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SAUDI-LED COALITION SAYS IT INTERCEPTED & DESTROYED BALLISTIC MISSILE TARGETING KHAMIS MUSHAIT

Houthis hit Aden airport as fighting escalates in Yemen

King Khalid airport in Riyadh also targeted with several drones

Reuters
Sanaa, October 7

YEMEN'S HOUTHIS attacked Aden's international airport with ballistic missiles and explosive-laden drones on Wednesday, the country's Transport Ministry said, as fighting between the Iran-aligned group and Saudi-backed government forces intensified.

Battles have focused in recent days on areas around the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a shipping route that has become more crucial for energy exports since the conflict between the US and Iran restricted trade through the Strait of Hormuz.

This week, Yemeni government forces with Saudi-led coalition air support launched a counter-offensive to recapture strategic territory near the strait and around the town of Mocha that the Houthis had captured in September, but it is unclear if their advance will hold.

The number of people displaced since the latest round of fighting began has risen to



Houthi supporters gather in solidarity with the movement as fighting escalates across several fronts, in Yemen, on Wednesday. REUTERS

more than 200,000, the International Organization for Migration said on Wednesday.

On Wednesday, the Saudi-led coalition said it had intercepted and destroyed a Houthi ballistic missile north of the Saudi capital Riyadh. It said it was tracking the launch platform over Houthi-controlled Sanaa and would destroy it, but gave no details of casualties or damage.

Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said in a statement that the group had targeted King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh with several drones. There was no immediate

ate Saudi confirmation of an attack on the airport.

Any Houthi stranglehold on the Strait could threaten shipping or global oil flows, and Saudi Arabia has been seeking international assistance to repel the Houthis. Turkey is sending mainly defensive and technical support, two officials said on Wednesday, after the NATO member and Pakistan pledged to implement a collective defence commitment under their newly formed alliance.

Fighting on the western front remains concentrated in Dhubbab, overlooking Bab el-Mandeb,



where pro-government forces are advancing into strategic hills to the east, Yemeni military and government sources said. The Houthis said they repelled the attacks.

A missile landed near the runway at Aden International Airport minutes before a Cairo flight was due to land, the Transport Ministry said. The flight was diverted to Jeddah, while two planes on the runway were moved away amid fears of further strikes. The Houthis did not immediately comment.

The Saudi-led coalition said it intercepted and destroyed a Houthi ballistic missile targeting Khamis Mushait, Saudi state TV reported. Separately, Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree said the group attacked Abha airport and a Khamis Mushait airbase with ballistic missiles and drones.

Iran must cut enrichment to end war: Vance

Reuters
Fairbanks, October 7

US VICE President JD Vance said in an exclusive interview with Reuters that Iran must make a "meaningful" reduction in its nuclear enrichment capacity to satisfy US demands and end the countries' seven-month war, even as Washington was unsure how Tehran makes decisions in negotiations.

Vance said on Monday after a campaign trip in Alaska that any agreement would require Iran to reduce its nuclear enrichment capacity, rather than offer assurances of future nuclear drawdowns.

"If you don't want a nuclear weapon, then why do you need 60% enriched fuel? And if you want to show commitment to not building a nuclear weapon, don't build highly enriched fuel. That's a very basic threshold issue," Vance said.

"I think if they want to show a commitment to not building a nuclear weapon, they would do something meaningful on their enrichment capacity."

Washington's "requests and ideas" about Iran's nuclear program are at odds with Tehran's demands, a senior Iranian official told Reuters on Wednesday when asked about Vance's comment that Tehran must cut enrichment to end the war.



People carrying Israeli flags walk through an installation marking the third anniversary of the October 7, 2023, Hamas attack on Israel, on the beachfront in Tel Aviv on Wednesday. AP

Scars from Oct 7 fuel divisions over Netanyahu ahead of Israel election

Associated Press
Jerusalem, October 7

AS ISRAEL gears up for its first elections since Hamas' October 7, 2023, attack, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and his opponents are putting it at the heart of their campaigns.

Nearly every poster, stump speech or televised debate seems to reference the attack, which has scarred the country and remains fresh in the minds of voters. Three years on, the worst security failure in Israel's history now threatens to end the career of its longest-serving prime minister.

"October 7 is kind of a framework for the entire political discussion that is going on," said Tamar Hermann, an expert on Israeli public opinion at the Israel Democracy Institute, a Jerusalem think tank. "All of us are post-traumatic in a way."

Netanyahu's opponents want him to pay for the failures that led to the deadliest day in Israel's 78-year history and plunged the country into a series of inconclusive wars. His defenders say Netanyahu was betrayed by the military establishment and that he has led Israel through a dramatic re-

bound from its darkest hour.

A loss in the October 27 election would likely end the career of the soon-to-be 77-year-old Netanyahu. A victory would mark the greatest turnaround yet for a man who has defied naysayers for three decades.

On the morning of October 7, Hamas militants fired several thousand rockets into Israel and thousands of militants attacked through holes blown in the border fence or with boats or motorized paragliders. Some 1,200 people were killed and 251 taken hostage.

Israel responded with a military offensive that has killed over 74,000 Palestinians in the Gaza Strip, according to local health authorities, left the territory in ruins and sparked an ongoing humanitarian catastrophe. Israel later went to war against Hezbollah militants in Lebanon, seized a chunk of Syria, attacked targets in Yemen and joined US in two wars against Iran.

Hundreds of Israelis, mostly young soldiers, have died, and nearly every household has been touched by the violence. Netanyahu promised "total victory," but Hamas, Hezbollah and Iran's theocratic government all remain intact.

Israel's international stand-

ing has plummeted, a number of foreign governments have accused it of genocide — a charge it vehemently rejects — and Netanyahu is now wanted by the International Criminal Court.

After a string of resignations by top security officials, Netanyahu is the only senior figure from October 7 still in office, making this month's election in many ways a referendum on his leadership.

Netanyahu and his opponents have put October 7 at the forefront of their campaigns — for different reasons. His opponents — from across the political spectrum — call his outgoing coalition "the massacre government." Netanyahu says he has led a "war of redemption."

His chief rival is Gadi Eisenkot, a former military chief whose son and nephew were killed in battle in Gaza. The opponents have pledged to form a government of "repair and reconstruction" — beginning with the formation of an official commission of inquiry into October 7.

They also have vowed to end draft exemptions for ultra-Orthodox religious men, a long-standing policy that has outraged the secular majority at a time of war, and accuse Netanyahu of threatening Israel's democratic institutions.

Russia launches 'massive' strikes at Ukraine, kills 24

Associated Press
Kyiv, October 7

RUSSIA POUNDED Ukraine with waves of missiles and drones in one of its most "vile strikes" on Wednesday, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said, killing at least 24 people, including children, and damaging industrial facilities and energy infrastructure.

The heaviest death toll was in Pryluky in Ukraine's northern Chernihiv region, where a Russian missile obliterated a five-storey residential building. At least 18 people, including



Emergency workers at the site of a Russian missile strike in Pryluky, Ukraine, on Wednesday. REUTERS

four children, were killed there, local officials said. Zelenskyy said the strike co-

“Today, as a birthday ‘gift’ to Putin, the Russian army destroyed a residential building in Pryluky”

VOLODYMYR ZELENSKYY, PRESIDENT OF UKRAINE

incided with Russian President Vladimir Putin's birthday.

"Today, as a birthday 'gift' to Putin, the Russian army destroyed a residential building in Pryluky..." Zelenskyy said, ad-

ding that six more people were also killed in Kyiv, Oleksandria and Kremenchuk during the massive attack.

In total, Russia fired 70 missiles at Ukraine overnight - many of them high-velocity ballistic munitions - and dozens of Shahed attack drones, he said. "The Russians wanted to strike painfully and demonstratively. This was one of the most vile strikes."

In Pryluky, an excavator and dozens of rescuers with shovels sifted through rubble at the site where several sections of the apartment block had collapsed.

Russia's defence ministry said its forces had carried out a "massive strike" on military-industrial facilities in Kyiv and other Ukrainian regions, using high-precision land-, sea- and air-launched weapons, as well as drones. Ukraine's air force said it had downed just over 80% of the 46 jet-powered drones launched by Russia.

Zelenskiy said the Russian ballistic missiles remained the major challenge for Ukraine, adding he and his team were "every day looking for Patriot systems that can and must protect people's lives".

Saudi launches probe into flydubai incident

Israel offers to join Saudi probe but says it was not invited

Reuters
October 7

SAUDI ARABIA has launched an air accident probe following last week's cockpit stabbing on a flydubai jet, as experts examine any fallout for aviation safety alongside a separate UAE-led criminal investigation, three people close to the matter said.

Until now, it has remained unclear whether Saudi Arabia would go ahead with such a probe, which experts say could test a system of international cooperation designed to make recommendations for safety without attempting to assign blame.

The people close to the matter said Saudi Arabia had notified specialist aviation agencies abroad that it would carry out a safety investigation

under international rules into flight FZ1073, which was in Saudi airspace when the co-pilot attacked the captain with an axe. Saudi Arabia's National Transport Safety Center, which has responsibility for accident investigations, did not respond to a request for comment.

Officials in the UAE did not respond to requests for comment. The UAE has already opened a separate criminal probe into the incident, which its prosecutor general has called a "terrorist attack."

Israel, whose citizens made up nearly all the 172 people on board, has offered to take part in any Saudi-led safety investigation but has not so far been invited to take part, the head of the country's air accident agency told Reuters.

"We are still waiting for a notification from Saudi Arabia to invite us to take a part in the investigation," Ofer Vaknin, director of the Aircraft Safety Investigation Authority, said.

S Korea's Lee says AI may have been used to hack banks

Seoul: South Korean President Lee Jae Myung said on Tuesday that AI models are believed to have been used in some recent hacking incidents against banks and called for the country to develop cybersecurity methods suited to the AI era. "In some hacking incidents, signs have emerged of AI being used, causing considerable public concern and anxiety," Lee said during a cabinet meeting. "Please establish circumstances swiftly and clearly, and concentrate personnel and resources on minimising the damage," he added.

South Korea's police have launched a full-scale investigation into the hacking attacks against commercial banks that led to a breach of customers' personal information, Yonhap news agency reported on Tuesday.

Authorities have not yet disclosed details on what kind of AI tools were used in the hacking incidents or the full scale of the breaches. REUTERS

US proposes \$70K work fee for foreign students

Associated Press
Washington, October 7

THE DEPARTMENT of Homeland Security on Wednesday proposed a \$70,000 fee for international students seeking to work in the United States, the latest effort from the Trump administration to crack down on foreign enrolment.

A proposed rule would require schools to pay the fee for every student who participates in the optional practice training programme, known as OPT, which allows students to work in jobs related to their major during or after their time in school. Students are generally eligible for one year of work post-graduation, though certain science, technology, engineering and math majors are eligible for an additional two years.

Schools would be required to pay the \$70,000 for each new student's initial application to the program, and a \$30,000 fee for each renewal.

The change would represent



US President Donald Trump

a blow to American colleges and universities that recruit students from overseas as a source of tuition revenue, as well as tech companies and other industries that hire many international students for technical roles.

In a statement, DHS described the fee as a response to fraud and abuse of the visa program, which it called a "pipeline for cheap foreign labor."

President Donald Trump's administration has been putting pressure on international students in many ways as part of its wider efforts to crack down on immigration and reshape higher education.

• BRIEFLY

NORTH KOREA

North Korea criticises US support for Taiwan, pledges backing for Russia



North Korea's Kim Jong Un at a press conference in Pyongyang. FILE

NORTH KOREA criticised the United States over its arms sales and military support for Taiwan, accusing Washington of fuelling tension in the Taiwan Strait, state news agency KCNA said on Wednesday. A KCNA commentary citing North Korean international affairs analyst Kim Myong Chol said US policy on Taiwan was undermining peace and stability in the region and condemned the appearance of US-sold fighter aircraft in Taiwan. REUTERS

POLAND

10 injured in knife attack at school

TEN PEOPLE were injured in a knife attack at a school in Ostroleka in Poland Wednesday, a regional governor said, with police detaining the 19-year-old suspect. Masovian Regional Governor Mariusz Frankowski said that nine people were taken to the hospital but none were in critical condition. REUTERS

GEORGIA

Man arrested in uranium sale bid

GEORGIA HAS detained a man who planned to sell uranium-238 to a foreign national for \$700,000, the national security service said on Wednesday. The Georgian citizen is accused of illegally handling nuclear material and faces up to 10 years in prison, it said in a statement. REUTERS

• SAINT WON AN ACADEMY AWARD IN 1955 FOR HER GRIPPING MOVIE DEBUT AS THE SHY LOVE INTEREST OF MARLON BRANDO'S LONGSHOREMAN IN *ON THE WATERFRONT*

Eva Marie Saint, Oscar winner and star of Hitchcock's *North by Northwest*, dies at 102

Aljean Harmetz
October 7

EVA MARIE Saint, who won an Academy Award in 1955 for her gripping movie debut as the shy love interest of Marlon Brando's longshoreman in *On the Waterfront*, and who proved equally convincing as a stylish siren opposite Cary Grant in the romantic Hitchcock thriller *North by Northwest*, died Tuesday at her Los Angeles home. She was 102. A family representative, Jeff Sanderson, confirmed the death.

Blonde and delicately beautiful — as a child, she played an angel in school pageants — Saint had been a working actress for eight years by the time she made

her first movie. She learned her craft on live television dramas — which, with their three cameras and constant tumult, forced her to learn to concentrate, she said.

Her supporting performance in *On the Waterfront*, which boasted one of the most impressive casts and crews ever assembled, would alone have assured her a place in movie history; the movie remains near the top of the American Film Institute's list of the country's greatest films.

It won the Oscar for best picture and director (for Elia Kazan), and Brando took home the award for best actor, for his tormented performance as a former prizefighter who moonlights as

muscle for a corrupt union.

Even if Brando had the most indelible lines ("I coulda been a contender"), Budd Schulberg, who won the screenwriting Oscar, said. Saint had the riskiest assignment — portraying a convent-educated young woman, Edie, who simmers with passion for Brando's Terry Malloy, Edie, who discovers Terry played a role in the death of her brother, who had run afoul of union racketeers, plays a critical role waking Malloy's conscience.

Kazan said he selected Saint from among hundreds of actresses for her ability to convey "simplicity and faith that well-brought-up Catholic girls have," but noted that she brought an ex-



Eva Marie Saint and Cary Grant in Alfred Hitchcock's 1959 movie *North by Northwest*. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

plosive capacity for lust and an ability to keep up with Brando, a master of improvisation.

"In casting Eva Marie Saint,"

the film critic AH Weiler wrote in *The New York Times*, "Mr. Kazan has come up with a pretty and blonde artisan who

does not have to depend on these attributes. Her parochial school training is no bar to love with the proper stranger. Amid scenes of carnage, she gives tenderness and sensitivity to genuine romance."

Nine months pregnant with her first child when she picked up her Oscar at the RKO Pantages Theater in Hollywood, she told the audience, "I'm so excited I may have the baby right here." Her son was born two days later.

Stardom beckoned, but Saint decided to raise a family and to make only one movie a year while her two children were growing up. She later recalled turning down a three-picture deal that her agent

promised would make her "a superstar." What she preferred, she reflected in 1996 to the Hollywood interviewers David Fantle and Tom Johnson, was "to be a working actress with a home life that worked."

"Have a life, and it is not lived on the set," she said. "I felt that way when I was raising my kids, and I feel that way now. I don't want make-believe children. When Donna Reed, the perfect American mother to millions of TV viewers in the 1950s, ended her show, her children were teenagers. She said to me, 'Now I'm going to get to know my kids.' I thought that was so very sad."

Almost as acclaimed as her work in *On the Waterfront* was

her performance as a seductive mystery woman opposite Grant in *North by Northwest* (1959), which is also on the AFI list.

Most of Saint's performances were intensely dramatic. She played the steadfast wife of a drug addict (Don Murray) in *A Hatful of Rain* (1957); the childhood sweetheart who loses Montgomery Clift to Elizabeth Taylor in *Raintree County* (1957); the widowed American nurse who falls in love with a Jewish warrior (Paul Newman) during the fight to create the state of Israel in *Exodus* (1960); and the older woman who is bedded and betrayed by a young drifter (Warren Beatty) in *All Fall Down* (1962). NYT

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MONETARY POLICY STANCE CHANGED FROM 'NEUTRAL' TO 'CALIBRATED TIGHTENING'

Easy money over: RBI hikes key rate by 25 bps to 5.5%, borrowers on notice

Full year growth estimate raised to 7.1 per cent, inflation forecast increased to 5.2%

Akash Mandal & George Mathew
Mumbai, October 7

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) has hiked its key policy rate, or the repo rate, by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.50 per cent, marking the first rate hike since February 2023. Repo rate is the rate at which the central bank lends short-term money to banks.

The bank has also signalled



RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra (centre) with his deputies (from left) Shirish Chandra Murmu, Swaminathan Janakiraman, Poonam Gupta and Rohit Jain at a press conference in Mumbai on Wednesday. PTI

a shift towards tighter monetary policy amid rising inflationary pressures, elevated crude oil prices and a challenging global interest-rate environment. The hike is expected to push up borrowing costs across the economy, affecting interest rates on home, personal and vehicle loans,

while also providing some support to deposit rates.

The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the central bank has changed the policy stance to 'calibrated tightening' from 'neutral' indicating

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



THE EDITORIAL PAGE
RBI'S FOCUS ON
INFLATION IS TIMELY
PAGE 10

First hike in over 3 years may not be last; repo rate can rise by another 75 bps

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 7

THE 25 basis points hike in key policy rate, the first in more than three years, may not be the last. A shift in the monetary stance from 'neutral' to 'calibrated tightening' is a clear warning that the central bank will tighten the screws if inflationary pressures refuse to ease. Bankers and economists are now expecting another 50-75 basis points hike in the policy rate in the coming reviews.

E. In other words, the RBI is likely to tighten the monetary policy with a series of rate hikes if the situation on the price front doesn't improve in the coming months. This means interest rates on loans will increase further, which in turn can dampen the demand conditions in the economy. "It (MPC) underscored that given the current conditions, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra holds a copy of the Constitution while being detained in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANIL SHARMA
RELATED REPORTS, PAGE 7

Second day, second Opp protest against CEC, detentions again

SP absent at Kharge lunch for INDIA bloc leaders; Cong for more protests today

Asad Rehman & Lalmani Verma
New Delhi, Lucknow, October 7

PRESSING FOR the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Opposition leaders staged a protest for the second consecutive day in the heart of the Capital Wednesday before they were stopped and detained by police.

The Samajwadi Party, however, stayed away from the INDIA bloc protest. On Tuesday, after the Opposition protest, Congress allies had expressed concern that it had been turned into a Rahul Gan-

dhi "show". The SP skipped the lunch hosted Wednesday by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge at the Sagar Ratna restaurant on Janpath.

From the restaurant, Opposition MPs, including Gandhi, Mamata TMC's Derek O'Brien, CPI(M)'s John Brittas and CPI's P Sandosh Kumar, boarded three buses to head towards Jantar Mantar. Over the next couple of hours, as the buses crawled forward, Congress workers walked alongside.

Police, however, blocked the way and the march came to a halt near Windsor Place. Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Up to 30% of cotton area under 'illegal' GM hybrids, finds study

Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, October 7

MORE THAN a quarter of the total area cultivated under cotton in India comprises "illegal" hybrids incorporating unapproved genetically modified (GM) traits, including resistance to glyphosate herbicide.

Out of the 114.8 lakh hectares (lh) area sown under cotton by Indian farmers in 2025-26, an estimated 26.2-29 lh, i.e. 24-30%, was of hybrids containing unauthorised herbicide-tolerant (HT) or *Bacillus thuringiensis* (Bt) genes, according to a field-based study

commissioned by the Federation of Seed Industry of India (FSII) and National Seed Association of India (NSAI).

India currently allows farmers to grow GM cotton hybrids/ varieties containing only two genes — cry1Ac and cry2Ab — that are isolated from Bt, a soil bacterium. These genes code for proteins toxic to certain bollworm insect pests.

But the FSII-NSAI study shows farmers are also planting the seeds of hybrids that contain cp4-epsps and Vip3A genes. Both these are alien genes, whose harbouring

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• Estimated market share of illegal HTBt cotton

	Total Cotton Area (lakh hectares)	Illegal HTBt Area (lakh hectares)	Illegal HTBt Area
Maharashtra	38.5	9.6-10.7	25-28%
Gujarat	20.9	6.2-6.6	30-32%
Telangana	20.5	5.5-6.1	27-30%
Andhra Pradesh	5.4	0.8-0.9	15-18%
Rajasthan	6.4	0.5-0.6	8-10%
Others	23.1	3.6-4.1	16-18%
TOTAL	114.8	26.2-29.0	24-30%

SOURCE: SOUTH ASIA BIOTECHNOLOGY CENTRE FIELD ASSESSMENT



Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the 'Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha - Seva Jyoti Yatra' in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

We will do it... will not stop, tire or waver: PM's new mantra for Viksit Bharat by 2047

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, October 7

CONTRASTING THE "gloom" and "immense challenges" under the UPA era with the "energy, enthusiasm, self-confidence" of India in the current global order, Prime Minister Narendra Modi Wednesday coined the mantra of "we will do it", saying the country will "not

stop, nor tire, nor waver" on the road to a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Speaking at the 'Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha - Seva Jyoti Yatra', organised at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi to mark 25 years of his continuous leadership as head of government, first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and then as Prime Minister, Modi said, "Even today, I consider myself

a student. I try to learn something new each day. That is why today, I prayed... that my power to learn does not wane. The more I learn, the more my capacity to do something for the nation will increase... I am beholden to every person and every incident which taught me something or the other. What brought me victory taught me to be humble, and

what made me stumble made me learn how to stand up."

"Well-wishers encouraged me and critics taught me to look within. Those who supported me showed me the strength of belief. Whoever opposed me taught me the power of democracy. Every crisis was a test of my patience, every success expanded my sense of »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• **THE SUPREME COURT** will hear the Centre's plea seeking initiation of contempt proceedings against the Jharkhand government for appointing the Director General of Police a day before retirement.

• **INDIAN WOMEN'S** football team will take on Russia in the first of two FIFA friendlies at Salt Lake Stadium in Kolkata.

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Record cheating incident, let student finish paper, alert helpline: IIT-B panel's exam drill

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, October 7

IF A student is caught cheating during an exam, the invigilator should take away the related material and record the incident, but allow the student to complete the paper with a fresh answer booklet. The quick response team (QRT) helpline should be alerted so the student has support after the exam.

These are among the proposals put forward by a committee, set up after the recent student suicide at IIT-Bombay, in its interim report, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

IIT Director Shireesh Kedare had set up the eight-member committee — four faculty members and four students — to revisit exam conduct rules, days after Sahil Wakode, a Second Year BTech stu-

dent who was allegedly found using a cellphone during a mid-



MPSC PROTESTS GROW IN MAHARASHTRA

semester exam, died by suicide on September 18.

The aim was to have guidelines in place before the remaining mid-semester papers are held this weekend. The committee presented its interim report at a special meeting of the IIT Senate on Wednesday.

The Senate has also decided to go back to the institute's 2015 punishment rules »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

2026 NOBEL PRIZE CHEMISTRY



HENRI B KAGAN

KENSO SOAI

How mirror-image molecules shaped the chemistry of life

EXPLAINED, PAGE 16

• CEO NOTICE SAYS BLOs SHOULD REFER TO LIST OF THOSE DELETED ON GROUNDS OF BEING ABSENT, SHIFTED, DEAD OR DUPLICATE, HINTS TRIBUNAL CASES NOT COVERED; BLOs WAIT FOR CLARITY

'They ask me over and over': Bengal BLOs fear tribunal questions in special drive

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, October 7

AN ORGANISATION representing Booth Level Officers (BLOs) has expressed apprehension that they may face the ire of deleted voters. Others wonder how long the latest turn in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise, of re-checking those voters "left out", will keep them away from their day jobs. Some point out that it entails them doing an exercise done by them once already. However, the biggest

question hanging over BLOs in West Bengal as they set out again is this: how do they tackle questions regarding those whose cases are hanging fire in appellate tribunals?

They also hope that clarity will be forthcoming in training sessions to be held for them after the Durga Puja holidays. With questions swirling, the state CEO's office put out a notice Tuesday saying that the special drive announced by the Election Commission of India (ECI) applies to "left out eligible voters", adding that BLOs should refer to the

list of ASDD (Absentee, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate) voters. "Any person in this list may submit Form 6 online or through BLO for inclusion of his/her name in the Electoral Roll," the notice said, apart from first-time voters who have now reached 18 years of age.

As reported by *The Indian Express* first, under fire over the scale of voter deletions, the ECI directed on September 29 that in the 20 states and Union Territories where the SIR was completed, a "special drive" will be held to enrol voters "left out" of the rolls. At a subsequent video conference with all state Chief



BLO Sahabuddin Mondol distributes enumeration forms to the residents of Kajipara, North 24 Parganas. EXPRESS ARCHIVES

Electoral Officers, the Deputy Election Commissioner present said pre-SIR and post-SIR

rolls should be compared to draw up the list of those deleted, and identify any who

may have been left out, as per officers who attended.

In the final electoral roll of West Bengal published on February 28 this year, 63.66 lakh voters were deleted, nearly 1.9 lakh added, while the cases of 60.06 lakh were listed as under adjudication. Of these, while 33 lakh-odd voters were restored to the electoral roll, cases of 27 lakh were referred to tribunals, which also took up around 16 lakh applications against inclusion.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* over the phone, Md Sahabuddin Mondol, a BLO of Barasat, North 24 Parganas, said: "Before the SIR, there were

1,279 voters in my booth. During the SIR, we found 120 either absent, shifted or dead. I think now there is a chance for such voters to apply again."

Additionally, from his booth, 586 cases were referred to the tribunals. Of these, "86 have been deleted so far", Sahabuddin says. "I am not sure whether these 86 can apply again, and I don't think those whose cases are still being heard by tribunals can apply either. But I am waiting for the training session."

The ECI also said in its September 29 order that the Form 6 for enrolment of voters now

will no longer require them to show linkage to the 2002 SIR. Sahabuddin says he has "heard of this change", but is waiting for clear instructions.

Pinki Jaiswal, a BLO at Kolkata's Narkeldanga, says of the 191 voters deleted in her booth, 100 were removed as they are dead. "The rest I will re-check. Basically, we have to check the shifted and absentee voters. In my case, I had found that most of them were now in Bihar."

Jaiswal adds: "The main problem is with the cases referred to tribunals. I have 28 in my booth who appealed, but »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PM’s new mantra

responsibility. Everything I accomplished gave me the strength, the drive to move towards larger goals,” he said.

Stating that he began his day with a visit to the Shri Vinayak temple where he “prayed for the nation and its 140 crore citizens”, he said, “I express my gratitude to all of you and to all my fellow countrymen. When I took the oath as Chief Minister of Gujarat on October 7, 2001, I never imagined that this milestone would also come.”

“Today, I have completed 25 years of continuously serving as head of government. This is the result of the continuous blessings of the janata janardan. I express my gratitude to all political colleagues of the BJP, NDA and all those who hold immense reverence for democracy. I bow my head at the feet of the people of the nation,” he said.

Praising the RSS swayams-evaks, whom he called the “guardians” of the country’s “cultural soul”, he said he never felt alone on his journey of self-less service.

Modi said the occasion was not one of merely recalling memories but also of adding new energy to predetermined goals and commitment. “*Hum kar ke rahenge* (we will do it)... Viskit Bharat by 2047, we will do it. Top three economies, we will do it. Aatmanirbhar Bharat, we will do it. Global manufacturing

hub, we will do it. Organising the Olympics, we will do it. Steps in outer space, we will do it... This energy, this enthusiasm, this self-confidence is incredible,” he said.

Taking a swipe at the UPA years, he said, “In 2014, the nation expanded my responsibility as Pradhan Sevak... The nation was confronting immense challenges, only problems were visible... Regarding Bharat’s economy, the world had begun saying ‘it’s a gone case’, growth was nowhere to be seen.”

Adding that a nation facing such “severe disappointment” needed “a new confidence”, he said he responded by doing “the only thing” he knows: “I urged the janshakti, repeated to them: ‘we will do it’. And today, 12 years later, the picture has changed entirely. Earlier, when a crisis used to emerge, India’s economy jolted. When a crisis comes now, Bharat’s perseverance is discussed. Its resilience is discussed,” he said.

“Back then, policy paralysis used to be discussed. Now the Reform Express is discussed... Back then, we used to import mobile phones even for our own use. Now, there is a jalwa of Made-in-India mobile phones,” he said.

Asking the gathering to take a pledge, Modi said, until Bharat become viskit, I will not stop, nor tire, nor waver.”

Opp stir

Vadralay on the road, clutching a copy of the Constitution, along with other women leaders.

Later, police forcibly removed Congress workers and detained the Gandhi siblings and other senior leaders. Kerala Chief Minister V D Satheesan and Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy were among those who had joined the protest.

“We are not going to stop protesting till Gyanesh Kumar resigns. This is a fight to protect the most sacred thing in this country. There is nothing that Narendra Modi and Amit Shah can do that will stop us,” Gandhi said.

He thanked all INDIA bloc MPs “standing firm in defence of our democracy – in Parliament, outside on the streets, and today near Jantar Mantar”.

The Congress called for more protests at state, district and block levels on Thursday.

The party also played down the absence of SP MPs from Wednesday’s lunch meeting, saying they had left Delhi the night before or early Wednesday. The SP’s absence, it is learnt, also came up during the discussions over lunch. Later in the day, INDIA bloc leaders reached out to the SP, which

agreed to send its representatives for the protest Thursday, sources said.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh, in a post on X, said all alliance parties were invited to the lunch. “But the decision for lunch had been taken late last night and communicated. It was therefore natural that some parties could not be represented. There is needless comment in some sections of the media on it. INDIA and other Opposition parties are united and stand in solidarity against Vote Chori, SIR and Delimitation,” he said.

SP leaders whom *The Indian Express* spoke to blamed the patchy coordination by the Congress. A party MP said, “The Samajwadi Party did not attend the lunch by the Congress because of lack of proper coordination from the Congress side. Samajwadi Party MPs left for their constituencies Tuesday evening after the protest against the CEC ended. Until then, there was no information about the lunch.”

Sources in the SP said the party leadership and the MPs were upset with the Gandhi siblings for “stealing the show” Tuesday. The developments are playing out against a key backdrop: the UP Assembly elections early next year. The SP and the Congress are allies and as the polls approach, a tussle over seat distribution has begun.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

RBI hikes rate

further hike in the interest rates is a likelihood. The policy panel has also hiked the growth projection to 7.1 per cent from 6.7 per cent in FY27 in the wake of the higher economic activity.

The panel also raised the inflation forecast to 5.2 per cent for FY27 from 5 per cent previously.

The six-member MPC headed by RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra has sent a hawkish message: the era of easy money is almost over, and borrowers should brace themselves for more pain. The MPC’s decision to shift its stance from ‘neutral’ to ‘calibrated tightening’ is not a mere change in terminology — it is a clear warning that the central bank is prepared to tighten the screws if inflationary pressures refuse to ease.

“It (MPC) underscored that given the current conditions, rate cuts are off the table in the near-term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving conditions and the outlook,” Malhotra said after the MPC meeting. The decision by the policy panel to hike rates comes after nearly two years of monetary accommodation.

Announcing the monetary policy, Malhotra said high frequency indicators show economic activity holding momentum in the second quarter albeit with some moderation when compared to first quarter.

The RBI’s move follows growing concerns that inflationary pressures are becoming more broad-based. Retail inflation rose to 4.82 per cent in August, remaining above the central bank’s medium-term target

of 4 per cent for the third consecutive month, although it continues to remain within the RBI’s tolerance band of 2-6 per cent.

The last rate hike – when it was hiked from 6.25 per cent to 6.50 per cent – occurred in February 2023, making any potential increase the first in over three-and-a-half years. As inflation risks persist, a more extended rate hike cycle may be on the horizon. The RBI decision comes against a backdrop of rising food and energy prices, weather-related disruptions and higher crude oil prices. Maharashtra has declared drought in about 266 of its 358 talukas, while the possibility of drought has also been flagged in Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan. Reservoir levels across India are around 20 per cent below last year’s levels, raising concerns about agricultural output and the rabi crop. The possibility of El Niño conditions extending into 2027 remains another key risk to the inflation outlook.

Global developments have added to the pressure. Crude oil prices have risen above \$100 a barrel amid geopolitical tensions, raising concerns about imported inflation and India’s external balance. The West Asia conflict and the Russia-Ukraine war have also added uncertainty to the global economic outlook.

At the same time, global interest rates remain elevated. The US Federal Reserve recently raised its policy rate by 25 bps to 3.75-4 per cent, while US benchmark yields have also risen sharply by 53 bps to 5.31 per cent in a month. The benchmark 10-year bond

yield in India has gone up by 25 bps to 7.21 per cent in a month. A narrowing interest-rate differential with the US could increase pressure on India’s financial markets and currency, making the RBI’s policy response more important. Foreign investors have been pulling out funds from India in the wake of the rise in yields in the US.

Loans to get costlier

The increase in the repo rate is expected to feed into lending rates, particularly for loans linked to external benchmarks. Home, personal and vehicle loan borrowers could see their equated monthly instalments (EMIs) rise as banks pass on the higher cost of funds. Loans linked to the marginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR) may also become more expensive. Banks, however, have flexibility in revising MCLR-based rates depending on their funding costs, liquidity conditions and deposit mobilisation.

Deposit rates could also rise marginally as banks reassess their funding requirements. The extent of any increase will depend on liquidity and broader funding conditions. Savers and depositors would like to see the deposit rates going up as high retail inflation has cut into their savings.

With borrowing costs already elevated, another rate hike would put additional pressure on households, businesses and an economy struggling to sustain momentum.

The central bank’s message leaves little room for complacency. By signalling further tightening, the RBI has effectively chosen to prioritise inflation control over the immediate concerns of growth and credit

demand. The outcome could be particularly punishing for consumers and businesses carrying existing debt, as higher interest rates translate into steeper EMIs, costlier working capital and weaker investment. If the MPC follows through on its hawkish stance, the next round of tightening could expose just how much economic pain the RBI is willing to tolerate to bring inflation under control.

“How deep the rate hike or shallow the rate hike will be will depend on the evolving macro-economic conditions and the growth dynamics,” Malhotra said.

“The underlying inflation, the path where it is going because especially in these times when a lot of increase in headline inflation is because of one base effect and other supply side factors. So headline alone may not be the right measure. Actually, we have to look at other measures which we have given including code, diffusion indices, etc,” Malhotra said.

He further observed that in the light of available data, it is clear that inflation and its outlook are not benign as they were last year, with headline retail inflation expected to average almost 5.8% in the next three quarters and core inflation projected at 4.4 per cent this financial year. “In this milieu, recalibrating the policy rate is imperative,” Malhotra said.

Looking ahead, global economic uncertainty and supply chain disruptions are expected to have some bearing on domestic economic activity, he said. “Furthermore, weak southwest monsoon along with strong El Niño conditions may impact the upcoming rabi season and rural demand,” he said.

5 states on GST power

feel that taking away such powers will make it completely toothless. While there can be a provision for ‘no arrest’ in normal cases, there can be a provision for ‘civil arrest’ in cases of serious violations under GST,” the minister said.

The Council meeting got deferred by a day to Thursday, and the additional day in between is learnt to have been utilised by Union government officials to reach out to GST chief commissioners across zones to iron out residual issues, especially concerns over the ‘no-arrest’ proposal.

On Thursday, the Council, in a bid to boost investor sentiment and allay concerns about overreach by tax authorities, is set to take up the proposal to decriminalise offences including removal of arrests, as was reported by *The Indian Express* last Sunday.

The underlying intent, an official said, is to make enforcement work through money rather than custody, and

through a system that detects fraud rather than a provision that deters it. As per the proposal to be discussed at the Council meeting, tax disputes are aimed to be resolved through civil consequences, namely recovery of tax, interest for the delay, and penalty, while keeping prosecution available for a higher threshold of Rs 5 crore as against Rs 1 crore at present.

“The idea is to focus on detection and not deterrence. The proposal is to remove pre-prosecution arrests and the Council will debate it. In the last 8-9 months, several rounds of discussions were held between states and the Centre, including three national coordination meetings. So far, 3-4 states have expressed their concerns, especially about how they will get to trace offenders. The Council will take a final call on the form that the arrest powers should take, keeping in mind the criticism regarding threats of criminalisation,” the official said.

The arrest provisions under GST have been seen as a major impediment for traders and businesses, especially after several arrests of high-ranking functionaries that were described by industry leaders as an overreach.

Industry experts said that arrests had become a harassment tool under GST, and would often be deployed as a bargaining tool for businesses to pay penalties in order to avoid prolonged legal battles.

That is why, the underlying principle about decriminalisation, is being supported across the board while keeping up the ante against a blanket removal for arrest powers.

“In the pre-GST era, the powers to arrest were only under excise, and not VAT (Value Added Tax). Once both excise and VAT got subsumed under GST, the powers to arrest got transferred too in the process and has been overtly exercised, not in action but in threats. It is a power that should only be exercised by a law enforcer and not a tax collector. The power to arrest should be linked to criminality, wherein

prosecution is involved through courts,” another official said.

The next phase of GST 2.0 is going to focus on a trust-based administration, the official said. For this, officials are of the view that “systems built on technology and good quality data” can help ensure correct behaviour from businesses without “onerous compliance”.

“With deeply integrated technology and artificial intelligence used in data analysis, the overall reform process should be system focused. The AI boom has enabled immense tech prowess for enforcement authorities and measures can be taken to improve upon it,” a state government official said.

The Council’s meeting Thursday will take up the second half of the reform exercise that was kicked off by the GST rate cuts announced in September 2025. The Council will deliberate on a wide variety of issues that encompass all the tax dealings of an entity during its lifecycle: getting registered, filing returns and correcting them, claiming refunds, and answering demands.

Bengal BLOs

there is no news regarding their hearings.” The BLO believes “they cannot be included in the exercise”.

Khurshid Anwar, a BLO from Srirampur in Hooghly district, says he has “heard that we will have to visit and re-check the documents”. He mentions that it will take time, and adds: “But the main problem is the tribunal cases. People are stuck there, and they ask me about it over and over.”

Habibur Rehman, a BLO from Deganga in South 24 Parganas, says: “All I am hearing is that there will be training. Only after that can I tell you anything.”

A BLO from Central Kolkata who did not want to be named expresses his frustration. “After

completing the SIR and then helping with the Assembly elections, we have now been enrolled for Census. That itself is a mammoth task, and the process will only be completed next February. Meanwhile, this special ECI drive has started. When will we do these jobs and when do we do our school duties?”

Earlier, an organisation representing BLOs called ‘Vote-kormi and BLO Aikya Mancha’ wrote to the Bengal CEO seeking “appropriate measures for complete security... for BLOs working in sensitive areas... where a huge number of voters have been deleted during SIR”. Referring to South and North 24 Parganas, Howrah, parts of Hooghly and Kolkata, Malda,

Murshidabad and Uttar Dinajpur, the letter said: “In these districts, a huge number of voters were deleted for no reason... They (the BLOs) may be the target of attacks by furious deleted voters.”

The BLOs themselves had no role in the mass deletion, the letter said, blaming it on the ECI “system” flagging logical discrepancies that had “raised the question of credentials of these deleted voters”. Then Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee’s decision to go to court led to their cases coming under adjudication and finally being referred to tribunals, the organisation wrote. “The entire process was faulty and then we drew the attention of the concerned authority, but

without result.”

Asked about the BLOs’ fears, a senior ECI official said, “In this process, they don’t have to go to every applicant’s house. All District Electoral Officers will organise camps where applicants can apply through Form 6. They can also apply online. Then, if an Electoral Registration Officer or District Electoral Officer thinks that in a particular case physical verification is needed, in only those, BLOs would have to go to the applicant’s residence.”

On the tribunal cases, the official said: “No applicant who was deleted after hearing in a tribunal or whose case is under tribunal’s jurisdiction can apply because the Calcutta High Court earlier said that such cases can only go to an appellate court. The ECI has no role in their cases.”

‘Illegal’ GM hybrids in cotton area

any crops has not been approved by the government.

The cp4-epsps gene, sourced from another soil-dwelling agrobacterium, makes cotton plants “tolerant” to glyphosate.

This herbicide cannot be sprayed on normal cotton, as the chemical does not distinguish between the crop and weeds. The Vip3a gene is derived from Bt, but works differently from the cry1Ac/ cry2Ab genes and is said to effectively control a broader spectrum of bollworm larvae.

The FSSI-NSAI study has been based on 227 geo-tagged seed/ leaf samples collected from fields of 984 farmers across

gene identification was conducted using dipstick/ lateral flow assays and ELISA (enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay).

“We found the HT cp4-epsps gene to be present in 72.69% of the field samples, with this as high as 88.64% for Telangana, 70.92% for Maharashtra, 62.86%

THE ‘HOTSPOT’ SURVEY DISTRICTS

Maharashtra	Akola, Jalgaon, Nagpur, Wardha, Yavatmal
Telangana	Jangaon, Jayashankar Bhupalpally, Karimnagar, Kumuram Bheem Asifabad, Mahabubabad
Andhra Pradesh	Anantapur, Kurnool, Guntur, Palnadu
Rajasthan	Hanumangarh, Phalodi

SOURCE: SOUTH ASIA BIOTECHNOLOGY CENTRE FIELD ASSESSMENT.

16 districts of Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh (AP) and Rajasthan. The 16 ‘hotspot’ districts were identified using a combination of secondary data sources, including glyphosate sale trends, farmer interactions and seed market intelligence. The testing of the samples for

First hike in over 3 yrs

rate cuts are off the table in the near term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving conditions and the outlook,” RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said after the MPC meeting.

With borrowing costs already elevated, another rate hike would exert additional pressure on households, businesses and an economy trying to sustain momentum in a challenging external environment.

The RBI’s message leaves little room for complacency. By signalling further tightening, the central bank has effectively chosen to prioritise inflation control over the immediate concerns of growth and credit demand. The consequences could be particularly punishing for consumers and businesses carrying existing debt, as higher interest rates translate into steeper EMIs, costlier working capital and weaker investment. If the MPC follows through on its hawkish stance, the next round of tightening could expose just how much economic pain the RBI is willing to tolerate in its battle to bring inflation under control.

Malhotra said the duration and extent of the rate hike cycle would be contingent on the actual growth-inflation developments and outlook, especially that of underlying inflation, the extent of broadening of price pressures and second round effects of the supply shock, as also the impact of demand impulses. The MPC observation clearly indicates that another rate hike might be in the offing in the December policy review, depending on the economic conditions, analysts said in initial reactions.

HDFC Bank economists expect the RBI to hike rates by another 50-75 bps over the coming meetings (expect back-to-back increases in consecutive meetings instead of a staggered approach). “The need for a more aggressive rate hike cycle (greater than 100-125bps) hinges on: how the West Asia conflict progresses from here on; how durable and strong is the second order impact of inputs costs increases on retail inflation; evolution of El Niño conditions and impact on winter crop and finally and how growth and de-

mand impulses hold up in the face of global volatility and rate increases,” the bank said.

“Given these factors, while a longer and higher rate hike cycle cannot be ruled out completely at this stage, we see it as a lower probability event,” it said.

While ICRA’s baseline GDP growth projection (+7.1 per cent) for FY2027 is in line with the MPC, it believes that there are risks to the outlook arising from deficient monsoon rainfall, impact of rising global energy prices on corporate profits, and an adverse base owing to GST rate cuts in September 2025.

ICRA’s baseline estimate pencils in the CPI inflation at 5.0 per cent in FY2027, lower than the MPC’s forecast. However, elevated crude oil prices could push inflation to 5.3-5.5 per cent, with the GDP growth moderating to 6.8 per cent in the fiscal. “At present, we expect another rate hike of 25 bps in the December 2026 meeting, and a pause thereafter, unless there are sizeable negative surprises on the inflation front,” ICRA said.

“Our estimates suggest that headline inflation will remain above 5.5 per cent YoY for three consecutive quarters starting in Q3 FY27, significantly above the RBI’s medium-term target of 4 per cent YoY. As inflation accelerates, real policy rates are likely to turn negative, necessitating a recalibration of monetary policy,” UBS Chief India Economist Tanvee Gupta Jain said. “We expect a cumulative 50-75 bps rate hike cycle, with another 25bps hike likely in the December policy.”

Namrata Mittal, Chief Economist, SBI Funds Management, expects another cumulative 75 bps of hikes through the cycle, potentially taking the repo rate to 6.0 per cent, though she highlights that the global environment remains highly fluid.

Malhotra further observed that in light of available data, it is clear that inflation and its outlook are not benign as they were last year, with headline CPI inflation expected to average almost 5.8 per cent in the next three quarters and core inflation projected at 4.4 per cent this financial year. “In this milieu, recalibrating the policy rate is imperative,” he said.

IIT-B panel exam drill

until a new set is drafted, putting on hold the stricter rules it adopted this year. Under the July rules, a student found carrying a phone into an exam got an FR (or ‘fail and repeat’) grade and suspension for a semester. Under the 2015 rules, carrying a phone in the exam hall would mean ‘loss of one grade’, and using it would mean an FR.

A student caught talking to another during an exam got a straight FR under the July rules. In 2015, it meant loss of one grade unless there was other evidence, such as identical answers.

The committee’s interim report proposes that the invigilator should record the incident in a prescribed form, give the student a chance to give their version, and alert a quick response team (QRT) so the student has support, it has said. Seized items such as phones may be photographed.

The report proposes limits to the invigilator’s role. “An important point to note: When a suspected unauthorised academic practice is noticed, the invigilator’s responsibility is to stop that activity, collect related material and record details to the extent possible. Further proceedings will be carried out later by the Disciplinary Action Committee as per norms,” it says.

Protesting students have alleged procedural lapses in how Wakode’s case was handled.

The invigilator is to seize the material with as little conversation with the student as possible. If there is doubt about the student’s identity, the invigilator can photograph them at the desk, the report says.

When the exam ends, the invigilator should fill a form describing the incident and the evidence collected. The student can record their version on another form, at a designated venue with additional staff present. The forms, which the report is prescribing for the first time, are meant to keep a complete record of each case, sources said. These will be sent to the head of the department conducting the course, along with the seized material and the original answer book.

When the student leaves the exam hall, the invigilator must alert the QRT helpline, giving the student’s name, roll number, course and venue, the report says. The idea is to ensure the student isn’t alone after such an incident, sources said.

Until now, the institute followed procedures framed in 2015, which had a single paragraph on what an invigilator should do. With no central monitoring, each department handled cases in its own way, sources said.

Choudhary noted.

Laboratory analysis of samples apart, the decline in sales of “legal” Bt cotton hybrid seeds – from 596 lakh packets in 2022-23 to 463 lakh packs in 2025-26 (each packet contains 450 grams of seeds) -- is also proof of the high acceptance of HT hybrids by farmers. This has been accompanied by a significant 29% jump in imports of glyphosate, from 27,721 kilolitres in 2024-25 to 35,642 kilolitres in 2025-26.

The FSSI-NSAI study has estimated the unauthorised HTBt seed market in India to have expanded from around 35 lakh packets in 2017-18 to 82-88 lakh packets in 2025-26. At an average price of Rs 1,000 per packet, this market would be “conservatively” valued at Rs 820-880

crore.

Equally interesting is the planting of cotton hybrids expressing the Vip3 Bt gene. “We found 53.74% of our 227 field samples testing positive for this next-generation insect-resistance gene. Its presence was 58.16% in Maharashtra, 54.29% in AP, 57.14% in Rajasthan and 38.64% in Telangana. The driver here seems to be effectiveness against pink bollworm, with the first-generation Bt hybrids becoming vulnerable to this insect pest,” said Choudhary.

Simply put, the market for illegal GM cotton seeds is growing, with both farmers and a sophisticated supplier network bypassing the country’s established biosafety and regulatory approval system.

Pregnant woman, 2 children killed in Delhi building collapse



Rescue operation underway at New Seemapuri on Wednesday. AMIT MEHRA

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 7

APREGNANT woman and two children were killed and eight people, including a three-year-old, injured after a four-storey building collapsed in Northeast Delhi’s New Seemapuri on Wednesday afternoon, trapping people under the rubble. On Tuesday, when Delhi experienced earthquake tremors in the evening, the building had developed cracks, officials said. Within minutes of the collapse, residents started pulling people out of the rubble and took them to hospitals. Among those who rushed between the collapse site and hospitals looking for their loved ones was Reshma (24). She was looking for her younger sister Gulfisha (22), who was four months pregnant. Gulfisha had been walking

through E Block with her four-year-old daughter Zoya when the building came crashing down around 3.10 pm. Her father received a call from Gulfisha after the collapse. “She told him she was stuck under rocks. And she can’t breathe,” Reshma said. Reshma rushed to Rajiv Gandhi Hospital after being told that Gulfisha had been taken there. “At the hospital, they say she is here (at the collapse site). I came back,” she said. Gulfisha was later identified as the pregnant woman who died. The identity of the two deceased children, one of whom was 12-years-old, had not been established by Wednesday evening. Zoya was among those initially feared trapped. Another one trapped was Hazra Khatun (42). She had been taking a walk near the building when it collapsed.



The four-storey building on Wednesday. AMIT MEHRA

“She was just taking a walk here. Then I heard that a build-

ing had collapsed. When she didn’t return, I came here,” Haseena, her daughter, said. The collapse took place near the Idgah Machhli Mandi area. “The building measured 225 sq ft. Some people have been rescued and sent to hospitals, but we suspect that two to three people are still trapped under the debris. They are talking... rescue operation is underway,” DCP R P Meena said. In a statement, the MCD described the structure as a ground-plus-three-floor building located in a jhuggi jhopri area on about 25 square yards of DUSIB land. It said the building was around 20-25 years old and occupied. The building stood next to the mosque in the densely packed locality. The boundary wall of the mosque also collapsed in the impact, while walls of an ad-

joining building were damaged, the MCD added. Officials said demolition work was being carried out in the adjoining building. Three- and four-storey structures surround the mosque on three sides, leaving little open space. Much of the debris fell inside the mosque compound, said local residents. The building was owned by Anwar. His family members who stayed on the first three floors included his wife Salma (50); son Rehman (28) and wife Sakeena; his daughters Nushrat and Ameena; as well as Nushrat’s three-year-old son Abdaan. While Anwar, Ameena and Rehman’s wife were not at home when the building collapsed, Nushrat is stuck under the debris, officials said. A tenant, also named Sakeena (35), lived on the upper floor, according to relatives.

Fixes for Barapullah 3 traffic mess: U-turn, redesigned merger point, wide road and changed Google Maps

• THE QUICK SOLUTIONS

- SUNDIAL MERGE:** Traffic Police has suggested redesigning the merger point to improve vehicle flow.

ROAD WIDENING: The government is working on widening the affected stretch to accommodate the increased flow.

FOOTPATH REMOVAL: A footpath between Sarai Kale Khan and ITO is being removed to improve traffic movement.
- TRAFFIC POLICE:** Personnel to be deployed at peak hours to regulate the three merging traffic streams.

NEW U-TURN: A dedicated U-turn near Gurdwara Bala Sahib for Siddharth Extension residents, reducing dependence on the ramp to the old Barapullah.
- GOOGLE MAPS:** PWD coordinating with Google Maps to ensure routing reflects the current congestion and traffic pattern.

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 7

WITH CONGESTION building up soon after Barapullah Phase III opened last week, the Delhi government is now relying on a series of quick measures — deployment of traffic police at merging points, a new U-turn, redesigning the point where traffic merges, widening the road and removing a footpath, while also working with Google Maps to ensure real-time route information is provided to the commuters. Citing an engineering flaw in the construction, which had not taken into account the traffic situation expected after 10 years, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Wednesday, “The government is currently working on immediate traffic-management measures, while discussions on a longer-term solution continue.” Singh blamed the previous AAP-led Delhi government for the flaw in the construction. “The Barapullah Phase III flyover project began in 2015. That means its design had already been approved in 2014-2015, when the AAP government had come to power in Delhi. The entire design was approved during their tenure. How many lanes the flyover would have, all of this was de-

cided by them,” he said. The new corridor connects Mayur Vihar with Sarai Kale Khan and links to the existing Barapullah network, creating a continuous stretch of around 10 km towards the AIIMS roundabout. However, the promise of a 15-minute, signal-free ride has run into a bottleneck at Sarai Kale Khan, where vehicles from three sides converge before entering the older and narrower Barapullah flyover. The project was scheduled for completion in 2017 but opened only in 2026. Over these nine years, vehicle numbers had risen significantly. Traffic Police had earlier flagged another problem: Google Maps was showing the new corridor as relatively clear, directing motorists towards a stretch that was already congested. Singh said the PWD was in touch with Google Maps and that its algorithm could take about 15 days to reflect the changed traffic situation. The AAP called for a CBI investigation. “The BJP government itself admits that Barapulla Phase III has serious issues of planning, design and traffic integration. It must answer why it sanctioned Rs. 1,635 crore without a proper technical assessment. The CBI must investigate the matter,” an AAP spokesperson said.

Ahead of CJP protest, police put 2,800 ‘criminals’ on radar

2,873 people who took part in CJP’s July protests flagged; police working to stop them from reaching Delhi on Oct 10

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 7

THE DELHI Police had identified 2,800-odd people with a criminal background who took part in the Cockroach Janta Party’s July protests against the NEET paper leak at Jantar Mantar. Efforts are on to ensure none of them reach Delhi on October 10, senior officers told *The Indian Express*. The CJP has announced that the ‘Jantar Mantar 2.0’ protest, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, will start on October 10. According to sources in the Delhi Police, all those with criminal antecedents who were spotted by the Facial Recognition System (FRS) during the July protests will be tracked by their local police stations. “Permission to protest has not been granted yet. So police stations will track if people with a history of serious offences, especially the ones who came last time, are heading towards the protest site. The idea is to not let them come here and disrupt law and order in the area,” said a police officer on condition of anonymity. At least 2,873 people with criminal records had been flagged by the FRS: 989 of them were accused in heinous cases, 101 named in murder cases, and at least 42 were involved in two or more murders. *The Indian Express* reported that at least 25 of them, accused of serious crimes such as murder, attempted murder, rape and child abuse, were even supposed to be in jail.

Students told to keep away

Apart from tracking criminals, police are also looking to ‘inform’ students that any assembly on October 10 in the New Delhi area would be unlawful, said a senior police officer. Public meetings with members of Residents’ Welfare Associations (RWAs) in areas with dense student populations are usually a regular feature. Now, a senior officer said, PG owners are specifically being made aware of the law and order situation in the capital in these meetings. “We are asking PG owners to inform students that Section 163 of the BNS is in force in the New Delhi district. So any protest in the area is illegal and students should be considerate of that,” said a senior cop.

Focus on city borders

The border areas are also a focus for the Delhi Police. Another senior officer told *The Indian Express* that police will be on a lookout for ‘large’ groups of people who are looking to enter Delhi before Saturday. The main focus areas will be the Uttar Pradesh border, which touches East Delhi and Shahdara, Haryana border, which touches Dwaraka, and the Rajasthan border, which touches Southwest Delhi. “Any mass movement will be tracked through borders. We will be putting up barricades for checks on routes going towards New Delhi, so that large groups of people don’t assemble,” said a senior police officer.

Maa Shakumbhari University, Saharanpur
(A State University of Uttar Pradesh)
Walk-In-Interview

Advt. No.- 06/36/प्रशा०/MSU/2026-27 Date: 08-10-2026

Walk-In-Interview will be held for inclusion in the panels of Faculty to be invited on a purely per lecture (Guest Faculty) basis during the session 2026-27 in various teaching schools/departments/Constituent Colleges of the University.

Note: For the Application form and other details, please visit the University website <https://msuniversity.ac.in>

Kamal Krishna
Registrar

Judge recuses himself from hearing plea of Gymkhana Club

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 7

DELHI HIGH Court judge, Justice Prateek Jalan, on Wednesday recused himself from hearing a civil suit over the Centre’s proceedings against the Delhi Gymkhana Club for its eviction from the 27.3-acre premises on Safdarjung Road. “I am going to recuse myself from this matter... I would be more comfortable if somebody else hears this,” Justice Jalan orally remarked. “There are matters where one does not trust one’s own judgement... There is too much personal involved,” he said without elaborating, reported PTI. Justice Jalan directed that the lawsuit by the Delhi Gymkhana Club Ltd Staff Welfare Association be listed before another bench on Friday.

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NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation of Physical Securities
This is to inform all concerned shareholders that, pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-POD/II/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, a special window for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019, has been opened for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.

This initiative is also applicable to transfer requests that were originally submitted prior to April 01, 2019, but were either rejected, returned, or not attended due to deficiencies in documentation or other procedural issues.

Please note that all transfer requests will be processed strictly in dematerialized form and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/lien-marked/pledged during the said lock-in period. Concerned shareholders are advised to take note of this opportunity and lodge/re-lodge their transfer requests along with the requisite documents to the Company’s Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, MAS Services Limited, at T-34, II Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-II, New Delhi – 110020. Tel.: 011-26387281-83; Email Id: investor@masserv.com

For National Fertilizers Limited, Sd/- (Ashok Jha) Company Secretary

Place: New Delhi
Date: 08.10.2026



MESSAGE FROM THE CHIEF OF THE AIR STAFF



AMAR PREET SINGH
Air Chief Marshal

On the occasion of the 94th Air Force Day, I extend my heartfelt greetings to the people of our great nation. Your trust and unwavering support remain our greatest sources of strength.

The Indian Air Force has evolved from its modest beginnings in 1932 into a modern, networked and a formidable force, shaped by generations of Air Warriors who have served with courage, professionalism and sacrifice.

As the strategic environment becomes increasingly complex and contested, one lesson remains clear: Air power is a decisive instrument of national power. Its speed, reach, flexibility and precision allow for rapid response and significant effects across the battlespace.

Operation Sindoor reaffirmed this reality as we integrated platforms, sensors, weapons and command-and-control into a coherent combat architecture that yielded decisive outcomes.

Our responsibility extends beyond the battlespace. Indian Air Force not only strikes but also saves. In times of disaster or humanitarian crisis, we have responded with speed, reliability and compassion thereby demonstrating that service to the nation and humanity, is central to our ethos.

For us, readiness is a permanent state of being, not a posture assumed during crisis. Our Air Warriors remain prepared 24/7 to respond whenever the nation calls. As we look ahead, our focus remains on building a resilient, integrated and future-ready force and we continue to prioritize combined operational effect over individual platform strength.

On this solemn occasion, we honor the bravehearts who made the supreme sacrifice and I pay my deepest respect to our Air Veterans, whose experience and wisdom continue to inspire us. As the Indian Air Force enters its 95th year, we move forward with pride, confidence and clarify; and continue to uphold our commitment to the nation's sovereignty, security, and integrity thus living up to the our theme:

“भारतीय वायु सेना – अचूक, अभेद्य एवं सटीक”

“As the Indian Air Force marks 94 years of distinguished service to the nation, we salute the dedication, professionalism and courage of its personnel. For over seven decades, Thales has been proud to support this journey through advanced technologies, local partnerships and a growing contribution to ‘Make in India’. Together with the Indian Air Force and local defence industry, we look forward to contributing to the development of future-ready capabilities that strengthen the nation’s air power.”

Ankur Kanaglekar, Vice President - India, Thales

“It is a great honor for us to congratulate the Indian Air Force on its 94th anniversary! India is a long-standing strategic partner of Russia, and we are proud that our aircraft have been in service with the Indian Air Force for decades, forming the backbone of the fleet. Russian aircraft account for the largest share of the Indian Air Force’s inventory, numbering around 400.

For instance, MiG has been organizing the production and modernization of defense products for over 50 years. Su-30MKI fighter jets are successfully assembled in India as part of an industrial partnership. This is not a recent trend but an established practice dating back to the 1960s, when licensed production of the MiG-21 fighter was launched in India. In other words, Russia has been building a strategic partnership with India within the framework of the “Make in India” concept for more than half a century. We also see prospects for collaboration on new projects, including fifth-generation aircraft.”

Vadim Badelkha,
CEO, United Aircraft
Corporation



Made in India,
Ready for the Skies



India’s pursuit of indigenous air power is entering a more consequential phase. The story is no longer simply about developing one fighter aircraft; it is about creating an aerospace ecosystem capable of designing, producing, integrating and sustaining aircraft, engines, avionics, sensors, weapons and helicopters. The Indian Air Force (IAF), through its operational requirements, has become an important anchor for that ecosystem.

The LCA Tejas Mk1 remains the foundation of this journey. Conceived by the Aeronautical Development Agency and manufactured by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), the fighter brought Indian design, flight-control, avionics and systems-integration capabilities into a frontline combat aircraft. Its evolution into the Mk1A is now taking the programme further, with enhanced avionics, electronic-warfare capabilities and an AESA radar. HAL has also expanded production, including a third LCA production line at Nashik.

An often-overlooked part of this story is training. In September 2026, HAL handed over the final two LCA FOC twin-seat trainers to the IAF, giving the service an indigenous training variant closely related to its frontline fighter. The aircraft are intended to provide pilots with a training pathway into Tejas operations.

Parallel to this is the HTT-40, India’s indigenously designed basic

trainer. HAL describes it as a tandem-seat, fully aerobatic aircraft equipped with a glass cockpit and an indigenous avionics suite. A second production line for the trainer was inaugurated at Nashik in 2025, underlining the importance of building an indigenous training pipeline alongside combat aircraft production.

The ecosystem extends well beyond airframes. DRDO-developed technologies include radar, electronic warfare, mission computers and life-support systems, while the Astra beyond-visual-range missile has been test-fired from Tejas Mk1, demonstrating the growing integration of Indian aircraft and weapons.

Helicopters add another dimension. HAL’s portfolio spans the Dhruv family, Rudra, LCH Prachand and LUH, giving India experience across utility, armed and combat helicopter categories.

Yet indigenous air power is still a work in progress. Tejas continues to rely on imported propulsion, while production speed and supply-chain capacity remain important challenges.

The larger achievement, therefore, is the emergence of a connected industrial base. The IAF is not merely receiving Indian-made aircraft; its requirements are helping create markets for Indian designers, manufacturers, MSMEs and technology developers. The next test will be whether this ecosystem can move from individual programmes to sustained, globally competitive aerospace capability.

“Lockheed Martin is proud of its longstanding partnership of seven decades with the Indian Armed Forces. We congratulate the Indian Air Force (IAF) on its 94th anniversary and remain steadfast in our commitment of being the partner of choice in its modernization journey. It has been our privilege to continue working with the IAF and supporting its fleet of 12 C-130J-30 Super Hercules aircraft. We are focused to further grow and strengthen this partnership with India as part of our unprecedented MTA offering for the Indian Air Force.”

Michael Fernandez, Country Head, Lockheed Martin India

Beyond the Fighter:
Can India Build the Technologies
of Tomorrow’s Air Power?

India’s aerospace ambition is entering a decisive phase. The next challenge is no longer simply to manufacture more aircraft, but to master the technologies that will define future air combat, stealth, autonomous systems, artificial intelligence, advanced propulsion, sensors and software-driven avionics.

At the centre of this effort is the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA), India’s planned fifth-generation fighter. Its development is intended to bring together stealth, advanced avionics, electronic warfare, internal weapons carriage and network-centric capabilities. More importantly, the programme is being structured to draw private industry into prototype development, potentially widening India’s high-end aerospace industrial base.

The future battlefield, however, will not belong to fighters alone. Defence Research and Development Organisation’s (DRDO) technology roadmap includes autonomous navigation, computer vision, autonomous target identification, edge AI and manned-unmanned teaming. Its work on autonomous UAVs and swarm technologies points towards an air force increasingly built around networks of crewed and uncrewed platforms rather than individual aircraft.

Propulsion remains a critical frontier. The Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR) and National Aerospace Laboratories (NAL) has developed the NJ-100 small gas-turbine engine for applications including tactical UAVs and compact cruise missiles, while its NJ-5 has

already reached flight-tested, production-ready status for micro-UAV applications. These developments demonstrate progress in technologies ranging from high-speed turbomachinery to miniature combustion systems.

The larger challenge is turning individual breakthroughs into an integrated technology ecosystem. India will need sustained investment in advanced materials, semiconductor technologies, sensors, secure communications, flight software, AI computing and above all high-performance aircraft engines.

AMCA can become more than another fighter programme. It can become the platform around which India develops the industrial and technological capabilities needed to move from a major defence manufacturer to a global aerospace technology power.

AMCA can become more than another fighter programme. It can become the platform around which India develops the industrial and technological capabilities needed to move from a major defence manufacturer to a global aerospace technology power.





“MBDA views India as a cornerstone of our global industrial strategy. While our history was built on a supplier-customer relationship, our future is about synergy.

We are transitioning into a partnership of equals, focusing on co-development and co-production to drive innovation together.”

Ludovic Dumont, General Delegate, MBDA India

“Embraer proudly joins the nation in celebrating Indian Air Force Day. We salute the courage, professionalism and excellence of the men and women of the Indian Air Force, who stand ready every day to protect India's skies and support the nation. We are honoured to be part of the IAF's journey through programmes such as Netra Airborne Early Warning & Control (AEW&C) Systems and look forward to continuing our partnership in advancing India's aerospace capabilities.”

Bosco da Costa Junior, President and CEO of Embraer Defense & Security

“The United Engine Corporation of the Rostec State Corporation has a wide range of power units. UEC products are aimed at both the domestic market and foreign markets. The Corporation is actively developing cooperation with India. We have been working with our colleagues to master engine production for over 50 years.

At international exhibitions in India, UEC has repeatedly demonstrated its advanced developments – the PD-8 for short-haul Superjet aircraft, the TV7-117ST-01 for regional Il-114-300, and the VK-650V for light helicopters. The range of engines certified in Russia also includes the serial PD-14 for the medium-haul MC-21.

We can see great potential in the development of civilian programs, especially given the discussion of projects to localize Russian aircraft in India. The issue is at an early stage of discussion, but we are ready to consider various formats of cooperation for the localization of the latest engines with the involvement of industrial partners in India, including in the format of joint ventures.”

Andrey Tereshniuk, Deputy General Director for Sales and Service, UEC

IAF pushes indigenous engines, faster fighter inductions amid squadron shortage

The Indian Air Force is pushing for faster development of indigenous fighter engines while also seeking quicker aircraft inductions to address a persistent shortage of fighter squadrons.

At his annual press conference ahead of Air Force Day, Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh stressed that building a domestic aerospace ecosystem, including indigenous propulsion, is essential for India's long-term self-reliance.

Responding to media queries, he said engine development would take time and require sustained national effort. And described indigenous programmes as critical to creating a foundation for future combat aircraft. The IAF has also been supporting efforts to integrate Indian weapons and systems onto its platforms.

The immediate concern, however, remains the shrinking fighter fleet. According to the chief, delays in aircraft induction were hurting the force, particularly following the retirement of MiG-21s.

The IAF needs to induct around 36-40 fighter aircraft annually over the next few years to arrest the decline and eventually move towards its sanctioned strength of 42 squadrons.

Drones Are Changing the Indian Air Force

BETTER SURVEILLANCE | PRECISION STRIKES | ENHANCED FORCE MULTIPLIER | NETWORKED OPERATIONS | GREATER SELF-RELIANCE

The Indian Air Force's drone fleet is evolving from a supporting surveillance tool into an increasingly important element of modern air power.

The experience of recent conflicts has shown that drones can provide persistent surveillance, precision-strike options and new ways of conducting warfare. For the IAF, therefore, the drone is no longer simply an aircraft without a pilot, it is becoming a key part of how India intends to see, target and fight in the skies of the future.

Israeli-origin Searcher II and Heron UAVs have been used for years for reconnaissance, while the IAF has also inducted four Heron Mk II medium-altitude, long-endurance drones.

The Heron Mk II can remain airborne for up to 45 hours and is equipped for long-range observation, electronic intelligence and communications-related missions.

INDIAN AIR FORCE NO.3 AMONG NATIONAL AIR POWERS

1 UNITED STATES AIR FORCE	2 RUSSIAN AIR FORCE	3 INDIAN AIR FORCE	4 CHINESE AIR FORCE
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1,716 AIRCRAFT	542 COMBAT & RETACK AIRCRAFT	5th CONSECUTIVE YEAR
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The IAF's success is based on a range of factors, including:

- Fast quality and service
- Reliability
- Superior support
- Risk and policy capability
- Dependability and other elements

India's bigger challenge, however, is building its own high-end unmanned systems. Defence Research and Development Organisation's (DRDO) TAPAS-BH-201, earlier known as Rustom-II, was conceived as an indigenous MALE drone for intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance. It has completed extensive flight testing, but struggled to meet the armed forces' original requirement of operating at 30,000 feet for more than 24 hours. DRDO has continued work on improving the platform rather than abandoning the broader effort to develop indigenous MALE UAV technology.

The next step is potentially more ambitious. DRDO's Archer-NG is being developed as an armed unmanned platform capable of carrying weapons, while India is also exploring larger combat and high-altitude unmanned systems.

“India is one of Russia's closest partners. Cooperation between our countries is strategic and strengthens every year.

Russian-Indian technological cooperation in the field of combat aviation began in the 1960s. Since then, India has successfully mastered production of various Russian aircraft, including the Su-30MKI fighter jet, which today forms the backbone of the Indian Air Force.

This 60-year partnership has demonstrated Russia's reliability and openness to technology transfer. This successful experience will significantly facilitate the implementation of new joint initiatives in full compliance with the Make in India program.

Today, Rosoboronexport is proposing cooperation on a number of promising projects, including aircraft manufacturing, which will enable the Indian Air Force to secure a long-term strategic advantage in the region and significantly strengthen the country's defense capability.

I sincerely congratulate the Indian Air Force on this holiday!”

Alexander Mikheev, Director General of Rosoboronexport

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Lunch, protest, detention: Opp says CEC has to resign

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, October 7

THE DRAMATIC events on Wednesday started off rather innocuously with a lunch for Opposition INDIA bloc leaders hosted by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge at the Sagar Ratna restaurant in Janpath in central Delhi.

While the police outside the restaurant prepared to stall any movement of the MPs, the mood inside was full of optimism. The leaders of the INDIA bloc spoke of how they were moving ahead in the “right direction” and that the government was on the “back foot”. Most of the leaders belonging to South Indian states ordered dishes associated with North Indian states, while those from the North and other parts of the country ordered what is broadly clubbed as “South Indian cuisine”, sources said. The variety on the plates ranged from idli and dosa to uttupam and North Indian and South Indian *thalis*.

Twelve leaders sat on the main table, including the Gandhi siblings, Kharge, K C Venugopal, RJD’s Manoj Jha, IUML’s E T Mohammed Basheer, CPI’s P Sandosh Kumar, CPI(M)’s John Brittas, and representatives of other parties. Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi shared with others the food he had ordered, said those present.

Following the lunch, the MPs exited the restaurant and announced to the media that had gathered outside that they would make their way to Jantar Mantar in three deluxe buses parked outside to keep up the pressure on the government for the second straight day, de-



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, RJD’s Manoj Jha, CPI’s Sandosh Kumar, and TMC’s Derek O’Brien, among other Opposition leaders, exit an eatery in New Delhi on Wednesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

manding that they be allowed to meet Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the Election Commissioners.

The Opposition, it seemed, was prepared for the long haul, stacking the buses with energy drinks, snacks, and plenty of water. As the buses left Janpath and slowly inched towards Jantar Mantar, less than a kilometre away, the word had gone around among Congress workers that the top leadership was heading towards a flash protest. Hundreds of Congress workers joined them, walking alongside the buses.

Soon afterwards, several Congress MPs, including Imran Masood, Deepender Hooda,

Imran Pratapgarhi, and Amrinder Singh Raja Warring of the Congress, climbed atop their bus and waved a Tricolour.

Once the destination was just metres away, the mood changed and became more confrontational as the police stopped the buses from entering the road to Jantar Mantar. The police had already barricaded it and a face-off appeared on the cards. Then came the tipping point, as the situation hurtled towards a skirmish.

Near the Windsor Place roundabout, Congress workers, including those from the party’s student and youth wings, were pushed back as the police tried to stop them from progressing. As several Congress workers

sustained minor injuries in the ensuing melee, those in the buses decided to get down. “How could we stay inside when our workers were being bashed up?” asked an MP.

This, sources said, marked a “change of plan”. “We thought we would sit in the bus till night,” said an Opposition leader.

The parliamentarians led by Rahul Gandhi got off their buses and attempted to begin an impromptu sit-in. Priyanka Gandhi Vadra lay on the road, shielded by other MPs and party workers, while her brother stood guard, pushing back the police personnel attempting to break up the protest. “This is my sister,” he shouted at the police. “He became a shield,” said a Congress MP.

But as it unfolded on Tuesday, both the LoP, Priyanka Gandhi, and other Opposition leaders were eventually pushed into police buses amid allegations that the police used force on them.

Trinamool MP Mahua Moitra sustained injuries to her face and hands, and was seen showing her counterparts that she had been left bloodied.

As the police bus carrying Rahul Gandhi made its way to the Barakhamba police station, some Congress workers punctured one of its tyres. As the police waited for backup, the LoP sent out a video message saying the fight would continue till Gyanesh Kumar resigned.

Priyanka and other MPs and Opposition leaders were taken to far-off Chhatrasal Stadium in Model Town. Eventually, all were released. The INDIA bloc is learnt to be planning another protest on Thursday and has kept the details under wraps.

Nitin Nabin: Rahul fighting for *ghuspaithiyas* whose names were deleted in SIR

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, October 7

BJP NATIONAL president Nitin Nabin claimed on Wednesday that Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, was fighting for “ghuspaithiyas” (infiltrators) whose names were deleted during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Addressing a programme in Varanasi on the conclusion of a motorcycle *yatra* as part of the BJP’s Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, a month-long programme to mark Prime Minister Modi’s 25 years in public office, Nabin said, “Everyone has seen how Opposition leaders are working with anti-social elements to spread anarchy. The people of the country will never allow their objectives and intentions to be fulfilled.”

The Opposition leaders, the BJP chief alleged, were only concerned about those who have been snatching the rights of the people of India. “I want to tell the Leader of Opposition today that the people of the country will never allow you to give rights to those ghuspaithiyas. Who you are concerned about and you are fighting for?” he asked.

“If the names of those ghuspaithiyas are deleted through the SIR and you raise questions on the country’s democracy for that, then the biggest question is on you. The people of the country will give a befitting reply to your anarchist mindset,” Nabin said.

Nabin also praised Modi’s political journey, saying his tenure reflected “service and dedication” and that he has sought



BJP national president Nitin Nabin addresses the concluding ceremony of ‘From Vadanangar to Varanasi’ bike rally, in Varanasi on Wednesday. ANI

to unite the country around the principles of *Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas and Sabka Prayas*.

He credited Modi with realising former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee’s vision of a model of good governance.

“I believe that today’s youth will fully realise the prime minister’s dream,” he said.

Nabin congratulated the Uttar Pradesh BJP leadership and the party’s youth wing for organising a motorcycle journey. Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma too attacked Rahul, saying, “As long as there is the power of Sanatan in India, you (Gandhi) cannot harm even a hair of Narendra Modi’s head.”

“There was a time when even Parliament was attacked; people from Pakistan would come, and terrorists would enter our country and attack our Parliament. But today Pakistan does not enter India; India enters Pakistan and destroys it. This is our leadership,” he

added. Sarma also referred to the construction of the Ram temple in Ayodhya, saying that people had once stopped believing that a temple would be built at the site of the Babri Masjid.

“But today, under the PM’s leadership, we drove away Babur and built the Ram temple,” Sarma said, adding, “If Babar and Aurangzeb are hidden under the soil today, the reason is Narendra Modi.”

The BJP would remain in power in Delhi, UP, Gujarat and Assam for another 50 years, he claimed.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, BJP state president Pankaj Chaudhary, Deputy Chief Ministers Keshav Prasad Maurya and Brajesh Pathak, as well as Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM) president and Vadodara Lok Sabha MP Hemang Joshi were among those present at the programme.

— WITH PTI INPUTS

First Response

WHILE THE INDIA bloc is learnt to have been in touch with the President of India’s office for a meeting to discuss issues related to the functioning of the Election Commission, CPIM Rajya Sabha MP from Keralam, John Brittas, has received a reply to a complaint he had sent to the Rashtrapati Bhavan on the same matter. Brittas has got an acknowledgement from the office of the President, also copied to the Legislative Department, Ministry of Law and Justice. Brittas, it is learnt, has been told to communicate with the Legislative Department.

Home Food

UNION TOURISM and Culture Minister Gajendra Shekhawat, who is visiting Malta for a global summit on tourism, could savour the taste of his home state Rajasthan even 6,000 km away. Chefs at a new Indian restaurant called Tanvi curated an Indian platter with Rajasthani specialities while hosting the minister for dinner upon his arrival.

Live Session

All Central government officials were on Wednesday morning requested to attend an hour-long live stream — “Sadhna Samvad” — a fireside chat between NITI Aayog member R Balasubramanian and Swami Bodhmayananda of Ramakrishna Mission, offering perspectives on service delivery to the people. The recording of the session was streamed repeatedly throughout the day for those who could not attend it live. Senior bureaucrats, ministry officials, security staff, and police officers in good numbers attended the session.

Punjab: SC sets aside polls in 50 wards, orders re-elections in six weeks

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 7

THE SUPREME Court has set aside the elections to 50 wards in Punjab after a fact-finding commission appointed by it found “widespread obstruction during the nomination process, whereby nomination papers were snatched, torn or destroyed, and candidates were assaulted, detained or threatened” in the local body polls.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joyymalya Bagchi and V Mohana ordered fresh elections in 50 wards — 28 in Patiala district and 22 in Moga. “...the Commission found 50 ward elections to be vitiated and deserving of being set aside. We accept the recommendations and direct that fresh elections be conducted in the relevant 50 wards...The entire process of re-election shall be completed within 6 weeks,” the bench ordered. In the September 28 order, which was made available Wednesday, the bench took note of the fact that Kapil Sibal, appearing for the State of Punjab “states that the State has no objection to the acceptance of the recommendations made by the Commission”.

To ensure that re-elections are conducted in a free, fair, and transparent manner, the top court asked the Chief Justice of the Punjab to appoint, within one week, a monitoring committee comprising a retired judge of the HC to oversee the process.

DMK’s dilemma: Rahul’s EC protest faces support, flak

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 7

MONTHS AFTER the Congress walked into the C Joseph Vijay-led TVK camp to form the government in Tamil Nadu, the DMK is blowing hot and cold on Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi over his campaign against the Election Commission (EC).

While a section of the DMK has sharpened its attacks on Gandhi, a marked contrast that reflects the changed relationship between the two parties, another section has “defended” the LoP’s right to protest.

DMK spokesperson Saravanan Annadurai on Wednesday cited a media report on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls to question why Gandhi, who has forcefully raised allegations of electoral manipulation elsewhere, had not spoken similarly about Tamil Nadu.

According to Annadurai, the TVK won 84 of the 135 constituencies where more than 20,000 voters were deleted and all 10 constituencies where deletions exceeded 80,000. The figures and the claim about their electoral effect were cited by Annadurai from the media report — the inputs provided do not include an EC’s response to them.

Senior DMK leader TK S Elangovan, however, defended the Congress leader’s right to protest. “It is the right of citizens to fight against the government’s wrongdoings. That is what Rahul Gandhi did yesterday,” Elangovan said on Wednesday. He also demanded Kumar’s removal and fresh elections in states where, he alleged, the electoral process had been compromised.

The apparent contradiction is partly explained by the political rearrangement since Tamil Nadu’s April election. The DMK subsequently left the Congress-led INDIA bloc. The TVK now governs with support from Congress and other smaller parties.

That has given the dispute over electoral rolls another layer. The DMK and Congress may still attack the same institution over the SIR, but they now approach Tamil Nadu from opposite sides of the political field.

The DMK leaders’ reactions came as Gandhi and other Opposition leaders intensified their confrontation with the EC in New Delhi. On Tuesday, Gandhi was detained at Akashvani Bhavan after police stopped Opposition MPs from marching to the poll body’s office. He also staged a nine-hour sit-in.

Yogi says it’s 80-20 NDA-PDA fight, Akhilesh Yadav hits back

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, October 7

A DAY after the Samajwadi Party (SP) decided not to field a third candidate in Rajya Sabha elections from UP, paving the way for the party’s two nominees and the ruling BJP’s eight candidates to get elected to the Upper House unopposed, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Wednesday said that the next year’s Assembly election has once again become a “NDA 80 and PDA 20” fight, triggering sharp reactions from the Opposition party.

Addressing ‘Seva Jyoti Yatra-Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha’ to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years of public life, in Lucknow, Adityanath said, “*Kal Uttar Pradesh ke Rajya Sabha ke chunav ne bata diya hai ki Vidhan Sabha ka chunav parinaam kya hone ja raha hai. Yeh ladai 80/20 ki fir aa gai hai. 80 fidsi NDA me, aur 20 fidsi PDA me. Aur PDA ka kya haal hone wala hai, yeh aapke saamne fir aane wala hai.*” (Yesterday, the Rajya Sabha elections in UP have foretold what will be the results of the Assembly election. The fight has once again become about 80 and 20: 80 per cent in NDA and 20 per cent in PDA. PDA’s fate will be before everyone.)”

Soon after, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav hit out at the chief minister over his remark on PDA, accusing the BJP government of threatening and targeting the ‘Pichhda, Dalit, Alpsankhyak’ (backward, Dalit, and minority) communities.

In a post on X, Yadav said the chief minister, in his “usual threatening tone”, admitted that the “harassment of PDA” would not stop under his government.

“This means that the atrocities and injustice of the BJP government against the ‘victimised, distressed and humiliated’ as well as the ‘backward, Dalit, minorities, half the population, and tribals’ are going to increase further,” he said.

Yadav posted a clip of the chief minister’s address, in



Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and Akie Abe, wife of former Japan PM, late Shinzo Abe, during the inauguration ceremony of the Abe Memorial Corridor in Varanasi, on Wednesday. PTI

which he says, “...what is going to happen to the PDA will again be before you.” Yadav said the “five-second confession threatening the PDA” would ensure that those involved in its suppression would not be able to “raise their heads and meet its eyes” for decades.

“When the honourable chief minister sees ‘PDA-PDA’ all the time, whether asleep or awake, our advice is: why not get ‘PDA’ written on 108 beads, make a rosary and chant ‘PDA’? At least some of his sins will be reduced,” the former UP chief minister said.

He alleged that the chief minister’s remarks were a result of the BJP’s “defeat” in the 2024 Lok Sabha election.

which he says, “...what is going to happen to the PDA will again be before you.” Yadav said the “five-second confession threatening the PDA” would ensure that those involved in its suppression would not be able to “raise their heads and meet its eyes” for decades.

“When the honourable chief minister sees ‘PDA-PDA’ all the time, whether asleep or awake, our advice is: why not get ‘PDA’ written on 108 beads, make a rosary and chant ‘PDA’? At least some of his sins will be reduced,” the former UP chief minister said.

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In Keralam, IUML elevates Hindu leader as state vice-president

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 7

AT A time when it faces Opposition allegations of communal polarisation and a push towards conservatism from within the Muslim community, Kerala’s United Democratic Alliance ally has made an unprecedented move — elevating a Hindu leader to one of its top positions. On Wednesday, the IUML announced that 61-year-old C Syam Sundar was its new state vice-president as part of its organisational reshuffle.

A former state leader of the Democratic Youth Federation

of India, the youth wing of the Communist Party of India, Syam, a prominent Nair leader from central Keralam, has been with the IUML since 2010. The decision comes after the IUML divested all ministers and legislators of various organisational roles. Speaking to the media after his elevation, Syam said he was “happy with the new responsibility”.

“I’m the first non-Muslim to become the state vice president of the IUML. I have been with the party since 2010 and started my journey with the IUML as a local party worker. Over the last 15 years, the party has given me various roles, which I have dis-



C Syam Sundar is a former leader of the CPI’s youth wing

charged with utmost sincerity,” he said.

For the party, picking Syam

for one of its top positions assumes significance, especially given the timing. The party finds itself in a difficult position — while the CPI (M) accuses it of communal polarisation, the IUML is also having to defend conservative positions amid growing pressure from Muslim clerics.

Who is C Syam

Syam belongs to a prominent upper-caste Hindu Nair political family from Alappuzha — the state’s first Assembly Speaker, R Sankara Narayanan Thambi, was his uncle.

At the IUML, Syam has been given charge of the Idukki and

Pathanamthitta districts, where the party does not have a significant presence.

Although this is the first time a Hindu leader has taken a prominent position in the IUML, the party has had non-Muslim leaders and electoral candidates in the past.

Last year, the outfit inducted Jayanthi Rajan, a Dalit woman, as a national assistant secretary, with the party even fielding her from the CPI(M) stronghold of Koothuparamba in this Assembly election. Although Jayanthi lost the election, she had managed to put up a formidable fight against the Left.

The IUML also backed a young Christian leader from the Congress, V S Joy, in the election in Thavanoor in Muslim-majority Malappuram. The support helped Joy beat the CPI(M)-backed independent and four-term MLA K T Jaleel in a seat where the Christian vote bank accounted for only 1.4 per cent of the total electorate.

For the election, IUML put its organisational machinery behind Joy, a non-Catholic Christian who had earlier struggled to find acceptance in Catholic-dominated constituencies when the Congress decided to field him there.

Now, Mithun Chakraborty is cultural adviser to Bengal govt



Mithun Chakraborty

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, October 7

THE WEST Bengal government on Wednesday appointed veteran actor and BJP leader Mithun Chakraborty as a cultural advisor with the rank of a Cabinet Minister.

He has been appointed as an advisor in the Information and Culture Department with immediate effect, as per a recent notification issued by the Personnel and Administrative Reforms Department.

The notification stated, “The Governor is pleased to appoint Shri Mithun Chakraborty as Advisor to the Government of West Bengal in the rank of Cabinet Minister in the Information and Cultural Affairs Department, with an immediate effect and until further order.”

The administrative circles believe that the scope of his responsibilities and his specific role as an advisor would become clear in the next steps.

According to sources in Nabanna, Mithun will take charge of the new post very soon.

At present, the veteran actor is in Alipurduar for a shooting assignment. From there, Mithun has thanked Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari for entrusting him with this new responsibility.

The Suwendu-led state government had also sought his advice during the centenary celebrations of Uttam Kumar, apart from areas such as tourism.

The veteran actor had joined the BJP in 2021. He also had a brief stint with the Trinamool Congress when Mamata Banerjee had nominated him for Rajya Sabha in 2014. However, he resigned from the Upper House in 2016.



Mathura gurukul tragedy: Four students die after inhaling toxic gas

Lucknow: Four students died after inhaling suspected poisonous gas inside an unused water tank at a gurukul in Mathura's Vrindavan late Tuesday night, when a group of students went into the tank to investigate a foul smell, police said.

Two owners of Maharishi Pannini Sanskrit Gurukulam have been taken into custody.

Mathura SSP Shlok Kumar, said the students initially tried to get rid of the smell by removing the small amount of water inside the unused, 15ft deep water tank with a bucket. One of the students then volunteered to go inside. Four others went down one after another in an attempt to bring him out. All of them fell unconscious. They were all rushed to the hospital.

SSP Kumar said they are waiting for families of the victims to file a complaint so they can register a case. **ENS**

Indian Oil official stabbed to death while sealing petrol pump, 4 held

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, October 7

AN INDIAN Oil Corporation (IOC) field officer was allegedly stabbed seven times and killed during an altercation while he was attempting to seal a non-functional petrol pump in Maharshtia's Hingoli district on Tuesday evening. Police have arrested four people, including a woman and her son, in connection with the murder and are searching for a fifth suspect.

The IOC officer was identified as Mahesh Shelke, 37. He worked as Manager (Retail Sales) and Field Officer with IOC and was posted in Nanded North.

According to police, Shelke, along with three to four members of his team, went to the Sai Umesh petrol pump in Ambachondi village in Basmat tehsil around 4.30 pm on Tues-

day to carry out official action to take over and seal the retail outlet. The pump had remained closed for nearly three months but had recently resumed operations.

Police said the petrol pump owner was not present at the spot. However, his wife, son and some others were present when the IOC team arrived. An argument broke out between the officials and the owner's family members and others at the site. The situation escalated when the group allegedly began pelting stones at the officials, said a senior police officer.

During the confrontation, Umesh Pandvir, 24, allegedly attacked Shelke with a knife and stabbed him seven times in the abdomen, chest and back. Shelke sustained serious injuries and died on the spot. The accused allegedly fled the scene

“The safety, dignity and security of our energy-sector personnel, who work tirelessly to serve the nation, remain paramount”

HARDEEP SINGH PURI,
MINISTER OF PETROLEUM AND NATURAL GAS.

following the attack, said another officer.

Police registered a murder case on Wednesday. A police team was formed to trace those involved, and four suspects were arrested within 12 hours.

The arrested accused have been identified as Umesh

Pandvir; his mother, Lata Sahebabrao, 46; Shravan Gangadhar Wakude, 24; and another person who is also a friend of the Pandvir family. Police said they have received information about the involvement of a fifth accused and a team has been sent to apprehend him.

Police are investigating the circumstances that led to the confrontation and the exact motive behind the attack.

The Indian Oil Officers' Association (IOOA) and IOC have demanded a swift and impartial investigation and strict action against those responsible for Shelke's killing.

“The issue has been taken up with the senior-most officials of the Maharashtra Government and Police to ensure swift and strict action against those responsible, in accordance with law. The safety, dig-

nity and security of our energy-sector personnel, who work tirelessly to serve the nation, remain paramount,” Petroleum Minister Hardeep Puri said on social media platform X.

The incident bears a striking similarity to the 2005 murder of Shanmugam Manjunath, a 27-year-old IOC sales officer who was allegedly shot dead in Uttar Pradesh after taking action against petrol pumps allegedly involved in selling adulterated fuel.

Manjunath had ordered the sealing of two petrol pumps in Lakhimpur Kheri for three months. After one of the outlets allegedly resumed operations illegally, he conducted a surprise inspection and was shot dead in November 2005. His body, bearing six bullet wounds, was later found in the back seat of his car.

• BRIEFLY



Police officers at the crash site in Sultanpur on Wednesday. PTI

UTTAR PRADESH

3 tennis players killed, 3 injured as car rams truck on expressway

THREE TENNIS players were killed and an equal injured when the car they were traveling in rammed a truck's behind on the Purvanchal Expressway on Wednesday, police said. The accident took place around 5.30 am in the Dhanpatganj Police Station area, when the car, allegedly, at around 100 kmph, carrying the six players crashed into the rear of the truck, they said. The players were returning to Deoria after participating in a sporting event in Lucknow. The impact left the car mangled, trapping the occupants inside. Police, with the help of locals, broke open the doors and extricated them. All six were taken to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared three of them dead, the police said. PTI

BSF woman dies of gunshot fired from own rifle

A 27-YEAR-OLD woman constable of the BSF died of a gunshot wound received from her service rifle at a forward border post near the International Border in R S Pura Sector on Wednesday, officials said. Constable Raj Lakshmi sustained a gunshot wound at Border Outpost Sushil at around 3 pm. The circumstances leading to the firing are yet to be ascertained, officials said. She was provided initial treatment at Sub-District Hospital in R S Pura before being referred to Government Medical College Hospital, Jammu. Doctors declared her dead on arrival, officials said. PTI

Dhami offers prayers at Kashi Vishwanath

TO MARK Prime Minister Narendra Modi completing 25 years in public life, Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami Wednesday offered prayers at the Kashi Vishwanath temple in Uttarkashi. Dhami said the 25 years have been marked by dedication to national service, public welfare and the country's development. Dhami announced on Wednesday plans to develop a corridor connecting the Kashi Vishwanath and Maa Shakti temples. He also said he would send a proposal for a Kendriya Vidyalaya in Bhatwari to the Central Government. **ENS**

India calls for de-escalation after Black Sea vessel attacks

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 7

AFTER FOUR commercial ships with Indian seafarers were attacked in the Black Sea in less than 36 hours, India on Wednesday once again called for dialogue and diplomacy to de-escalate tensions and enable early return of peace to the region.

“The targeting of commercial shipping and seafarers in the region must end, and free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through the international waterways must be restored at the earliest,” the Ministry of External (MEA) official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on Wednesday.

“We have seen a string of attacks targeting commercial vessels in the Black Sea region. We condemn such attacks that threaten commercial shipping and endanger the lives of our seafaring community,” he said.

Listing out four incidents, he said the commercial vessel *MV Royad Mamnadov* came under attack while it was plying in the Black Sea. “There were three Indian nationals onboard. One of them was injured and has since received medical treatment,” he said, adding that the Indian embassy in Romania is in touch with them for their safety and welfare. “We thank the Romanian authorities for their support and swift action,” he said.

“A Togo-flagged ship, *Alfa Watan*, was attacked yesterday and the fate of its crew is unknown,” he said. “Another vessel, Palau-flagged *MV ABLE*, came under a drone attack, but fortunately all its 18 crew, including 7 Indian nationals, have been rescued. One Indian national suffered injuries and is under medical supervision,” MEA spokesperson said, and thanked the Bulgarian authorities for their timely help. “Our Mission in Bulgaria is offering all possible assistance to our seafarers,” he said.

“The fourth ship which came under attack is the Liberia-flagged *Aframax Rio*, an oil tanker. All the crew, consisting of 23 Indian seafarers, have been rescued,” he said.

The Liberia-flagged vessel carrying oil, with a crew of 23 Indian nationals, came under attack by drone boats off Russia's Black Sea coast, Russian authorities said. “The crew has been saved and evacuated to shore,” a spokesman for the Russian transport ministry told state-run TASS news agency.

The *Aframax Rio* tanker came under attack on Tuesday by unmanned surface vessels (USVs), and open fire is raging in the Black Sea waters, the Russian transport ministry said.

The ministry said the vessel's all Indian crew of 23 was saved and none was hurt. The incident took place near Sochi, Russia's resort city on the Black Sea coast. When asked about the Indian proposal to end Russia-Ukraine conflict, the MEA spokesperson said, “On the issue of the Ukraine conflict, India has consistently maintained that dialogue and diplomacy are the way forward.

In Moscow, “Indeed, India is declaring readiness to make a feasible contribution to resolving the situation surrounding Ukraine,” Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov, on Wednesday, was quoted as saying by state-run TASS news agency.

His statement came days after Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha described India's proposal for a possible ceasefire as the “broadest” among four offers received by Kyiv.

EXPRESS special

Jharkhand woman runs 1,600 m barefoot in a saree for Home Guard job

Kumari finishes practice race in 8 minutes, earning ‘Excellent’ grade

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, October 7

EVERYONE IN the stadium started clapping and hooting as soon as a woman in a blue saree, tucked at the waist, removed her slippers and ran barefoot to finish a 1,600-metre run. Someone watching the trial run amid the Home Guard recruitment shot a video, focusing on the woman as she passed other candidates one by one. It went viral on social media.

The woman is Kavita Kumari, a widow from Jharkhand for whom a Home Guard job could spell a change in fortunes. Kumari starts her day with an early-morning practice run on uneven ground near her village, Soso, in Ramgarh district.

On October 4, she travelled to Sidhu Kanhu Stadium for a free trial conducted by an academy run by athletes, where candidates could get a sense of the ground and assess their fitness in conditions closer to those they would face in the recruitment test. The same stadium is scheduled to host the physical test for the Home Guard recruitment from October 24 to November 5.

Kumari, clad in a saree and chappals, was among those who showed up. “I was very nervous as soon as I reached the stadium. People were looking at me in a saree, and I was looking at them in tracksuits with bags, bottles and shoes on their feet. This just made me uncomfortable, but I took part in the run,” she said.

To pass the running test in the female category, a candidate has to run 1,600 metres in 10 minutes. Kumari said she completed it within eight minutes,



Kavita Kumari, 30, works as a labourer at a brick kiln. EXPRESS

earning an ‘Excellent’ grade with full marks.

“Till people applauded me, I had no idea about what I had done. I just removed my chappal and started running barefoot. While I was running, I had no thoughts other than the Home Guard job. Someone took my video and posted it on social media... I hope I will run with the same energy and confidence on the physical exam day,” she said.

Ankit Singh (25), who runs Ankit Runner Academy in Ramgarh and organised the October 4 trial, said the purpose was not merely to conduct a practice run but to familiarise candidates with the stadium. The ground, he said, has a slope on one side, with portions that are sandy, gravelly and uneven.

“Candidates need to know how the ground behaves before the actual physical test. That is why many of them come from 15 to 20 kilometres away to practice here. That day, around 1,900 candidates took part, including nearly 1,100 women. Many of the women came from rural areas, and some wore sarees. There were around 50 to 60 women in sarees that day,” he said.

He said that for women from

rural areas, wearing a tracksuit and running shoes and going out to practise is not always easy.

The notification for Jharkhand Home Guard recruitment was issued in April this year, with 284 vacancies in Ramgarh district against more than 16,000 applications. The first phase of the recruitment includes a physical test comprising a 1,600-metre run, long jump, high jump and shot put, following which the written examination will be conducted.

The recruitment also reserves 50 per cent of the overall posts for women, with 5 per cent reserved for widows.

A long list of misfortunes

Kumari said she got married in 2009 while she was a minor. Now around 30, she lost her husband, Deepak Kumar Mahato, three years ago. Deepak was a migrant worker in Gujarat after working in Mumbai, she said.

“During Covid, he was unwell, and he returned home. He continuously fell sick and died in 2023. I had to look after my in-laws, maintain the home and children and run the home financially,” she said.

Six months after Deepak's

death, the family also lost his younger brother. “My sister-in-law left home after her husband's death,” she said.

Kumari told *The Indian Express* that the family has a debt of around Rs 6 lakh after spending a substantial amount on treatment.

She said she worked as a security guard at private offices in Ramgarh town but left the job as her shifts ended late and she could not find transport back to her village.

Now she works as a labourer, mostly at a brick kiln, to repay the debt and support her two children, who study at a private school in Ramgarh.

While preparing for the physical test, Kumari said she relied on YouTube to learn and practice. “I ask my children to open YouTube and play the videos for me, as I hardly know how to use it. I watch the videos and prepare for the exam. I do not have a single penny to spend on dresses, shoes or tuition fees...,” she said.

After the video reached a wider audience, several people and politicians reached out to support her. Dumri MLA Jairam Kumar Mahato spoke to Kumari over the phone and sent her a tracksuit and running shoes.

Ajay Karmali (38), a Home Guard posted in Ramgarh, is Kumari's coach and runs the HMT Physical Academy in Dulmi, about 5 km from her village. He started the academy around four or five months ago, offering free physical training to villagers. Kumari found him through his social media posts and called him to ask if she could join.

Karmali said he encouraged her to run at the stadium before the recruitment test so that she could become familiar with the ground and gain confidence. “Though she did not have a running uniform, she hopes that she will soon get the Home Guard uniform,” he said.

• FOR NOW, THE SYSTEM WILL BE RESTRICTED TO WEEKENDS, WHEN THE SHRINE SEES THE LARGEST FOOTFALLS; LATEST SURGE DRIVEN BY END OF MONSOON SEASON AND RELEASE OF ‘HANUMAN ANSH’ FILM

Kainchi Dham to get Char Dham-style registration system amid visitor surge

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 7

THE NAINITAL district administration is set to introduce a registration system for pilgrims visiting Kainchi Dham, initially on weekends, as the Kumaon shrine grapples with a sharp rise in visitors and traffic congestion, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The proposed system will be modelled on the registration mechanism used for Uttarakhand's Char Dham pilgrimage and is expected to allow the administration to know in advance how many devotees are expected at the shrine on a given day and regulate the flow when crowds swell.

Currently, there is no registration requirement to visit Kainchi Dham. Pilgrims can arrive at the shrine and enter for *darshan* without any prior registration.

Nainital District Magistrate Lalit Mohan Rayal told *The Indian Express* Wednesday that a joint report by him and the Senior Superintendent of Police will be sent to the state government's Tourism Department recommending the system.

“The proposal is to introduce registration at Kainchi Dham, similar to what is done for Char Dham,” Rayal told *The Indian Express*. “A joint report of the DM and SSP will be sent to the government.”

The proposal was discussed at a meeting involving the district administration, police and other stakeholders, including the temple committee and taxi union on Tuesday.

For now, the administration plans to restrict the system to weekends, when the shrine sees its largest crowds.

“We will keep it for weekends,” Rayal said. “Later, when the regular season comes, we

will assess the expected crowd and implement it according to the estimated footfall.”

“It will take about a month for the government to develop the portal and everything else,” he said, adding that the administration would seek to “replicate” the existing Char Dham model at Kainchi.

The Char Dham registration system the administration is looking to replicate runs through Uttarakhand's Tourist Care portal and mobile application. Pilgrims first create an account, then create a tour by entering their travel dates, number of pilgrims, and the Dhams they intend to visit, along with the dates they plan to visit each shrine. They then enter the required details of each pilgrim.

Once registration is complete, pilgrims receive a Yatra Registration Letter with a QR code, which they must keep with



Heavy traffic on the route leading to Nainital, Bhimtal and Kainchi Dham during the October 2 weekend. ANI

them. At the destination, designated counters at the shrine verify the registration. The official system describes registration and verification as compulsory for the Char Dham and Hemkund Sahib pilgrimage.

Individuals, families, and tour operators can use the system. Pilgrims can register on-

line through the portal or mobile application; physical registration facilities and assistance through “Yatri Mitra” are also available.

The Char Dham system also allows pilgrims to obtain *darshan* slot tokens, while vehicle registration is part of the system for those travelling by per-

sonal or public vehicles.

The Kainchi administration proposes to adapt this broad framework, rather than simply asking pilgrims to provide their names at the temple gate.

The proposal follows an unprecedented surge in visitors to the shrine, associated with spiritual leader Neem Karoli Baba.

Rayal said the administration normally expects around 25,000 visitors a day at Kainchi Dham. During the long weekend beginning October 2, however, the daily footfall crossed 35,000. The extra visitors overwhelmed the road connecting Kainchi with Bhowali and Mukteshwar. “Both the pilgrims and the locals use the same road to Kainchi, which also goes up to Mukteshwar, causing a traffic jam for hours,” Rayal said.

The congestion stretched through Bhimtal, Bhowali and Kainchi over the long weekend,

with vehicles crawling for kilometres and journeys taking hours longer than usual.

The administration is now pursuing crowd management and additional road capacity.

A key development discussed at the meeting was the proposed alternative route around Kainchi.

Rayal said the Forest Department has now given the required permission for the 18-km Ratighat bypass, which will provide a more direct route towards Almora, Ranikhet and Kausani and help separate traffic from the road leading to Kainchi. “The bypass has received permission from the Forest Department,” Rayal said. “Earlier, the in-principle approval had been given. Now, the practical permission on the ground has also come.”

Around eight kilometres of the bypass have already been hot-mixed, while work remains

on roughly 10 kilometres. Rayal said the state government is currently considering a Rs 21-crore estimate for hot-mixing the remaining stretch.

“There is a discussion in the government today regarding the Rs 21-crore estimate for hot-mixing it,” he said. “Once that is approved, the road should become functional in four to six months.”

According to figures accessed by *The Indian Express*, 24.34 lakh people visited Kainchi Dham in the first six months of 2026, compared with around eight lakh visitors last year.

Rayal attributed the latest surge partly to the end of the monsoon, when tourists who had avoided the hills because of rain and landslides began returning, and partly to the release of *Hanuman Ansh*, a film based on the life and teachings of Neem Karoli Baba.



We don't distinguish between nations in sea operations: Coast Guard chief

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, October 7

DIRECTOR GENERAL of the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) Paramesh Sivamani on Wednesday underscored the force's commitment to saving lives at sea, saying it does not "distinguish between nations" while carrying out an effective search and rescue (SAR) operation.

Speaking to the reporters ahead of the 12th edition of the national level Search and Rescue Exercise (SAREX-2026) to be conducted off Paradip coast on Thursday, he said several nations look up to India in the event of a crisis.

"We have enhanced our capacity, redefined the procedure and fine-tuned standard operating procedure over the years. We have established a very robust system of SAR and all nations in Indian Ocean Region look up to Bharat in case there is a crisis or a volatile situation that requires a SAR," said the ICG chief.

Stating that they have built up the SAR capabilities from scratch, Sivamani said they have ensured that the ICG's prowess of executing a good SAR operation is there for a larger good of humanity. "Whenever there is a crisis and our ships and aircrafts are required to the spot... we do that immediately," he said.

During the inaugural event of SAREX, the ICG chief also emphasised that the future of maritime SAR hinges on advanced technological integration, real-time information sharing, and seamless inter-agency synergy.

Sivamani stressed the imperative for enhanced vessel tracking, robust distress-alert management, data-driven operational decision-making, and accelerated asset mobilisation. He also underscored that operational lessons derived from past missions and multi-agency exercises must directly translate into heightened mission readiness and response capabilities.

The SAREX-2026 exercise will witness participation and observation by 32 delegates from 30 foreign friendly nations.

Leaked papers, cancelled govt exams, no new dates: Protests grow in Maharashtra

Shubham Kurale & Soham Shah
Pune, October 7

RAHUL MAHALE, 29, had a simple plan: give the State Services Main Exam this month, write the Group-B Main in December, exit the long preparation phase finally, and end the monetary drain it caused his parents. Then, his hopes vanished.

Mahale is among the thousands of aspirants sitting for exams conducted by the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC), who have been protesting in Pune — an MPSC exam hub — since October 2.

The exam Mahale was preparing for, having passed the Prelims for the State Civil Services, has been postponed with no new dates announced, since irregularities were found in tests conducted by the MPSC.

"My demand is that the wrongdoers be removed, and the commission adhere to strict exam schedules and transparent conduct," Mahale says. Topping the demand for him and others is resignation of MPSC Chairman Vivek Bhimanwar.

With the government on the backfoot since the NEET paper leak protests, the Opposition, including the Congress, NCP (SP), Maharashtra Navnirman Sena and the Cockroach Janta Party,



Protesters in Pune on Wednesday. ARUL HORIZON

has lent its weight to the MPSC protests. Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil has also spoken up for the aspirants.

Shiv Sena MP Omraje Nimbalkar, a ruling coalition leader, visited the protest site and promised to raise the aspirants' demand to remove the MPSC chief "personally with the CM".

On Monday, in one of its biggest concessions to demands of the aspirants, the Fadnavis government sent a recommendation to Governor Jishnu Dev Varma proposing a committee to examine the conduct of former and incumbent MPSC chairpersons and members.

The CM had earlier said Bhimanwar held a "constitutional" post and hence could not be removed arbitrarily. His recommendation to the Governor was made under Article 317 of the Constitution, which deals with the removal and suspension of chairpersons and members of public service commissions.

On Wednesday, hearing a petition by some Pune residents, the Bombay HC said it was the government's duty to ensure that public recruitment exams are conducted impartially, adding: "If they (students) lack opportunities and (believe) there has been hanky panky, they have the right to agitate. Because they have given hours of study... The protesters are students... not anti-social elements."

On June 12, results were declared for the drug inspector posts exam conducted by the MPSC in March, selecting 506

applicants for the interview round. A little over a month after the results came out, NCP (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar held a press conference claiming that the paper had been leaked.

A month later, the MPSC admitted the irregularities and cancelled the recruitment process on August 25. By then, 488 of the 506 candidates who qualified for interviews had been interviewed, and a provisional merit list of 485 had been released.

Soon after, the MPSC's State Services Main Exam 2025, held in November last year for 139 vacancies, came under scrutiny after its August 25 result short-listed candidates for interviews. Widespread protests alleged irregularities in evaluating descriptive-answer questions, a format introduced only last year, and questioned unusual variations in marks. On September 10, Rohit Pawar held another press conference, where he claimed MPSC chief Bhimanwar was close to Fadnavis, and that his record was marked by several controversies.

Bhimanwar defended himself saying he took charge of the MPSC only in April this year, and that the alleged irregularities predated his tenure.

On September 11, in a further escalation, members of the Maratha outfit Sambhaji Brigade

blackened the face of then MPSC secretary Mahendra Harpalkar at the commission's head office in Navi Mumbai.

On September 28, the MPSC postponed the State Services Main Exam 2026, scheduled to begin October 3, citing requests from aspirants, parents, student groups and elected representatives. It also ordered a re-evaluation of 2025 answer sheets and deferred the Maharashtra Civil Engineering and Group-B Main exams, without announcing new dates.

By mid-August, CM Fadnavis had already announced a complete review of the MPSC system. As part of this, a seven-member committee was asked to visit each Revenue Division, consult students, representatives of educational institutions and other stakeholders, and submit a report by the end of the year. With tempers rising, on October 2, the government transferred Harpalkar.

While the government seems to have relented on its position regarding Bhimanwar now, the protesters are also divided over their main demands. If for one group, the main thing is the MPSC chief's removal, another wants the descriptive pattern of exams scrapped, while yet another opposes any return to the objective format.

Average size of vertebrate populations declined 73% in 52 yrs: WWF

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, October 7

THE AVERAGE size of monitored vertebrate — mammals, fish, birds and amphibians — populations declined 73% over 52 years between 1970 and 2022, according to the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) biennial Living Planet Report, 2026.

As part of the Living Planet Index (LPI), average changes in the size of wild populations of vertebrate species are measured over time, tracking variations in relative abundance rather than absolute numbers.

This means that the size of

these populations fell by, on average, 73% during the assessment period, and it does not reflect the number of individual animals lost, nor the number of populations lost.

Habitat loss and degradation, overexploitation of resources, climate change, impact of invasive species, pollution and disease are some of the dominant drivers of changes across ecosystems and wildlife populations, the Living Planet Report stated.

The way the world produces and consumes food is the single largest driver of biodiversity loss. The food and agriculture system

is the leading cause of habitat destruction, overharvesting, and a major source of greenhouse gas emissions.

Even as the report noted the declining trends in wild populations, it also noted that nature can recover if society follows a clear pathway to trigger positive tipping points in the energy, food and finance systems that drive biodiversity loss.

"The Living Planet Report 2026 is both a stark reminder of the scale of the biodiversity crisis and a message of hope. While the Living Planet Index continues to highlight significant declines in monitored wildlife

populations, the report also shows that these declines are not inevitable," said Ravi Singh, Secretary General and CEO, WWF-India.

"Species recoveries, including those of tigers in India and globally, demonstrate what sustained conservation action, collaboration and long-term commitment can achieve," he added.

The LPI, produced by the Zoological Society of London, includes 35,803 population trends of 5,790 vertebrate species from 1970 to 2022.

The strongest declines, 85%, were seen in freshwater eco-

systems, followed by terrestrial ecosystems, at 69% and marine ecosystems at 59%. "Although the overall trend is negative due to the magnitude of the declining trends, half of the populations included in the LPI are stable or increasing," WWF said.

The report highlights recoveries in populations of green turtles, bluefin tuna, tigers and southern African elephants, which, it said, demonstrate that targeted conservation interventions can deliver proven results.

The report noted rise in global wild tiger numbers between 2010 and 2025 — from 3,200 to around 5,700 individuals.

TAIWAN

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TAIWAN IN INDIA

Taiwanese presence in India comprises 3 TECC offices, 6 Taiwan Chambers of Commerce, 3 Taiwan World Trade Centers, and 43 Taiwan Education Centers (TECs), bringing together thousands of Taiwanese professionals and families in India.

KEY FIGURES OF TAIWAN-INDIA TIES

	Key Benchmarks	Data / Value
	Bilateral Trade (2025)	>12.5 billion USD
	Taiwanese Enterprises in India	>380
	Job Creation	>2.2 lakh
	Indian Students in Taiwan	~3500 (2025-26)
	Bilateral Research Projects	~200 (Since 2009)

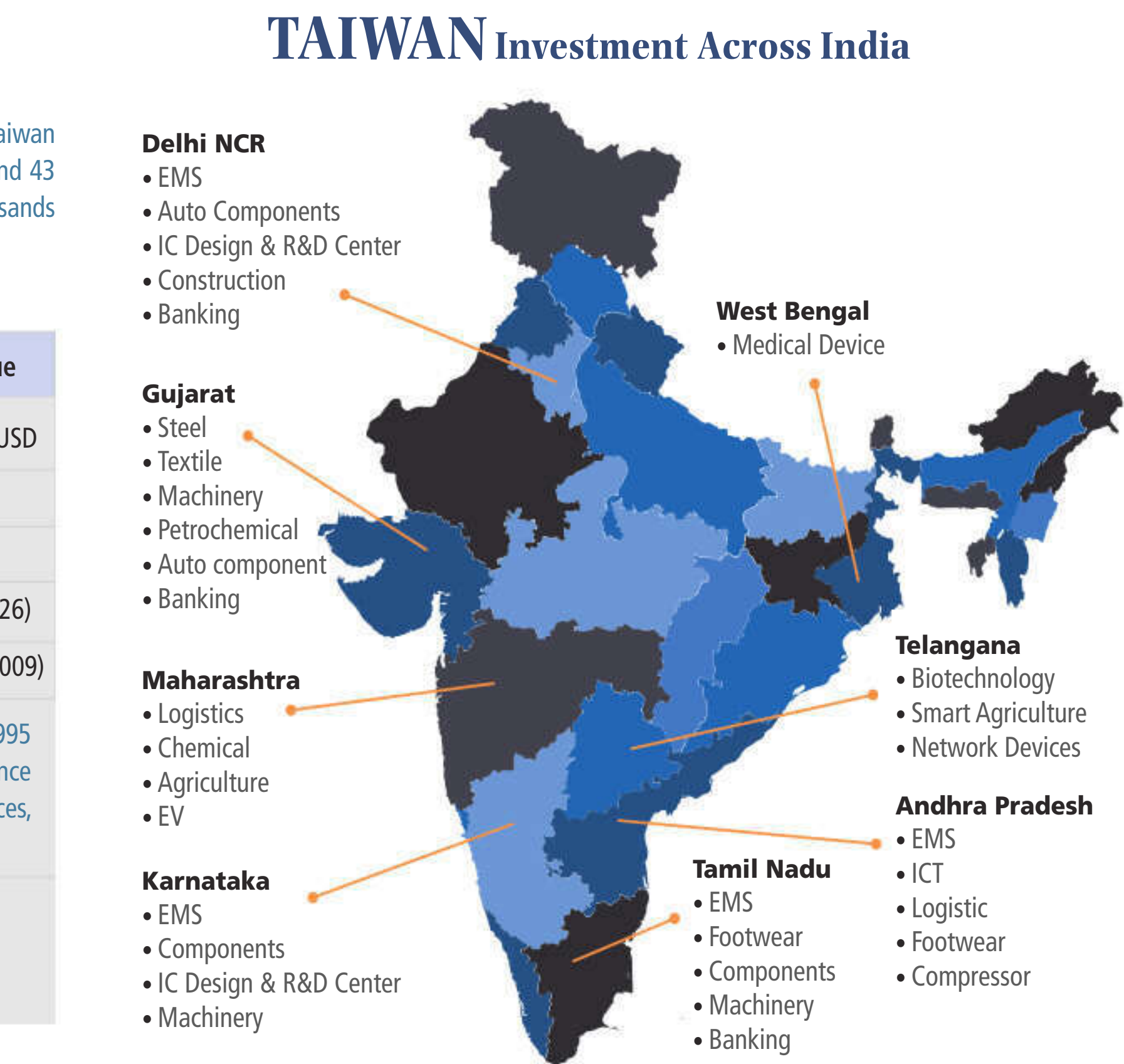
Bilateral MoUs and agreements: signed between 1995 and 2026 including trade, investment, education, science & technology, agriculture, labor mobility, aviation services, healthcare and finance.

Taiwan's Supply Chain in India: Smartphone, Semiconductor Manufacturing, PC and Electronic Components, Machine Tools and Footwear.

Dr. Mumin Chen
Representative, Taipei Economic & Cultural Center in India

TAIWAN & INDIA

Taiwan and India continue to build a close and diverse partnership across economics, technologies, education, culture, and people-to-people relations. With bilateral trade, investments, and the number of Taiwanese companies in India all hitting record highs, the resumption of direct flights between Taipei and New Delhi this December is set to catalyze future travel, business operations, and



TAIWAN BY THE NUMBERS

Taiwan is world's powerhouse of high-tech and innovation, driving global technologies by anchoring critical ICT and semiconductor ecosystems, while leading traditional enterprises to expand strategic presence into the world market.

	Sectors	Global Share
	Advanced Wafer Foundry	~90%
	Motherboards	>80%
	Laptop OEM/ODM	~80%
	Golf Club Heads	~80%
	Server Management Chips	>70%
	High-End Bicycles	Global No. 1
	WLAN Equipment	~60% - 65%
	Cable CPE	~60%
	DSL CPE	~55%
	IC Packaging&Testing (OSAT)	~50%
	Optical Lenses	>50%
	IC Substrates	~40%
	Industrial PCs (IPC)	~40%
	Desktop PC OEM	30~40%
	Printed Circuit Boards (PCB)	~32%



To fight in the arena, howsoever imperfect, is the only way to strengthen democracy



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

IN RECENT weeks, with the revelations about the Election Commission's troubling conduct and the disenfranchisement of 13 crore voters by unfair means, a provocative debate has emerged. Some are questioning whether opposition parties should continue participating in elections at all, under conditions they claim are fundamentally compromised. Critics point to the systematic erosion of democratic safeguards, the apparent capture of key institutions by *mala fide* elements, and a playing field tilted heavily in favour of the government. Why should the Opposition, they ask, legitimise a system they believe has been captured, by participating in a rigged process?

To these critics, continuing to contest elections under the present administration would be an empty ritual that grants a veneer of democratic legitimacy to what they characterise as a "managed democracy". They argue for an electoral boycott, saying such a course is rooted in moral clarity; by walking away from the ballot box, the Opposition would withhold the democratic stamp of approval that the ruling power relies upon to justify its authority both domestically and internationally. A boycott, from this perspective, is not an act of surrender, but a strategy of non-cooperation designed to expose institutional decay, delegitimise the regime, and shock the public into recognising an existential threat to our democracy.

Yet, this logic, however passionately argued, rests on a basic misreading of political power and the nature of state institutions. As the great French diplomat Talleyrand famously observed, "*les absents ont toujours tort*" — the missing ones are always wrong. To voluntarily withdraw from the electoral arena is not to delegitimise the governing power; it is simply to leave an uncontested field for political opponents to assume untrammelled control over the instruments of

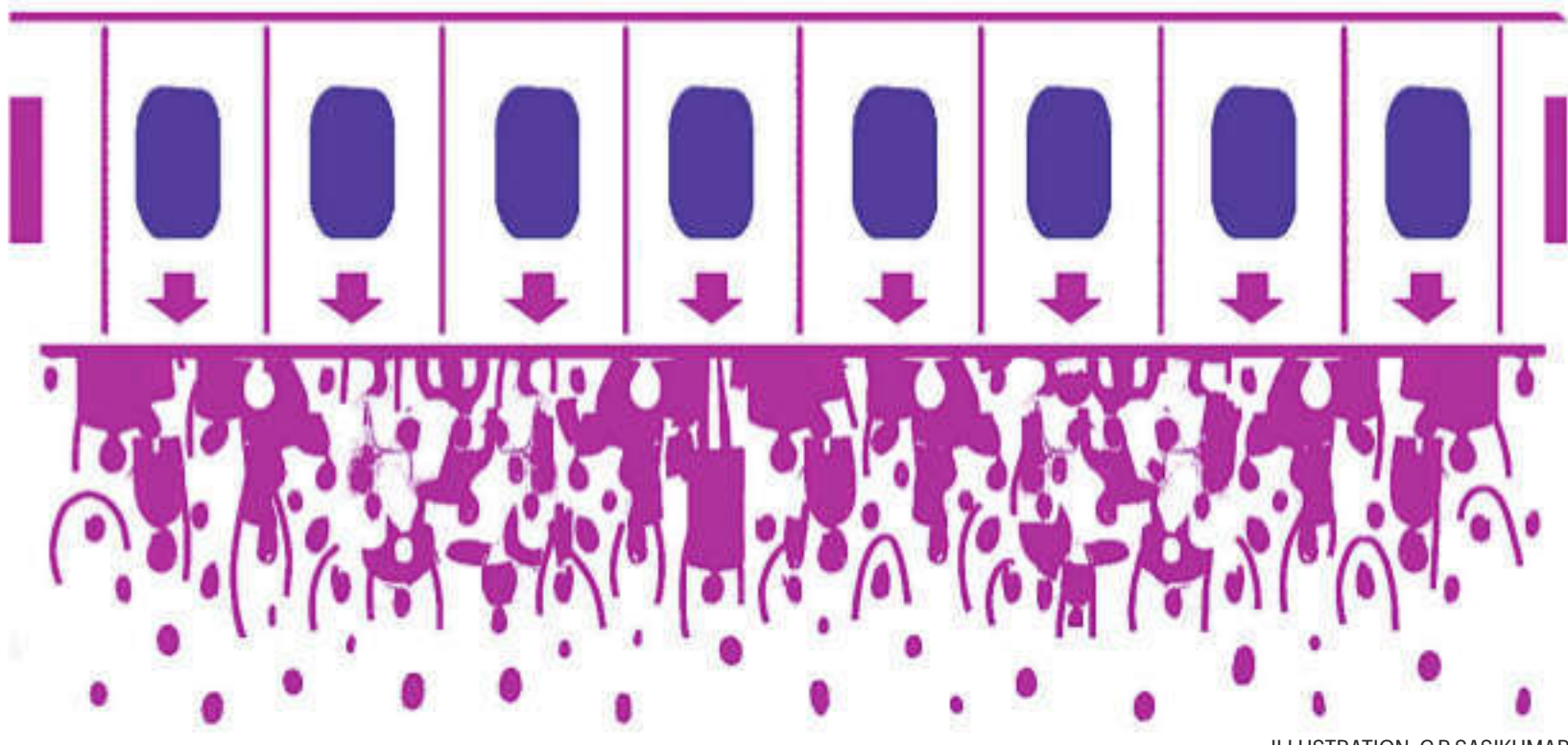


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

the state. In a system where power is derived from constitutional mechanisms, abandoning the battleground means forfeiting every leverage available to protect citizens, influence policy, and hold authority to account. A boycott does not stop the government machinery; it merely removes the challenges that an active opposition generates within it.

The historical precedent often invoked by proponents of boycotts — Gandhiji and the Indian freedom struggle — illustrates why such a strategy fails in a sovereign republic. Boycotts and civil disobedience were effective tools against British colonial rule because the oppressor was an occupying foreign power. In rejecting a subsidiary role that would have enabled colonial rule, the nationalists demonstrated its complete lack of moral authority. In that context, boycotts were meant to shame the colonial government by exposing the inadequacy of the limited representation it offered.

However, a strategy designed against an alien occupier cannot be applied to a sovereign democracy where political actors share a common citizenship and operate under a shared constitutional framework. The Indian National Congress itself recognised this distinction during the Independence movement. While it boycotted elections under the restrictive Montagu-Chelmsford reforms of 1919 to reject a flawed system that enshrined colonial tokenism, it ac-

Even under imperfect conditions, election campaigns provide a unique platform to raise critical issues, expose executive overreach, and present alternative visions for the country

tively chose to participate in the elections under the Government of India Act of 1935, despite limited franchise and communal electorates. Indian leaders recognised that refusing to contest would hand the right of representation to less worthy forces and abandon the public to unmediated colonial authority. In our contemporary constitutional system, choosing non-participation against domestic rivals is not a moral stand, but a spectacular act of self-emasculation.

Beyond the misapplication of history, advocating electoral boycott ignores the practical realities of democratic survival. First, political parties are dynamic organisations sustained by public engagement, cadre morale, and local leadership. Abstaining from elections starves a party of its essential lifeblood. Without campaigns to organise around, candidates to field, or local offices to fight for, political cadres will disperse, local networks collapse, and financial resources dry up. Rebuilding an organisational machine after years of non-participation is extraordinarily difficult, if not impossible. A party that retreats from the field of contestation rapidly renders itself irrelevant to the voters it seeks to represent.

Second, electoral participation remains the primary mechanism for public mobilisation and civic education. Even under imperfect conditions, election campaigns provide a unique platform to raise critical issues, expose executive

overreach, and present alternative visions for the country. When opposition leaders take election campaigns to the streets, hold rallies, and debate policies, they keep democratic discourse alive. Ceding this space entirely to the ruling party guarantees that only one narrative reaches the public, further solidifying the government's grip on popular consciousness and leaving voters who are dissatisfied with the status quo without a voice or a vehicle for change.

Furthermore, participating in elections does not mean accepting institutional flaws with blind faith. Rather, it provides the necessary foundation for resisting them. History shows that electoral authoritarians and dominant parties are rarely weakened by moral appeals or voluntary abstentions; they are challenged, constrained, and ultimately defeated through persistent, organised resistance at the ballot box. Even in highly uneven contests across the globe, opposition participation has frequently exposed the limits of ruling power, forced unexpected concessions, created internal friction within ruling coalitions, and preserved institutional footholds that later served as launchpads for political renewal. Take Hungary this year: Despite facing an illiberal system engineered to entrench Viktor Orbán's rule, the Hungarian opposition refused to abandon the ballot box, contesting elections and exposing the regime's failings, ultimately mobilising to deliver a landslide victory. Illiberal autocracies are dismantled through competitive endurance, not voluntary retreat.

Democracy is not a fragile artefact that can be preserved by hiding it away from flawed contests; it is a muscle that strengthens only through continuous exercise. Complaining about electoral irregularities and demanding institutional accountability are not signs of naive credulity, but the necessary duties of a democratic opposition. To fight in the arena, despite the odds, biases, and structural disadvantages, is the only way for Indian democrats to safeguard the republic. To abstain from contesting would mean handing victory to those who seek to redefine the nation's destiny without resistance. We must not abandon the field to them.

The writer is a fourth-term Congress MP from Thiruvananthapuram

Protect the referee, even as you question the decision



SHASHANK R JOSHI

IN EVERY game, you can abuse the player. You cannot abuse the referee. If you do, the game ends. Today in India, we are abusing the referee. The Election Commission of India (ECI) is not just another bureaucracy. It is the core of democracy. To protect it is not to support any party; it is to support the game itself. This wisdom is not new. It is in our Vedas, it was in Rome, and it was in Greece.

The Rig Veda does not start with a king. It starts with two institutions: *Sabha* and *samiti*. *Samiti* was the people — the voters. *Sabha* was the council of elders, the learned, the impartial who ensured the *samiti* could meet freely and choose freely. The Atharva Veda prays: *Sabha cha me samiti cha ma avatu* — may my *sabha* and *samiti* protect me.

The *sabha* had no army, no kingdom. Its power came from only one thing — trust. If the *sabha* was seen as biased, the *samiti* collapsed and the *janapada* broke. The ECI is our modern *sabha*. It has no seats to contest, no vote bank to protect. Its only capital is credibility. When we chip away at that credibility for political points, we are not hitting at an office in Nirvachan Sadan, but at the idea of *sabha* itself.

The Vedas also gave us a method: *Tarka* and *shastrartha*. Debate fiercely, but accept the decision of the *sabha*. The Brihadaranyaka Upanishad shows King Janaka hosting a great debate where Yajnavalkya is questioned by everyone, including women scholars like Gargi. He answers. The debate ends, and his authority is higher, not lower, because he submitted to questioning. The ECI must be questioned. But after questioning, it must be obeyed. That is *dharma*.

The Romans were the greatest bureaucrats. They knew democracy needs a clean voter list more than a popular leader. They created the office of censor. The censor was not the consul who fought wars. He was more powerful. He prepared the census — the list of citizens. He could remove a senator by marking him with *nota censoria*. He was elected for 18 months, but his list lasted for 5 years. Why did Romans give so much power to two men who did nothing but count? Because they understood: If the voter list is corrupt, the republic is corrupt.

When we in India politicise the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, or the deletion and addition of voters, we forget Rome. A clean roll will always be painful. Someone's name will be deleted. Someone's booth will shift. That pain is the price of a republic. Attack the error with data, appeal to the ECI, go to court — but do not attack the censor itself. If the censor falls, the republic becomes an empire.

Athens, the mother of democracy, had a brilliant safeguard. They did not even trust elections fully. Most offices in Athens were filled not by election, but by "lot" — by lottery among citizens — under the supervision of the "eponymous archon". Why? Because they feared that elections could be manipulated by orators. Their safeguard was procedure. The archon did not decide who won; he ensured the "procedure" was followed.

The ECI is our archon. Its job is not to decide who should win — 140 crore Indians decide that. Its job is to ensure the lottery of democracy — the EVM, the VVPAT, the ink, the booth — remains pure. Every dharma is two-sided. If the players must not abuse the referee, the referee must also remember why it wears black. In the Vedic *sabha*, the elder did not speak more than necessary — he spoke through decisions, after listening to both sides. In Rome, the censor was respected because he applied *nota censoria* equally, even to his own kin. In Greece, the archon was trusted because he drew lots in the open *agora*, not behind closed doors. The referee protects itself best by transparency, by same-rule-same-speed for all jerseys, and by a dignified restraint that let the orders speak louder than the press note. The moment a referee starts explaining too much, defending too much, or being seen too much, the crowd begins to doubt the whistle. The referees work best when we see them stable, silent, and steady.

I am a doctor, not a psephologist. In the ICU, I see what happens when sodium — a single ion that no one notices — falls from 141 to 123. The body seizes and the brain starves. Sodium is invisible till it is low. The ECI is the sodium of our democracy. Invisible when it works, catastrophic when it fails. You can disagree with an order. That is your right in a democracy. File an affidavit, produce data, go to the Supreme Court. That is Vedic *tarka*, Roman *provocatio*, Greek *elenchus*. But do not call for burning down the office that guards the list. Rome tried that. When Augustus destroyed the power of the censors, the republic never returned. Protect the referee, even as you question the decision. That is the only way the game continues.

The writer is an endocrinologist and public health physician based in Mumbai

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Restore trust

A STRONG democracy cannot afford an institution that displays opaqueness ('Can Election Commission untie knots of its own making? That's the question', *IE*, October 7). When civil servants, judges, and political parties alike question its authority, the foundation of electoral legitimacy shakes. The ECI must embrace transparency, consistency, and accountability to restore public trust. Ashok Lavasa rightly points out that inaction breeds contempt, reducing the ECI to a bureaucratic shell. By untangling its contradictions, the ECI can reaffirm itself as the unbiased guardian of India's democratic soul.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow

PUBLIC CONFIDENCE in elections depends greatly on the Election Commission's transparency and consistency ('Can Election Commission untie knots of its own making? That's the question', *IE*, October 7). The ECI should respond promptly to legitimate questions and ensure that its processes are easily understood by citizens and political parties alike. Courts and institutions must be able to scrutinise electoral decisions without unnecessary confrontation. Strengthening institutional accountability will help preserve the credibility and independence of the electoral process.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

Punish the guilty

THE CORNELL incident is another reminder of the deeply entrenched attitudes towards women that persist despite modernity and democratic institutions ('Cornell reminder on impunity, sexual violence', *IE*, October 7). Across India and elsewhere, women are increasingly speaking out on social media and public platforms against abuse, threats and humiliation. Rape threats and misogynistic abuse online are not merely offensive speech; they reflect a culture in which perpetrators often expect little consequence.

Tushar A Rahatgaonkar, Dombivli East



SHIBASHIS CHATTERJEE

IT IS hard to find a more surreal turn of events than what befell Christa Pike in Tennessee. The state prepared to execute her and gave her two doses of pentobarbital, but she survived. She was then taken from the prison to a hospital by ambulance, where doctors immediately began working to preserve her life, contrary to the state's recent actions. Pike's attorneys stated that medical personnel were attempting to remove the drug from her body. The woman found guilty of the horrific 1995 murder of 19-year-old Colleen Slemmer was reported to be unconscious, critically ill, and on a ventilator.

This represents a confrontation between the two sides of the contemporary state. In one place, authorities apply chemicals intended to cause death. In another, medical professionals employ their expertise and technology to preserve that same life. If Pike recovers, an even stranger question emerges: Can the state prepare to execute someone its medical system has just fought to save?

To make this an issue of sympathy for Pike would miss the point. Her crime was appalling. No serious discussion of capital punishment should diminish Slemmer's suffering or disregard the claims of victims and their families. The moral challenge of the death penalty stems exactly from the fact that the crimes are often so horrific. The question is: What can a constitu-

If Christa Pike recovers, an even stranger question emerges: Can the state then prepare to execute someone its medical system has just fought to save?

IN GOOD faith

IN GOOD faith

tional state do once guilt is confirmed?

American law has faced this dilemma before, if not under these circumstances. Willie Francis survived an attempt to execute him in the electric chair by the state of Louisiana, because there was a malfunction of equipment in 1946. The US Supreme Court in *Francis vs Resweber* (1947) held that a botched execution was accidental and not a separate punishment, thus permitting a second attempt. However, Justice Felix Frankfurter added a crucial caveat: "A series of abortive attempts" might create what he called an altogether different constitutional problem. Now that the condemned has reached death's door and been gravely injured again, what purpose does it serve to bring her there a second time? One might ask: When does administering justice become a demand for a deed to be performed?

Further, lethal injection owes its acceptance, in part, to medicalisation. A prisoner is positioned on what appears to be a hospital gurney. Death looks like the evisceration of a grotesque tumour. However, medicine and execution have utterly opposite moral foundations. Medicine interposes itself to preserve life or ease suffering, while execution is an intervention that can only remove a life.

The Pike case also unsettles the reassuring language of "humane" or "painless" executions. The US

In every trans woman's life, there is a Dorothy



NEGHA AND PRIYA ANGAMUTHTHU

A SOCIETY disturbed by a kiss must first ask why it is unable to see a trans woman's pain, love, and humanity. The Tamil film *Dorothy*, directed by Karthik Subbaraj, engages with a society still struggling to recognise transgender people as complete human beings. What troubles us is not the debate surrounding the film, but what this has chosen to focus on. A story exploring caste, patriarchy, family, systemic violence, toxic masculinity, and gender politics has been reduced to one question: How can a trans woman kiss a man?

Why does that kiss spark such moral panic? Calling it "two men kissing" reveals a

refusal to recognise a trans woman as a woman. But beyond that, why should intimacy cause such discomfort? Set in the 1990s, *Dorothy* reminds us of the real-life Dorothys whose stories were never documented, living through an era where gender, caste, and class inflicted severe violence on women's bodies. Through a sharp intergenerational lens, Subbaraj confronts a centuries-old system now struggling to digest the truth. This conflict forces a deeper inquiry into identity: Who is Dorothy to Subbu? Is she a mother? A sister? A sister-in-law?

Before demanding answers, society must face a simpler question: Do you accept Subbu as Dorothy? Change is not an overnight process, but opposing and ignoring the struggles of another human remains deeply inhumane. A section of viewers forgets how Subbu struggled to guard her *kattakutanga*,

her protective, nurturing femininity in a male-dominated world, only to obsess over a single kiss in the final scene. In truth, Dorothy represents the collective feminine that nurtures and protects a trans woman's emerging identity. In real life, Dorothy takes many forms: Mothers, mentors, female educators. In every trans woman's life, there is a Dorothy; most often, she is another woman.

Music is a vital pillar of this sanctuary. For

For decades, mainstream Tamil cinema offered transgender and queer people little more than ridicule. In 'Dorothy', Ilaiyaraaja's score feels like a balm to those wounds

decades, mainstream Tamil cinema offered transgender and queer people little more than ridicule. In *Dorothy*, Ilaiyaraaja's score feels like a balm to those wounds. Music provides a space where trans women safely explore their identity, historically through Ilaiyaraaja and Swamalatha compositions like 'Enulle enulle', and 'Muthumani', now a trans anthem. In many ways, Ilaiyaraaja himself embodies Dorothy through the emotional shelter his art bestows.

The film's visual grammar speaks volumes. Karthik's choices such as the slow-motion parrot and salna sequence or the sharp presence of the *chappathi kall* (prickly pear cactus) vividly convey the weight of toxic masculinity enforced upon trans bodies.

This depth extends to performance and casting. Sanath's performance deserves appreciation for its vulnerability and commit-

ment. Yet, when cisgender actors consistently receive accolades for portraying transgender characters, it raises an undeniable question: Where does that leave trans actors who have spent years fighting simply to be cast? At the same time, *Dorothy*'s inclusion of trans actors and the international platform given to artists like Jeeva is meaningful. True representation must extend beyond who plays the lead; it must be about who gets access to opportunities.

Dorothy is a gift and a necessary step forward. To shift the collective consciousness and urge the public to view every person as human, Tamil cinema needs hundreds of more films like *Dorothy*, *Super Deluxe*, and *Natchathiram Nagargiradhu*.

Negha is an actor, writer, and co-founder of Queer Casting. Angamuththu is a law student

AI and cybersecurity courses now a must for IPS officers

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, October 7

COURSES ON emerging technologies, evidence-based policymaking, cybersecurity fundamentals, art of storytelling, and generative AI tools will now be compulsory for IPS officers, and their performance on the iGOT Karmayogi platform will be reflected in their annual performance appraisal reports.

In a communication recently sent to the Chief Secretaries, the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) said the decision followed a Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) directive aimed at ensuring continuous, role-specific capacity building for officers, who will now have to complete prescribed courses on iGOT every year.

As the cadre controlling authority for the IPS, the Ministry of Home Affairs has selected 24 courses for its officers – six for each of four categories based on years of service.

Of the six courses in each bracket, the first three are man-

datory and will be linked to the annual performance appraisal reports.

In the first category (up to nine years of service), the mandatory courses for officers are an introduction to emerging technologies, search and seizure procedures, and cybersecurity fundamentals.

In the second category (up to 16 years of service), officers will take an introduction to emerging technologies, and a foundational module on the interoperable criminal justice system.

In the third category, officers with service experience between 16 years and 25 years will be introduced to emerging technologies, evidence-based policymaking, cybersecurity fundamentals, the art of storytelling, and generative AI tools such as ChatGPT.

Under the final category (more than 25 years of service), officers will take courses that overlap substantially with the preceding group, with the addition of a module on integrative wellness.

WHO underlines rise in obesity among children, issues guidelines

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, October 7

THE WORLD Health Organisation (WHO) on Wednesday released guidelines addressing the sharp rise in obesity among children and adolescents, recommending against the use of weight-loss drugs and bariatric surgery for children below the age of nine, and advocating restraint for such practices in the case of adolescents between the ages of 10 and 19.

“The foundation of obesity care for children and adolescents is not medicine or surgery, but access to comprehensive support that enables healthy eating, physical activity and sustainable behaviour change,” said Dr Luz María De Regil, Director of the Department of Nutrition and Food Safety, WHO.

The development comes following the increasing obesity in these age groups. Cases have quadrupled since 1990, rising from 2 per cent to 8 per cent. In 2024, 170 million children and adolescents aged 5-19 years were living with obesity, including 70 million children aged 5-

• WHO on obesity management

Recommendations	Children	Adolescents
Structured dietary interventions	Strong in favour	Strong in favour
Physical activity	Strong in favour	Strong in favour
Behaviour-change interventions	Strong in favour	Strong in favour
Digital, technology driven interventions	Conditional in favour	Conditional in favour
Pharmacotherapy	Strong against	Conditional in favour
Bariatric surgery	Strong against	Conditional in favour
Multimodal interventions	Strong in favour	Strong in favour

9 years and 100 million adolescents aged 10-19 years.

When it comes to India, the number of children and adolescents between the age of 5 and 19 years living with obesity is set to increase to 27 million by 2030, accounting for 11% of the global burden, according to the Comprehensive National Nutrition Survey 2016-18.

“Children and adolescents living with obesity are likely to develop lifestyle diseases much earlier in life and have to live longer with complications arising from them. We now know that losing weight can help prolong their lives. This is the reason we need to intervene aggressively in the early years,” says Dr Jothydev Kesavadev,

chairperson, Jothydev’s Diabetes and Research Centre.

Dr Anurag Bajpai, president of the Indian Society for Paediatric and Adolescent Endocrinology (ISPAE), says that he has seen a three-fold increase in the number of children coming to his clinic with obesity.

“Most of them come in with other co-morbidities such as fatty liver, prediabetes, and high cholesterol levels. So far, there were limited treatment options. But now, the use of semaglutide has been approved in children over the age of 12... However, this should be limited to children living with morbid obesity and complications,” he said.

In fact, ISPAE is currently in the process of drafting guide-

lines for the use of GLP-1 drugs in children to ensure that it is not over-used and yet is offered to those who require it.

WHO’s latest guidelines do allow for the use of weight-loss drugs and surgery for adolescents who are morbidly obese with lifestyle conditions linked to it, or those for whom interventions have failed to achieve results after six months.

While guidelines on use of drugs are not specifically meant for GLP-1 alone — with these drugs being an area of interest when it comes to obesity — Dr Luz said that there was no long-term data on the efficacy and effects of these drugs in children yet.

According to Dr Bajpai, surgeries are not recommended in children as they can hamper their growth. The WHO recommends structured diets, physical activity, and behaviour change for managing obesity in children and adolescents.

According to the National Family Health Survey (NFHS) data, India is witnessing a rapid surge in overweight and obesity among children under five, with prevalence rising by 127 per cent between 2005-06 and 2019-21. Similarly, adolescent girls and boys have seen an increase in overweight and obesity of 125 per cent and 288 per cent, respectively.

KARNATAKA JOB EXAM RACKET

KPSC officials Sahukar, Geetha took bribes to leak answer keys: ED

Express News Service
Bengaluru, October 7

AN ED probe has revealed that the now-suspended Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) chairman Shivashankarappa Sahukar and member B V Geetha allegedly leaked answer keys for the January 6 veterinary doctors recruitment exam in exchange for bribes.

Sahukar reportedly leaked the keys to an aspirant for a Rs 10 lakh advance, who subsequently secured the third rank, while Geetha allegedly provided them to the first-rank winner for Rs 20 lakhs.

They were arrested by the ED on Tuesday following a probe into allegations of money laundering by KPSC officials through job frauds in the Commission, with a specific reference to the fraud in the recruitment of veterinary doctors.

The ED’s findings were presented in court on Wednesday, where the agency said that the duo had obtained the keys for 80 questions from the now-arrested KPSC Controller of Exams Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar and supplied it to as many as six candidates.

Incidentally, Gangwar and a middleman Basavaraj Kanale were earlier arrested for al-

legedly leaking up to 80 questions to as many as 11 aspirants.

“In the case of the previous arrests, it was the questions that were leaked. Here, in this case, it is the answer keys,” the ED counsel Madhu N Rao told the court. “This is a different modus operandi,” he added.

The ED probe has found that four other candidates – the eighth, ninth, 11th and 12th rank winners – were also given access to keys by Sahukar and Geetha.

The agency found that Geetha gave the names of six aspirants to Gangwar and he, in turn, looked at their seating arrangement in the exam hall and provided keys for the specific set of question papers they would receive, the counsel said.

The ED has shown “prima facie” that the two accused were misusing their positions... for illegal gratification of Rs 20 lakh and Rs 10 lakh respectively,” the special court said while remanding Sahukar and Geetha to ED’s custody till October 19.

The ED probe also “prima facie” discloses that Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar, VH (the third rank candidate), her father, NB (the first rank candidate) and his father, and Shivashankarappa Sahukar and B V Geetha were connected with monetary transactions... “the court observed.

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-AUCTION NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through **IREPS** (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt-Oct-01-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-C	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-01-26	Waiting Rooms	Panipat Railway Station	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-01-26	Waiting Area	New Delhi Railway Station	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Vinyl Stickers/Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 22479/80 and 22485/86	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Unipole	Modinagar.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-E, F & D	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	DDIS UTS	290 UTS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	DDIS PRS	165 PRS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Non-Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Waiting Rooms	Khekra, Baghpat Road, Shakur Basti & Mansa, Railway Station	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Passenger Announcement System (PAS)	New Delhi, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Panipat, Sonapat, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffarnagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Rohatk, Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Palwal.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Head Rest Covers	Train No. 22439/40, 22435/36, 22447/48	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen. <https://ireps.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)

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Letter No. 1488 / निविदा / 175 //निविदा सूचना// Date : 06.10.2026
Email id : secchdr.ujn@gmail.com

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु अर्ह फर्मों से ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.uktenders.gov.in पर निम्न विवरणानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम	निविदा प्रपत्रों की संख्या (रु. में)	घरेलू दर (रु. लाख में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
01	UeWSP कार्यक्रम के अंतर्गत बाइकोली युवर्ग ग्रामियम पेयजल योजना के चरण 1 अर्थात्, चार्ज, जलसंचयन, प्रत्येक निर्माण एवं तलाकाम्ची कार्य।	5900.00 (जीएसटी 0% सहित)	84.00	18 माह
02	UeWSP कार्यक्रम के अंतर्गत रामपुर ग्रामियम पेयजल योजना के चार्ज लाइन, चार्ज अलवयर्स, नल्लेख निर्माण एवं तलाकाम्ची कार्य।	5900.00 (जीएसटी 0% सहित)	82.00	18 माह

1. पोर्टल पर ई-निविदा उपलब्ध करने की तिथि / समय :- 07.10.2026 समय 17:00 बजे तक।
2. ई-निविदा को उपलब्ध करने की अंतिम तिथि / समय :- 24.10.2026 समय 17:00 बजे तक।
3. ई-निविदा की तिथि व समय :- दिनांक 12.10.2026 समय 16:00 बजे स्थान: प्रधान कार्यालय, 11-मोहिनो रोड, आलवाला देहरादून।
4. कार्यालय में EMD सम्बन्धी प्रश्न जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक - 27.10.2026 समय 17:00 बजे तक।
5. तकनीकी विड खुलने की तिथि / समय :- 28.10.2026 समय 13:00 बजे, स्थान: कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, निर्माण मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल निगम, हरिद्वार।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए लॉग इन करें www.uktenders.gov.in

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

Thai woman accuses Kanpur ‘husband’ of Rs 60 lakh fraud and hiding marriage

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 7

TRAVELLING 3,000 km from Thailand to Kanpur, a 35-year-old woman went looking for the man she said she married — and the Rs 60 lakh she had lent him.

The man, a tannery businessman named Mohammad Irfan, had stopped answering her calls and cut off contact. When she went to his Kanpur home, she allegedly discovered that he was already married and

had children. The woman approached Kanpur Police on Tuesday alleging that Irfan and his family members assaulted and threatened her, and pressured her to convert to Islam.

Based on her complaint, Kanpur Police arrested Irfan and registered an FIR against him at Anwarganj police station under charges including assault. Police also invoked provisions of the anti-conversion law against him. “We have arrested Irfan. The woman’s allegations are being

examined, and necessary verification is being carried out,” said Assistant Commissioner of Police, Kanpur, Manjay Singh.

He added that Irfan has admitted to marrying the woman and is being produced before the court. The woman has been sent for medical examination and the report is awaited.

According to police, the woman, who runs a restaurant and a canteen in Thailand, met Irfan through social media around four years ago.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

NBCC signed an MoU with the IDPS, New Delhi, to construct the India International Cultural Centre at Sector 9A, Gurugram. The project is supported under Indian Railway Finance Corporation’s CSR initiative. The MoU was signed by Dr. Amit Jain, President, IDPS, and Rajeev Kumar, CGM (Engg.) & SBG Head, NBCC, in the presence of Dr. Yogendra Narain, Chairman, IICC, and Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy, CMD, NBCC. The Centre will feature a museum, Zool, auditorium, research facilities and cultural exchange hub.



MoHUA: The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched several initiatives under Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban, including a Swachh Bharat Test Bed & Innovation Centre at Durgapur in collaboration with CSIR-CMERI, the third cohort of 13 sanitation startups with IIT Kanpur, and a Swachhata Behaviour Change Digital Kosh. Union Minister Manohar Lal

also inaugurated a Reduce, Reuse and Recycle (RRR) Centre at Sankalp Bhawan, New Delhi. The initiatives support cleaner, technology-driven cities and citizen participation. Manohar Lal said 50 cities across 24 states will become clean role models through outcome-based monitoring. Minister of State Tokhan Sahu highlighted Swachhata’s evolution into a way of life.

BSES organised a three-day workshop on the Battery Energy Storage System Safety Framework, bringing together power-sector leaders, global experts, utilities and emergency services to ensure battery storage scales up safely. The inaugural session featured CEA Chairperson Ghanashyam Prasad, BSES Group CEO Amal Sinha and other senior officials. Discussions covered safety-by-design, thermal runaway, testing and first-responder readiness. Highlights included a live thermal runaway demonstration with Delhi Fire Service intervention, insights from UL Standards experts, and nine multidisciplinary teams tackling emergency scenarios. The programme drew on BSES’ experience with its 20 MW/40 MWh KiloKri BESS.



rose to Rs. 13,781 crore, with CRAR at 20.59%. The company plans to expand financing in battery storage, pumped storage, green hydrogen and smart meters, while strengthening global financing through GIFT City. Dr. Mohanty also released IREDA’s first ESG Report for FY2025-26.

CCL: The Corporate Communications & Public Relations (CC & PR) Department of Central Coalfields Limited (CCL) has been conferred the prestigious ‘Strategic Communication Leadership Award’ at the ET Business Excellence & Leadership Summit 2026. Rajeev Khandelwal, Indian film celebrity, presented the award at the ceremony to Alok Kumar Gupta, General Manager & Head (CC & PR Department), and Mayank Kashyap, Manager (CD). Under the leadership and guidance of CCL CMD Nilendu Kumar Singh, the department has undertaken several creative initiatives to strengthen the company’s corporate identity and brand presence. The recognition is seen as a significant national-level honour for CCL’s innovative communication and branding efforts.



PETRONET LNG recently hosted its Investors and Analysts Interactive Meet, “Samvaayah 2.0,” in Kochi from September 23–25, 2026. Organised by UBS Securities India Pvt. Ltd., the three-day event brought together PLL’s senior management, investors and analysts to discuss the Company’s business operations, growth outlook, strategic priorities and India’s evolving LNG sector. Akshay Kumar Singh, Managing Director & CEO, highlighted PLL’s commitment to transparency and stakeholder engagement, while Saurav Mitra, Director (Finance) & CFO, emphasised meaningful investor dialogue. The event reaffirmed PLL’s focus on strengthening India’s natural gas value chain and supporting a cleaner, diversified energy mix.



played key roles in achieving record CAPEX utilisation and transmission additions and successfully led the Arun-3 SAPDC Transmission Project in Nepal. He previously served as Executive Director (Project Management), POWERGRID.

POWERGRID: Akhilesh Pathak assumed charge as Director (Projects) of POWERGRID on September 30, 2026. An Electrical & Electronics Engineering graduate, he joined POWERGRID as an Executive Trainee in its first batch in 1993 and brings over 32 years of power-sector experience. He has expertise in transmission planning, project execution, management, business development and strategic infrastructure development. Pathak

RECPDCL handed over Balsane Power Transmission Limited, a project-specific SPV, to successful bidder Resonia Limited on September 28, 2026. Resonia emerged successful through the Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding process conducted by RECPDCL for Maharashtra’s intra-state transmission project on a Build, Own, Operate and Transfer basis. The SPV was handed over by Anil Kumar Perala, DGM (Engg.), RECPDCL, to Tushar Chhabra, Head – Business Acquisition, Resonia Limited, in the presence of officials from Resonia Limited, Maharashtra STU, and RECPDCL. The project includes a 765/400/220 kV AIS substation at Balsane in Dhule, a 106-km 400 kV double-circuit line to Malegaon, and 50-km 220 kV lines to Shivajinagar and Vikharan. The project is scheduled for completion within 24 months.

BSNL unveiled two customer-centric initiatives on its Foundation Day. Bharat Fibre customers can now choose from 25+ OTT platforms, including Hotstar, SonyLIV, ZEE5 and regional apps, and change their selection every month through the BSNL CinemaPlus portal. In another initiative, BSNL partnered with OICL to offer Rs. 1 lakh accidental death and Rs.10,000 cyber-fraud cover with select prepaid plans, including STV 202 and STV 2449. The insurance activates automatically after recharge. A. Robert J. Ravi ITS, Chairman and Managing Director, BSNL, said the initiatives reflect BSNL’s commitment to customer choice, protection and inclusive connectivity.



JAMIA MILLIA ISLAMIA has secured 334th position globally in the UI GreenMetric World University Rankings 2026, improving by 42 places from 376th in 2025. The University also ranks 13th in India and 192nd in Asia, reaffirming its commitment to sustainability, environmental responsibility and sustainable campus development. The University acknowledged the vital contribution of the Internal Quality Assurance Cell, led by Director Prof. Rafat Parveen, whose work in data management, rankings, accreditation and evidence-based governance continues to strengthen institutional performance.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dr. Sanjay Sachdeva’s new book, Your Body Listens – How Thoughts Become Biology was launched at the C.D. Deshmukh Auditorium on 22 September, New Delhi. Dr. Shashi Tharoor, MP & author, Suresh Raina, Indian Cricketer & Vikas Pawha Senior Advocate, Supreme Court of India graced the event. Blending neuroscience, psychoneuroimmunology, the gut-brain axis and ancient Indian traditions, the book introduces the TSH Model™ (Thought - Signal - Hormone) and explores the “Electrical Human” and emerging bioelectric medicine. The book discusses how cellular communication and electrical states may influence biological processes, while acknowledging that much of the most exciting Bioelectric research remains experimental.



exchanged the MoU with MPSBB Member Secretary Sudeep Singh. KRIBHCO will provide up to Rs.10 crore for plantation, a Nature Interpretation Centre and infrastructure. The park will promote biodiversity conservation and environmental awareness.

KRIBHCO has signed an MoU with the MPSBB to support the development of “Mor Van Biodiversity Park” in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh. The MoU was exchanged in the presence of Amit Shah, Union Home & Cooperation Minister, and Dr. Mohan Yadav, Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh. KRIBHCO Chairman V. Sudhakar Chowdary and Managing Director S. S. Yadav

exchanged the MoU with MPSBB Member Secretary Sudeep Singh. KRIBHCO will provide up to Rs.10 crore for plantation, a Nature Interpretation Centre and infrastructure. The park will promote biodiversity conservation and environmental awareness.



RECPDCL handed over Ranipur Chunar Power Transmission Limited, a project-specific SPV, to H G Infra Engineering Limited on 26 September 2026. The SPV was handed over by Rajesh Raj, GM & HoD, RECPDCL to Ujjval Verma, CGM (Finance), H G Infra Engineering Limited, in the presence of other senior officials from RECPDCL, H G Infra Engineering Limited and Uttar Pradesh Power Transmission Corporation Limited. The project involves 220/132/33 kV AIS substations at Ranipur (Mau) and Chunar (Mirzapur), and a 220 kV D/c line from Rasra to Ranipur. The implementation schedule is 18 months.



challenges in drone-based agricultural services and rural entrepreneurship. Dr. Mohanty encouraged the women entrepreneurs to share knowledge, support fellow Drone Didis and assured continued HURL support. The programme also featured an award ceremony recognising three highest-performing Drone Didis. The initiative showcased women’s growing role in technology-enabled agriculture, livelihood generation and rural enterprise development.

HURL organised ‘Apna Samvaad’ at its Gorakhpur Plant, bringing together Lakshpati Drone Didis from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar to discuss their experiences, achievements and the impact of drone technology in agriculture. Led by Dr. Siba Prasad Mohanty, Managing Director, HURL, the interaction highlighted opportunities and

REC successfully concluded the REC Swachhata Inter-School Cricket Tournament under the nationwide Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign at Guru Dronacharya Sports Academy Cricket Ground, Sector 82, Gurugram. Organised by UDAAN, REC’s Sports & Wellness Club. The two-day leather-ball T10 tournament featured eight Gurugram schools, promoting sportsmanship, teamwork, discipline and cleanliness. Matches followed a knockout format, culminating in a final between Summer Field School and DAV Public School Sector-14, with Summer Field School emerging champions. The initiative reinforced REC’s commitment to youth development, community engagement, wellness and civic responsibility while supporting the national campaign for a cleaner, healthier India.



Department of Civil Engineering since September 19 under an academic exchange programme. The delegation was welcomed by Prof. Quamrul Hassan, Head of the Department, and met VC Prof. Mazhar Asif, Registrar, Prof. Md. Mahtab Alam Rizvi and other senior officials. Discussions focused on renewing the MoU, which has facilitated student and faculty exchange for about two decades, and exploring new research collaborations. Prof. Asif announced plans for a Centre for German Studies at JMI. The Registrar highlighted JMI’s new four-year BA in German Studies and a distance-mode German language course.

JAMIA MILLIA ISLAMIA: A delegation from the University of Applied Sciences, Erfurt, Germany, led by Christian Stangenberger, Department of Civil Engineering, along with seven students, has been on a visit to Jamia Millia Islamia’s

‘EU and India are trusted partners; you need partners for strategic autonomy’

AS HE weighs on global consequences of the Russia-Ukraine war, new Finland Ambassador to India, Mikko Kivikoski, says they appreciate India's efforts, and it is a situation where everybody else is ready to negotiate to stop the war except the Russians. He says the global community should incentivise Russia to come to the negotiation table and then to have this war ended.

In an interview with Divya A, weeks after presenting his credentials to the President Alexander Stubb, Kivikoski weighs in on lessons from global conflicts and the US protectionism, why the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) is stuck, and the imminent need to reform the UN Security Council. Excerpts:

With protectionism rising from big powers like the US, what would be Finland's priorities in terms of the India-EU FTA, set to be operationalised in the coming months?

The Free Trade Agreement (FTA) sends a clear message that when it comes to international trade, rules-based trade is still beneficial for all of us. This applies to all the FTAs that both India and the European Union (EU) are signing with other partners as well. So, there is a strong signal that there are several countries that want to have rules in international trade.

The US has imposed steep reciprocal tariffs on Indian goods. So, how does Finland assess the impact of all of this on global supply chains and on small, open economies?

We are living in quite a turbulent time, when it comes to geopolitics and geoeconomics. Everybody is looking at partners and diversifying things — to make sure you have the freedom of manoeuvre, and also certain (amount of) predictability. We are all doing that — be it India, the EU or Finland. That is one of the lessons learned.

India has been seeking from the EU to ease the CBAM, visa norms for professionals and even data protection. What is Finland's position on this?

We are part of the EU, so we have been part of the decision making on the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism



(CBAM), and the same applies to the EU data protection laws. But we believe it is about level playing field, and sustainability in the long run. Many Indian companies are already adapting; something I personally noticed is that sustainability issues are more on the agenda in India.

Should India and Finland collaborate more on critical minerals and batteries? Because Finland has large reserves, India has demand.

That is also part of the EU-Finland-India partnership. Again, it all comes down to the supply chain and strategic autonomy. And in that context, the EU and India see each other as trusted partners. And you need partners when it comes to strategic autonomy. You cannot do everything by yourself.

With navigation disrupted due to war, especially in the Red Sea and the Black Sea, is there a scope for cooperation on alternative routes, maybe IMEC, mooted by India in 2023?

Definitely, one of the consequences of the recent geopolitical, geoeconomical changes in the world is that, again, it all comes down to the supply chains and strategic autonomy. All the countries are looking for new logistic routes. They want to cut down dependencies...

You have been talking about resilient supply chains and strategic autonomy. Do you think globalisation, as we know, will change forever?

I hope not. For a small country like us, we would like to see sort of rules and institutions when it comes to the international order. We would also like to see that world trade would be free. So, we are part-

nering with countries that have similar views. Finland, India and the EU have similar views when it comes to international order, as well as on multilateralism.

India and Finland are definitely natural partners when it comes to multilateralism, the UN charter and the UN-based multilateralism. We would like to see India as a permanent member of the UN Security Council, and we believe that the Council needs to be reformed.

India has been in touch with Russia and Ukraine to find a solution to the war, and the Ukrainian Foreign Minister said they support India's proposal. Have there been discussions between Kyiv and other EU partners on the proposal?

Yeah, sort of two remarks on that. Firstly, all the attempts to bring the war to an end are highly appreciated and needed. As we all know, it has been underway, and it is already the 5th year. The global consequences are clear. Your External Minister has talked about the consequences multiple times, so that is clear. We are in a situation where everybody else is ready to negotiate — to stop the war — except the Russians.

So basically, what we need is that the global community incentivises Russia to come to the negotiation table, and then to have the war ended.

You have arrived in New Delhi at a time when the India-EU relations are getting stronger, and the India-EU FTA is in the last leg before being signed. What do you think about the collaboration between New Delhi and Helsinki?

We have been witnessing record-high activities this year: Finland Prime Minister Petteri Orpo visited India, President Stubb visited India, and we also had the Nordic-India Summit in Oslo. Then a few weeks ago in Gandhinagar, there was the 10th edition of the World Circular Economy Forum... And when you add to that the FTA and the perspective of the agreement to be enforced next year, this creates a great momentum to deepen our collaboration. And therefore, our task here will be to turn this framework into concrete activities.

Probe into Vizag spy ring: Naval personnel were lured, blackmailed by Pak women

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, October 7

INVESTIGATORS PROBING allegations of spying in Visakhapatnam claim to have pieced together how intelligence operatives from Pakistan trapped and then blackmailed civilians and navy personnel to gather information about the movement of vessels and submarines.

According to investigators, around six months ago, a woman operative allegedly posed as a shipping firm employee and struck up a conversation with Annam Sai Varaprasad, 28, a civilian hired on a contract basis to drive naval officers' vehicles at the Visakhapatnam naval base.

The woman messaged him on his social media accounts, investigators said, adding that though he was initially suspicious, he allegedly continued the conversation. She told him she was from a neighbouring state.

At first, the conversation focused on his personal life: where he lived and why he was not married. Then, investigators said, she asked about his work, his salary, and the kind of vehicles he drove. Eventually, the woman allegedly shared sexually explicit content and promised to meet him soon.

As the conversation prog-

ressed, she allegedly managed to extract information about the officials he drove. From then on, he was threatened that he would be reported to his employers and arrested. Investigators said what followed was blackmail to provide information about the locations of various naval assets, the deployment of officials, etc.

The platform for their communication shifted from social media to WhatsApp. However, Varaprasad had basic security clearance and lacked access to observe and report on classified assets, naval ships docking, and submarines arriving or leaving, investigators said.

The Andhra Pradesh Police's Counter Intelligence Cell and naval officials monitored him for over a month before his arrest on October 6. Officials are also examining his phone to check if he received payments through cryptocurrency, investigators said.

According to investigators, Varaprasad allegedly shared details of a trainee sailor, Pradeep Mukharjee, 31, whom he previously met at the Visakhapatnam base. He too was allegedly trapped by a Pakistan-based intelligence operative, who posed as a medical professional.

Threatened with arrest and legal complications, he too shared information about the

Vizag and Coimbatore facilities, where he was attending a training course, investigators said. He was allegedly forced to share OTPs to activate WhatsApp accounts of Pakistani operatives, and was threatened.

These WhatsApp numbers were then used to lure and trap at least 16 others. They targeted employees posted in Kerala, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Gujarat, Goa, Delhi, Tamil Nadu, Chhattisgarh and Bihar, investigators said, and information sought included movement of naval ships and submarines.

Andhra Pradesh Counter-Intelligence Cell officials said that after it was established that Varaprasad and Mukherjee allegedly shared information and helped operatives trap others, they registered a case against them on September 2 and put them under surveillance. On October 1, simultaneous raids at the homes and residences of 18 persons, including 13 naval personnel, were conducted and 12 teams supported by officials of the anti-terrorist squads of several states, navy intelligence officers, and local police seized phones, electronic devices, and documents. Authorities are investigating the 16 people to determine their level of involvement and have arrested Varaprasad and Mukherjee.

Pak's unwarranted references to Kashmir part of propaganda: Harivansh at IPU meet

Divya A
New Delhi, October 7

EXERCISING INDIA'S right to reply in response to certain references made by Pakistani delegation on J&K at an international forum in Tanzania, Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh Narayan Singh on Wednesday said that Kashmir is an integral and inalienable part of India, and that Pakistan has no *locus standi* commenting on India's internal affairs.

Speaking at the 153rd Assembly of the Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU) in Arusha, Tanzania, Singh said, "We deplore the attempts by a delegation to politicise the forum and to bring in unwarranted references to issues which do not fall within the purview of this forum or meeting."

He added that "quite habitually, this (Pakistani) delegation attempts to indulge in propaganda and makes baseless allegations against India. The Union territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh have been, are, and shall always remain integral and inalienable parts of India."

No amount of rhetoric and propaganda from any country can override the fact that accession of Jammu & Kashmir to India was completely legal and



irrevocable, he said.

"Pakistan has no local sustainability to comment on India's internal affairs. In fact, it is Pakistan which is in illegal and forcible occupation of India's territories that it should vacate," he added.

Highlighting the progress Kashmir has seen over the last few years, Singh said, "People of Jammu and Kashmir are progressively moving forward on the path of development and democracy. This was evident in a high voter turnout in both the general elections - 58.5%, the highest in the last 35 years - and 63% in the Assembly elections in 2024. Jammu and Kashmir witnessed a record surge in tourists last year."

Harivansh arrived in Arusha on Sunday to head the high-level parliamentary delegation at the 153rd IPU Assembly and associated sessions.

I&B Ministry notifies names of 13 journalists as Press Council members

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 7

THE MINISTRY of Information and Broadcasting (I&B) on Wednesday officially notified the names of 13 journalists as members of the Press Council of India (PCI) — India's key media watchdog. The names comprise six newspaper editors and seven working journalists (other than editors).

The *Indian Express* reported on Wednesday that the I&B Ministry has not yet notified the names of 13 of the 28 PCI members, despite nominating them earlier this year and the council sending three reminders to the government.

The gazette notification has been long pending, with the PCI operating at half its sanctioned strength for nearly a

year and without a single working journalist or newspaper editor.

The PCI operates under the Press Council Act, 1978, which stipulates that the Council must consist of a chairperson and 28 members, each serving a three-year term.

So far, only 14 of the 28 members have been appointed: five MPs, three nominees and six from among newspaper owners and management, aside from the chairperson.

Earlier in the day, the Editors Guild of India also demanded the immediate reconstitution of the 15th Press Council in conformity with the Press Council Act, 1978, including the prompt filling of all 13 seats reserved for professional journalists.

DELHI POLLUTION CONTROL COMMITTEE

DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENT, (GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI)
3RD FLOOR, BLOCK-I, DMRC IT PARK BUILDING, SHASTRI PARK, DELHI-53
visit us at: <https://dpcc.delhi.gov.in>

Tender Document for Setting Up and Operating “Common Bio-Medical Waste Treatment and Disposal Facilities (CBWTFs)” in NCT of Delhi

Member Secretary, Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) invites online Bids from qualified Bidders for Setting Up and Operating “Common Bio-Medical Waste Treatment and Disposal Facilities (CBWTFs)” on BOO (Built, Own and Operate) basis for the collection, transportation, reception, storage, treatment and disposal of Bio-medical Waste for Two Regions of the NCT of Delhi.

The Tender Document can be downloaded from the Government of NCT of Delhi e-Portal (<https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in>) as well as from the DPCC website www.dpcc.delhi.gov.in (for reference). The last date for submission of Tender Document is 04.11.2026 till 3.00 P.M.

Sd/-
Member Secretary
Delhi Pollution Control Committee

Former Amreli MP Virji Thummar dies at 67

Ahmedabad: Senior Congress leader and former legislator Virji Thummar died on Wednesday at the age of 67. Known for raising his voice for farmers in Saurashtra and fighting for their issues, Thummar was battling cancer for some time now.

Born in Amreli on May 31, 1959, Thummar, a commerce graduate, was elected to the Assembly for the first time in 1990

from the Babra constituency on a Janata Dal ticket. He won from the constituency again in 1995, but on a Congress ticket.

Thummar was elected to the Lok Sabha from Amreli in 2004 and served as the Congress MLA from Lathi between 2017 and 2022. He contested the 2022 Gujarat Assembly election from Lathi but lost to the BJP candidate. **ENS**

निदेशालय सैनिक कल्याण एवं पुनर्वास उत्तराखण्ड देहरादून।
ज्ञप्ति

पत्रांक : 1002/विपु० अधि०/सैनिक०-1
दिनांक : 07 अक्टूबर 2026

1. निदेशालय सैनिक कल्याण एवं पुनर्वास उत्तराखण्ड के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न जयपदों में उपनिदेशक/जिला सैनिक कल्याण एवं पुनर्वास अधिकारियों के रिक्त पदों हेतु सेना के तीनों अंगों (आर्मी, नेवी, एयर फोर्स) के कर्नल/ले कर्नल व समकक्ष अवकाश प्राप्त सैन्य अधिकारियों से आवेदन पत्र निदेशक, सैनिक कल्याण एवं पुनर्वास उत्तराखण्ड, 15वीं, कालीबास रोड, पो० आ०-हाथीबाड़कला, देहरादून-248001 के पते पर दिनांक 22 अक्टूबर 2026 तक आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

2. उक्त पदों हेतु कर्नल / ले कर्नल व समकक्ष अवकाश प्राप्त अधिकारी उपलब्ध न होने पर, मेजर व समकक्ष अवकाश प्राप्त अधिकारियों के आवेदन पत्रों पर विचार किया जा सकता है। आई फोर्स के तीनों सेवाओं से योग्य पूर्व सैन्य अधिकारी उपलब्ध न होने पर, सैनिक विधवा/अश्रितों की यात्रा पर विचार किया जा सकता है। इद हेतु अर्हताएँ एवं अन्य जानकारी सैनिक कल्याण विभाग की वेबसाइट <https://sainikkalyan.uk.gov.in> पर उपलब्ध है। इसके अतिरिक्त कार्यालय के लैंड लाइन न० 0135-2741481 एवं मोबाइल न० 9422202250 पर भी जानकारी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

निदेशक
सैनिक कल्याण एवं पुनर्वास उत्तराखण्ड।

ANDHRA UNIVERSITY VISAKHAPATNAM, ANDHRAPRADESH, INDIA

NAAC-Accredited "A" Grade with a CGPA of 3.74 out of four point scale "ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified"

PDF NOTIFICATION

Applications in the prescribed proforma are invited for the Posts of AU Centenary Post Doctoral Fellows, in Department of History & Archaeology (01), Department of Geo-Engineering (01), Department of Geology (01), Department of Law (02), Department of Meteorology (01), Department of Psychology (01), Department of Quantum Technology (02), Department of Semi-Conductor (01), Andhra University, Visakhapatnam.

Issue of Notification : 08-10-2026 | Last date for Receipt of Application : 24-10-2026

The prescribed application form, qualifications, scales of pay attached to the post etc., registration fee and other details can be had from the **University website : www.andhrauniversity.edu.in**

The last date for receipt of the duly filled in application is : 24-10-2026

The University reserves the right to fill or not to fill any of the post(s) without giving any reason whatsoever.

Date: 08-10-2026 **Sd/-Registrar**

EXPRESS Careers

Central Hindu Military Education Society's
BHONSALA MILITARY COLLEGE
NAAC Accredited 'B' Grade
Bhonsala Bhawan, Rambhoomi, Dharmaveer Dr. B. S. Moonje Marg, Nashik 422005 (Maharashtra) ✉ info@bhonsala.in
📞 <https://bhonsala.in> | 🏠 College Office: 0253-2309600/01 +91454540480/91454540481

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the post of Principal to be recruited in Central Hindu Military Education Society's, Bhonsala Military College, Nashik (Arts, Commerce & Science College) affiliated to Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune.

Sr. No.	Name of Post	No. of Post	Reservation	Remark
01	Principal	01	Open to all	Grant in Aid

Terms & Conditions:-

- Essential Qualification: As notified by U.G.C., Government of Maharashtra & Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune (Experience, Age & Pay Scales For this post of Principal shall be as per 7th pay Government Resolutions dated 8th March 2019 & 10th May 2019 with amendments and additions).
- The Appointment to the said post will be for a tenure of 5 years from the date of appointment or up to the attainment of superannuation whichever is earlier.
- Only eligible and qualified candidates should apply along with their resume, passport size photograph and self-attested copies of all educational, experience certificates and with valid API score should reach to The Secretary, Central Hindu Military Education Society, "Bhonsala Bhawan", Rambhoomi, Dharmaveer Dr. B. S. Moonje Marg, Nashik, Maharashtra India 422005 within 30 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.
- All the terms & conditions are applicable as mentioned in the Government NOC Letter No/JDHE/PUNE/NOC/2026/97 Dated 28/07/2026. (subject to the final judgement of H'ble Court in writ petition no 12051/2015 BENCH AT AURANGABAD)
- Parallel reservation for women and differently disabled (Divyang) shall be applicable as per the norms of Government of Maharashtra.
- Those candidates who are already in service should send their application with NOC of the present employer through proper channel.
- The incomplete / late applications will not be entertained.
- Filling the above post is the final right of the management.
- NO TA/DA will be payable to the candidates appearing for the interview. (Applicants who have already submitted their applications in response to the earlier advertisement published on 13th August 2026, are not required to apply again in response to this advertisement. Their applications submitted earlier will be considered valid and will be taken into consideration for the scrutiny process.)

Secretary
Central Hindu Military Education Society
Nashik Division, Rambhoomi, Nashik-422005

Place :-Nashik
Date: 08/10/2026

Maharashtra Airport Development Company Ltd.
CIN: U45203MH2002SGC136979

TENDER NOTICE

MADC invites Tender for Appointment of Consultant for Preparation of Detailed Techno-Economic feasibility Study and Bid process management for development of Greenfield offshore International Airport at Kore, VadHAVAN Port Region in Palghar District, Maharashtra (Revised).

The detailed advertisement can be seen / downloaded from the website www.mahatenders.gov.in from **08/10/2026** 14:00 hrs.

Sd/-
Vice Chairman and Managing Director

WINDING UP OF INDIAREIT APARTMENT FUND

This is to inform the general public that Piramal Fund Management Limited, the investment advisor to Indiareit Apartment Fund, a scheme of Indiareit Alternative Trust is seeking to locate investors (or their heirs, successors, or nominees, in the case of deceased investors) who have invested in the scheme but have not yet received their on-hold distribution.

Eligible individuals are requested to contact us by sending an email to investors@piramal.com with the details of your investment along with the folio number and required documents and credentials within **15 (fifteen) working days** from the date of publication of this notice. Failure to respond within stipulated timeline, shall result in the preservation of the investor's entitlement and the amounts shall be dealt with in the manner as Securities and Exchange Board of India may direct.

By Order of
Piramal Fund Management Limited
Date: 8th October, 2026

WINDING UP OF INDIAVENTURE TRUST FUND I

This is to inform the general public that IndiaVentureAdvisors Pvt. Ltd., the investment advisor to IndiaVenture Trust, is seeking to locate investors (or their heirs, successors, or nominees, in the case of deceased investors) who have invested in India Venture Trust Fund I, a scheme of IndiaVenture Trust, but have not yet received their on-hold distributions.

Eligible individuals are requested to contact us by sending an email to India.Venture@piramal.com with the details of your investment along with the folio number and required documents and credentials within **15 (fifteen) working days** from the date of publication of this notice. Failure to respond within stipulated timeline, shall result in the preservation of the investor's entitlement and the amounts shall be dealt with in the manner as Securities and Exchange Board of India may direct.

By Order of
IndiaVentureAdvisors Pvt. Ltd
Date: 8th October, 2026

Public Notice Under Section 3G (3)

रजिस्ट्री सं. सी.एल-33004/99

REGD. NO. D.L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र The Gazette of India

सी.जी.-सी.एल.-अ.-29092026-276616
CG-DL-E-29092026-276616

**असाधारण
EXTRAORDINARY**

भाग II-खण्ड 3-उप-खण्ड (ii)
Part II-Section 3-Sub-Section (ii)

**प्राधिकार से प्रकाशित
PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY**

सं. 4951]
No. 4951]

नई दिल्ली, शुक्रवार, सितम्बर 18, 2026/चाद्र 27, 1948
NEW DELHI, FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 18, 2026/BHADRA 27, 1948

**MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS
NOTIFICATION**
New Delhi, the 28th September, 2026

S.O. 5157(E).—In exercise of powers conferred by sub-section (1) of section 3A of the National Highways Act, 1956 (48 of 1956) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government, after being satisfied that for the public purpose, the land, the brief description of which is given in the Schedule below, is required for building (widening/two lane with paved shoulder/four laning etc.), maintenance, management and operation of NH248A in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 27.32 in the village(s) namely- Tikri Taluk- Gurugram in the district of Gurugram in the state of HARYANA hereby declares its intention to acquire such land.

Any person interested in the said land may, within twenty-one days from the date of publication of this notification in the Official Gazette, object to the use of such land for the aforesaid purpose under sub-section(1) of section 3C of the said Act.

Every such objection shall be made to the Competent Authority, namely, District Revenue Officer Gurugram in writing and shall set out the grounds thereof and the Competent Authority shall give the objector an opportunity of being heard, either in person or by a legal practitioner, and may, after hearing all such objections and after making such further enquiry, if any, as the Competent Authority thinks necessary, by order, either allow or disallow the objections.

Any order made by the Competent Authority under sub-section (2) of section 3C of the said Act shall be final.

The land plans and other details of the land to be acquired under their notification are available and can be inspected by the interested person at the aforesaid office of the Competent Authority.

SCHEDULE

Brief Description of the land to be acquired with or without structures falling NH248A in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 27.32 in the village(s) namely- Tikri Taluk-Gurugram in the district of Gurugram in the state of HARYANA

State: HARYANA District: Gurugram

Sl. No.	Survey/Plot Number	Type of Land	Nature of Land	Area (in Local Unit)	Area (in Hectares)
1	2	3	4	5	6
Taluk: Gurugram Village: Tikri					
1	13/11/1/2 Min	Private	Non Agriculture (G. M. School)	0.098 (Hectare)	0.098
2	13/11/2/2	Private	Non Agriculture (G. M.)	0.0051 (Hectare)	0.0051
3	13/12/2 Min	Private	Non Agriculture (G. M. School)	0.0126 (Hectare)	0.0126
				Total	0.1157

District: Gurugram
<https://egazette.gov.in>
Publication Date: 18 September 2026
<https://egazette.gov.in>
<https://bhoomirashi.gov.in>

File Number: PIU/GA/08/07/2016-17/3A
Shaikh Aminkhan, Director

Note : The physical copy of this notification is also available at the office of CALA/PIU/PMU/RO/ED and Landowners may also see the notification there.

UPITS 2026

UP TAKES BUSINESS TO THE GLOBAL STAGE

Uttar Pradesh is turning scale into opportunity - and UPITS 2026 brought that transformation into sharp focus. From global business and investment to tourism, technology, culture and women-led enterprise, the trade show showcased the state's rapidly expanding economic ecosystem. With 2,400+ exhibitors, 5.5 lakh visitors at the Tourism Pavilion, 100+ investment and collaboration inquiries and 76,484 sq. m. of operational exhibition space, UPITS 2026 demonstrated how Uttar Pradesh is connecting its local strengths with national and international markets while creating new avenues for enterprise, employment and growth.



UTTAR PRADESH: BUILDING A GLOBAL BUSINESS ECOSYSTEM

- **Enterprise & Investment Reforms:** ODOP, Vishwakarma Shram Samman, Mukhyamantri Yuva Yojana, single-window clearances and industrial incentives are supporting enterprise and investment.
- **Emerging Growth Hubs:** The Defence Corridor across six cities and Greater Noida's data-centre ecosystem are expanding UP's industrial footprint, alongside the growth of religious and experience-led tourism.
- **India Expo Mart Advantage:** 2,400+ exhibitors and international participation created a major trade platform, supported by 1,800 showrooms and 774 exporters for year-round buyer-seller engagement.
- **Business Meets Culture:** 20 knowledge sessions, traditional crafts, MSME showcases, youth activities and cultural performances added knowledge and cultural dimensions to the business platform.
- **Expanding Infrastructure:** Exhibition halls increased from 14 to 16, while operational area rose 17.87% to 76,484 sq. m.
- **UP's Local Strength Goes Global:** ODOC showcased the culinary heritage of all 75 districts, while ODOP, Banarasi sarees, Bhadohi carpets, Lucknow chikankari and other local products connected with wider markets.



UPITS 2026 RECORD-BREAKING BUSINESS & INVESTMENT

- **₹4,400 MoUs**
₹6,500 crore investment commitments signed.
- **₹15,500 crore**
projected business transactions.
- **41,500**
B2B meetings - up 31% over 2025.
- **5.99 lakh**
visitors recorded during the five-day event.
- **13,500**
RBSM meetings-up 123%.
- **2,400+ exhibitors**
600+ international buyers
90 countries represented.



FROM LOCAL SKILLS TO GLOBAL MARKETS UP WOMENLEAD THE ENTERPRISE STORY

- **3 Districts, One Global Platform:** Women entrepreneurs from Meerut, Ghaziabad and Bulandshahr are showcasing their enterprises and connecting with new domestic and international markets.
- **7 Women Gain Employment:** Anjali's growing enterprise now provides regular employment to 7 other women, extending the impact of women-led entrepreneurship.
- **From Meerut to Global Markets:** Soul for Earth,



led by Harpreet Kaur, has expanded beyond local markets, with its products reaching markets outside India.

- **Women Drive the Full Business Cycle:** Entrepreneurs are moving beyond production to take charge of branding, sales, customer outreach and market expansion.
- **SHGs Strengthen Self-Reliance:** Women associated with Self-Help Groups are turning local skills into income-generating enterprises, creating pathways to financial independence and wider livelihoods.

UP TOURISM: HERITAGE MEETS GLOBAL OPPORTUNITY

- **5.5 Lakh Visitors:** The UP Tourism pavilion attracted 5.5 lakh visitors, with nearly 10,000 travel guides and itineraries sought.
- **Investment & Collaboration:** The pavilion generated 100+ investment/collaboration inquiries and engaged with 20 tour operators.
- **Beyond Iconic Destinations:** Neeb Karori Baba route, Kannauj's perfume heritage, wildlife and eco-tourism highlighted UP's diverse tourism potential.
- **Immersive Experiences:** VR Braj Leela, live zardozi, Kathak and Mayur dance, alongside interactive installations, brought UP's heritage to life.



PAVILIONS THAT STOOD OUT

- **Excellence Recognised:** Outstanding pavilions were honoured for innovation, creativity and impactful presentation, with participation from government departments, PSUs, authorities, banks, institutions and leading companies.
- **UP Police:** Won the Best Display Award for the third consecutive year, following honours in 2024 and 2025. Its showcase featured cybercrime prevention, UP 112, police technology and modern security services.
- **UP Skill Development Mission:** Won the Best Performance Stall award in Hall 7, featuring 16 live skill demonstrations and showcasing youth talent and craftsmanship.



INFORMATION PAVILION: KNOWLEDGE MEETS YOUTH ASPIRATIONS

- **Career & Learning Hub:** Competitive-exam books and publications, including Uttar Pradesh Varshiki, attracted young aspirants.
- **Heritage & Development:** Books and digital showcases presented UP's history, culture, spirituality and development journey.
- **Interactive Attraction:** Selfie zones featuring Ayodhya, Varanasi, Vrindavan and Sarnath drew strong visitor interest, with waits reaching nearly 30 minutes.
- **Knowledge Through Engagement:** The pavilion combined learning, cultural awareness and interactive experiences for young visitors.



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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• GLOBAL

Bolsonaro Jr's 'Trump card' over Lula in Brazil polls

Rishika Singh
New Delhi, October 7

IN THE first round of Brazil's presidential elections on Sunday, incumbent President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva and Flávio Bolsonaro received 45% and 47% of the vote, respectively. Since neither won over 50% of the vote but still secured the most votes among all candidates, they will go head-to-head in another round of voting on October 25. Flávio Bolsonaro is the son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, who won the 2018 elections and rejected the 2022 loss to Lula. In 2023, Bolsonaro Sr's supporters stormed government offices in the capital, Brasília, evoking visuals of US President Donald Trump's supporters attacking the US Capitol in 2021. Jair Bolsonaro is serving a 27-year sentence in relation to the attempted 2023 coup.

The Bolsonaro clan

Flávio Bolsonaro, 45, is a lawyer by training. A senator from Rio de Janeiro, he bears a striking physical resemblance to his polarising father. In the 2022 election, the closest in Brazil's history, Lula received 50.9% of the votes against the senior Bolsonaro's 49.1%. Jair Bolsonaro's supporters saw him as a conservative, pro-business politician who would "tell it like it is", similar to other populist right-wing leaders globally. Among his key policies was relaxing protections for the Amazon rainforest to encourage commercial activities. His vow to combat graft was notable, since his rise was fuelled by mainstream political figures getting implicated in major corruption scandals. Jair Bolsonaro is also known to make homophobic and misogynistic statements. He was also criticised for his handling of the Covid-19 pandemic, with Brazil having the second-highest death toll among countries, after the US. The Bolsonaros have enjoyed voter support among more well-off groups, the more conservative Evangelical Christians, and the country's southern regions. On the other hand, Lula, 80, is a veteran socialist now contesting for a fourth term with supporters such as Catholics, progressives and poorer groups. Flávio has criticised Lula for not being tough enough on crime and drug gangs.

Flávio Bolsonaro, 45, is a lawyer by training. AP

Jair Bolsonaro is also known to make homophobic and misogynistic statements. He was also criticised for his handling of the Covid-19 pandemic, with Brazil having the second-highest death toll among countries, after the US. The Bolsonaros have enjoyed voter support among more well-off groups, the more conservative Evangelical Christians, and the country's southern regions. On the other hand, Lula, 80, is a veteran socialist now contesting for a fourth term with supporters such as Catholics, progressives and poorer groups. Flávio has criticised Lula for not being tough enough on crime and drug gangs.

The Trump factor

Since Jair Bolsonaro's presidential term, which partly overlapped with the first Trump administration, Trump has publicly supported him owing to their similar ideology and disdain for critics. He met Flávio Bolsonaro earlier this year, calling him a "smart young man, who loves his country, Brazil, very much". Within months of his second term, Trump announced 50% tariffs on imports from Brazil in July 2025 for "threats" to the US. The executive order also noted that Brazilian officials were "persecuting" Jair Bolsonaro and that this "contributes to the deliberate breakdown in the rule of law in Brazil". Trump has earlier warmed up to other strongman leaders globally, with vocal support for those from South America. Another example is Argentina's Javier Milei. This approach is also in line with the US National Security Strategy, released in 2025. It laid out intentions for the US to be dominant in the Western Hemisphere. Its effects were seen in the capture of Venezuelan President Nicolas Maduro.

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• HISTORY

'Greatest headache': Constituent Assembly on appointing Election Commission

EXPERT EXPLAINS

INDU BHUSHAN

FORMER IAS OFFICER AND ECONOMIST

ON JUNE 15, 1949, a little-remembered member of the Constituent Assembly named Shibban Lal Saxena rose to object to a deceptively simple clause. The draft Constitution said the President would appoint India's Election Commissioners. In a parliamentary system, Saxena pointed out, that meant the government of the day would effectively be choosing the referee for its own contests. "It is quite possible that some party in power who wants to win the next election may appoint a staunch party-man as the

chief Election Commissioner," he warned. Saxena said he wasn't accusing anyone and even called the sitting Prime Minister lucky to have the independence and impartiality he did. But that, he said, was exactly the problem with resting a constitutional safeguard on the character of one man. "We are making a Constitution for ever, and not only for today," he said. Saxena proposed that appointing an Election Commissioner should require a two-thirds majority in Parliament: not to make the Commission answerable to Parliament, but to make it impossible for one party to install its own nominee. The Assembly voted his proposal down. But the warning stayed on the record. The next day, H N Kunzru pushed further. Provincial governments had been kept out of election administration because they might be politically biased. Fair enough, he said — but why assume the Central Government would be any less capable of bias? Kunzru wanted safeguards strong

enough that Commissioners could act "fearlessly", and then delivered a stark warning: "Worked by people whose integrity cannot be depended upon, democracy will be poisoned at the source." **The eventual compromise** Even B R Ambedkar didn't dismiss the concern. He called it one of the Drafting Committee's "greatest headaches". He considered borrowing the American model, where the Senate confirms presidential appointments, but worried it would import its own political games. The eventual compromise: the Constitution would establish the Election Commission and shield the Chief Election Commissioner from easy removal, but leave Parliament to legislate the actual appointment mechanism. That became Article 324 — a foundation with the front door deliberately left unlocked. For 74 years, Parliament never walked through that door. No law was passed. Then, in 2023, the Supreme Court did what

Parliament hadn't: in Anoop Baranwal v. Union of India, it ruled that until Parliament acted, appointments should be recommended by a committee of the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition, and the Chief Justice of India (CJI), a structure built to keep any one side from controlling the outcome. Parliament did act. The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, replaced the CJI on the selection panel with a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. Now, two of three seats on the committee effectively answer to the same person. **The perception of impartiality** None of this proves an Election Commissioner appointed under the new law will act improperly, or that the Commission has turned partisan. But it does raise a legitimate constitutional question, and it's almost exactly the one Saxena and Kunzru asked in 1949: does this appointment mechanism give the government enough

distance from the body that referees elections involving the government itself? Simply put: In an election, the government is one of the contestants. The Election Commission is the referee. The question was never whether the referee will actually favour one side. Actually, most of the time, individual Commissioners will do their jobs honestly. The question is whether a system that lets one contestant hold disproportionate sway over who gets to referee should be designed. This is precisely why Saxena refused to let the Constitution's safeguards depend on who happened to be Prime Minister at the time. His argument was structural, not personal. It's a design principle, not a character judgment, and it holds regardless of who sits in which chair today. The system should be such that the selection of the referee should not only be impartial but also appear to be so. This controversy isn't really about any individual Commissioner's competence or integrity. It's about whether the architecture

of appointment produces both the right incentives and the right perception — because in institutions of this kind, the appearance of independence often matters as much as the fact of it. A referee no one fully trusts is, for practical purposes, no referee at all. Seventy-seven years after Kunzru's warning against a flawed electoral machinery, the argument has looped back to that exact source: who chooses the people who run the machinery? The Constituent Assembly saw the danger clearly, debated it seriously, and then — perhaps wisely, perhaps not — left the final answer to a Parliament that would one day have to decide for itself. Whether Parliament decided well is the debate we are having today, but what's striking is how little the terms of that debate have changed. Sometimes, the sharpest commentary on the present isn't written by today's columnists at all. It was spoken, on the floor of the Constituent Assembly, by those who could not have known exactly how the future would test their words, only that it eventually would.

• NOBEL PRIZE IN CHEMISTRY

Mirror-image molecules and the chemistry of life

AMITABH SINHA

CERTAIN MOLECULES exist in two forms, each a non-superimposable mirror image of the other — like the left and right hands of human beings. Chemically, the two forms are the same in the sense that they are composed of the same set of atoms, connected in the same order. The difference is only in the relative three-dimensional arrangement of those atoms, such that one happens to be the mirror image of the other. This structural asymmetry, called chirality, becomes particularly interesting in biology. Many of the fundamental molecules in biology, like the amino acids that make up proteins or the sugars in DNA, appear in only one form. The mirror image versions of these amino acids or the sugars do exist, but they are rarely used in these biological settings. This preference for homochirality in life forms has intrigued scientists for long. This year's Nobel Prize in Chemistry has been awarded to two scientists, Henry Kagan and Kenso Soai, for demonstrating how this homochirality can emerge. The normal chemical processes used to produce a chiral molecule results in the production of both forms, called enantiomers. Kagan developed a way of manipulating these processes in such a manner that one form was produced in much greater proportion than the other. Soai took a step further and designed the first chemical reaction in which only one of the enantiomers was produced. Outside of biological processes, such a result had never been achieved.

The first breakthrough

The propensity of biochemistry to prefer one particular enantiomer over the other was initially thought to be something unique for life forms. After all, when chiral

• 'FOR THE DISCOVERY OF NON-LINEAR EFFECTS AND AUTOCATALYSIS IN ASYMMETRIC ORGANIC SYNTHESIS'

"Like hands, all amino acids exist as two mirrored variants, but only one of them is found in the proteins in your cells. The other is rarely found in nature."

HENRI B KAGAN, 96
Professor Emeritus at then Université Paris-Sud, France

KENSO SOAI, 76
Professor Emeritus at Tokyo University of Science, Japan

WHEN MIRROR-IMAGE MOLECULES HARMED BABIES

A DRUG FOR MORNING SICKNESS: Thalidomide was introduced in the late 1950s and marketed by a West German pharma company as a sedative. It was widely prescribed, including to pregnant women for morning sickness.

BIRTH DEFECTS: By 1961, doctors had linked the drug to severe birth defects. Thousands of babies across 46 countries were affected, many with phocomelia, in which limbs are severely shortened or absent.

THE MIRROR-IMAGE PROBLEM: Thalidomide exists as two mirror-image molecules, or enantiomers. One caused birth defects while the other produced the desired effects. Later, it was found the two forms can interconvert (change into each other) in the body.

ON THURSDAY: NOBEL PRIZE IN LITERATURE

molecules were produced in laboratories, a mixture of both enantiomers was obtained in almost even proportions. However, way back in the early 1900s, German chemist Willy Marckwald had been successful in carrying out a chemical reaction in which the proportion of the yields of the two enantiomers was slightly asymmetric. Marckwald had used a catalyst — a chemical that speeds up the reaction without itself getting consumed into it — which itself was chiral. And this had led to one mirror-image form being produced more than the other. However, subsequent attempts to increase the asymmetry in the yields of the two enantiomers remained unsuccessful. Besides, scientists still did not understand how the use of a chiral catalyst was affecting the reaction in a manner that one enantiomer was produced in greater quantity. It was Kagan, working in the 1980s, who eventually answered these questions. Before him, it was believed that there was a

Some key terms

- Chirality:** The phenomenon of molecules existing in mirror-image forms — much like your left and right hands.
- Homochirality:** The preference for one mirror-image form of a molecule in life forms.

linear relationship between the catalyst's chirality and the proportion in which the two forms of the product were produced. In other words, if the catalyst itself contained a disproportionate amount of one form, this would get reflected in the proportions of the final product as well. Kagan was able to show that this was not true, and that much greater asymmetry in production could be achieved even if the catalyst was only mildly chiral. In the process he was also able to demonstrate the internal dynamics of how this was happening. **The next step** This breakthrough created a new excitement in the field. While studying one of the chemical reactions that had produced one particular enantiomer in large quantities, Soai realised that there were significant similarities in the catalyst used and the final product. That prompted him to explore autocatalytic reactions — chemical reactions in which the final products them-

Some molecules exist in two forms, but life's building blocks use only one. Soai and Kagan showed how to make just that form in labs — crucial for medicines

selves act as catalysts. None of the autocatalytic reaction known at the time Soai started experimenting with them in the 1990s were known to produce asymmetric formation of enantiomers. After about a decade of trying, he finally succeeded in carrying out an autocatalytic reaction that resulted in the production of one particular enantiomer, which then formed copies of itself in a self-replicating process. The final product contained 99.5% of one enantiomer, a result comparable to the kind of preference seen in biological processes for a particular version of a chiral molecule.

Mysteries of life

The work of Kagan and Soai has demonstrated that homochirality can be obtained in the laboratory as well. It was not exclusive to nature. Their work does not solve the origin of the puzzle of life — how biological processes themselves preferred homochirality. But it did open up fresh avenues for scientists to try and understand the chemistry of life. Possibly the biggest practical implication of their work has been in the pharmaceutical industry. Many drug molecules are chiral, and it matters immensely which particular enantiomer has to be used. This is because the human bodies prefer only those enantiomers. The other variety of molecule might not just be ineffective, they can even be harmful. Before this Nobel Prize-winning work showed how one single enantiomer could be produced, pharma companies had been manufacturing the drug molecules as a mixture of both enantiomers, and then the desirable enantiomer was separated through a separate process. This was an expensive, wasteful and often technically difficult way of achieving the final result. The asymmetric synthesis of a particular enantiomer, as shown by Kagan and Soai, is already being used widely by the pharmaceutical industry. This is relevant for the manufacturing of all other substances that are meant to interact with living organisms, including flavours, fragrances and agricultural chemicals like pesticides.

• LEGAL

Detention vs arrest: The extent and limits of police's powers

Amaal Sheikh

New Delhi, October 7

LEADER OF Opposition Rahul Gandhi was detained on Wednesday as Opposition leaders protested in New Delhi demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise. This was the second time in as many days that the Congress leader had been detained. Since October 2, the Delhi Police has detained hundreds of protesters.

How does detention differ from arrest?

Police are empowered to maintain law and order, particularly during protests and demonstrations. In practice, this may sometimes look like an arrest and at other times a detention, often because these terms are used interchangeably. "Arrest" is a formal act of police taking a person into custody in connection with an offence, marking the beginning of criminal proceedings. Once a person is arrested, a range of constitutional and statutory safeguards immediately come into play. The Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (or BNSS, which replaced the Code of Criminal Procedure or CrPC) does not define "detention" perse. Instead, it gives police a set of powers that allows them to stop, remove or temporarily hold people in certain situations. This is why disputes arise

after protests. Someone may be taken away by police, kept in custody for several hours, and released without any case being registered. To the person involved, it can feel very much like an arrest. Legally, however, police may say that they were exercising preventive powers rather than arresting the individual for an offence. Senior Advocate Sanjay Hegde drew a distinction between a formal arrest and the short-term custody often seen during protests. "They are temporarily not allowed to leave wherever they are detained, and they are not put under a formal arrest either," he told *The Indian Express*. Advocate Soutik Banerjee told *The Indian Express* that the distinction is often used to avoid the scrutiny that accompanies a formal arrest. "The police know that the power to arrest cannot be exercised casually when there is no cognizable offence punishable with more than seven years being committed by the protestors. If they are arrested, courts will come down heavily on them," he said. A cognizable offence is one for which police can arrest without a warrant. **SECTION 170** of the BNSS allows preventive action before any offence is committed. A police officer, "knowing of a design to commit any cognizable offence may arrest, without orders from a magistrate and without a warrant, the person so designing, if it appears to such officer that the commission of the offence cannot be otherwise prevented".



Gandhi at Jantar Mantar on Wednesday

Your rights

- Article 22 of the Constitution deals with protection of an accused against arrest and detention.
- It requires production of an accused person before a magistrate within 24 hours; information about the grounds of arrest; and the right to have legal representation. The Supreme Court, in multiple cases, has held that written grounds of arrest must be furnished.

SECTION 172 of the BNSS says a police officer "may detain or remove any person resisting, refusing, ignoring or disregarding" a lawful direction. The officer must then take the person before a magistrate or, in petty cases, release them within 24 hours. Unlike the earlier CrPC, this provision expressly allows police to "detain or remove" a person who refuses to comply with a lawful direction. "Section 172(2) BNSS is new. The CrPC had no equivalent," Hegde said. "The CrPC let police prevent cognizable offences and arrest to prevent them. It did not bind citizens to obey police directions, nor let police detain those who refused. Section 172 adds both..." The idea came from state police statutes, not the CrPC. The 24-hour limit was itself a late addition." The practice of briefly taking protesters into custody is different from "preventive

detention" — which allows a person to be held without trial under special laws such as the National Security Act.

When can police detain people?

Most protest-related detentions begin with a claim that police are trying to prevent a law and order problem. Often, there is already a prohibitory order in place. On October 2, the Delhi Police imposed Section 163 of the BNSS across New Delhi. If protestors refuse to disperse or continue activities prohibited by such an order, police may invoke preventive powers to remove them from the spot or hold them temporarily. Disobeying such an order is itself an offence under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (or BNS, which replaced the Indian Penal Code or IPC). That is the point at which a detention can turn into an arrest with an FIR. Courts have, however, said that such actions cannot be arbitrary. Police must be able to explain why restricting a person's liberty was necessary. The Supreme Court, in *Joginder Kumar v. State of UP* (1994) held that "the existence of the power to arrest is one thing" and "the justification for the exercise of it is quite another". In *Armesh Kumar v. State of Bihar* (2014), the court told police not to arrest automatically in offences punishable up to seven years. In *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018) the court held that restrictions on protests should be regulatory rather than eliminating the right to protest altogether.

MPc's AUG 5, OCT 7 DECISIONS WERE BOTH UNANIMOUS

Dovish in August to hawkish: How MPC flipped in 2 months

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 7

IT WAS almost a foregone conclusion that the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) would increase the policy repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.5% on Wednesday. What was not as widely expected was that the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) would also make the policy stance more restrictive — from ‘neutral’ to ‘calibrated tightening’.

This shift is important. As Governor Sanjay Malhotra said, interest rate cuts are now “off the table in the near term.”

According to Madhavi Arora, Chief Economist at Emkay Global Financial Services, the change means RBI has “clearly prepared markets for a higher-for-longer interest rate environment”.

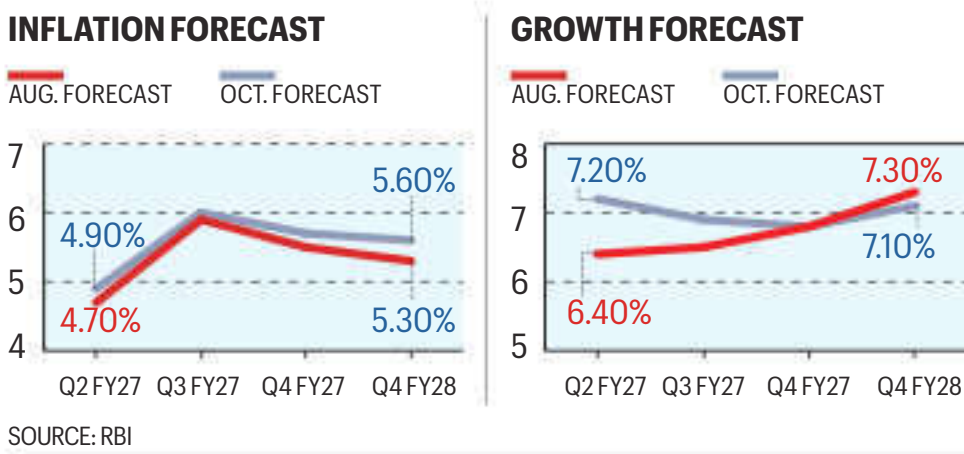
While some economists did and continue to predict only a shallow rate hike cycle of 50 bps or so, markets had already priced in a long-ish hiking cycle of at least 100 bps. This was despite the MPC’s unexpected dovishness in August, when it said there were “little signs of generalisation of price pressures so far” — an assessment that left some economists unconvinced.

Generalisation of inflation means higher prices spreading to other parts of the CPI basket.

A stark example of this generalisation has been seen recently: with commercial cooking gas getting expensive after the start of the West Asia war, restaurants and cafes sharply increased prices on their menu.

Consider the following: the number of items in the CPI basket whose inflation was more than 4% was 65 in January and rose to 110 in August. Moreover,

• How CPI, growth forecasts have changed



prices of 314 of the 358 items were higher in August compared to July. In February, this number was 236. Data for September may show more of the same.

Little change in data

When the MPC last met, it had with it the Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation data for June, which had risen to 4.38% from 3.93% in May.

Meanwhile, Wholesale Price Index (WPI) inflation had edged up similarly to 9.87% from 9.68%.

Since then, inflation developments on both fronts have not been outsized; while retail inflation has risen to 4.82% in August, wholesale prices rose by 9.92%.

The RBI is mandated to target a CPI inflation rate of 4% in the medium-term in a band of 2-6%.

Of course, the MPC must be forward-looking and take a view on what it thinks inflation might be a year or so down the line because interest rate changes impact growth and inflation with a delay of 9-12 months. However, the RBI’s own projections have not moved dramatically.

“The Governor’s statement emphasising that average inflation of 5.8% over the next three quarters with core inflation pro-

jected at 4.4% needs policy recalibration reinforces the hawkishness,” said Puneet Pal, PGIM India Mutual Fund’s Head of Fixed Income. Pal expects incrementally 75-100 bps of rate hikes over the next nine months.

But even back in August, these forecasts were not markedly different. Retail inflation was expected to average almost 5.6% in the three quarters starting October, while core inflation was seen at 4.3% this fiscal. But it is only now that the MPC sees “some evidence of elevated inflation expectations and generalisation of inflation”.

What has materially changed is the growth outlook and major central banks having raised their own policy rates.

But the central bank focuses on domestic inflation and growth developments. And signs have been apparent for a while now that price pressures are spreading due to weak rains, the El Nino, and higher memory chip prices, among other factors. The reasons behind the MPC’s turn between August and now may explain what lies ahead.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Repo rate hikes to continue, SBI sees 50 bps jump by Dec

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 7

THE RESERVE Bank of India’s Monetary Policy Committee is widely expected to keep increasing interest rates in the coming months after kicking off the tightening cycle on Wednesday, with Soumya Kanti Ghosh, State Bank of India’s Group Chief Economic Adviser, calling for a 50-basis-point hike either in the December 2-4 meeting or even before that.

“Given the steepening inflation trajectory currently underway, we believe that the December policy cycle could mostly deliver a jumbo 50 bps rate hike depending on the global conditions,” Ghosh said in a report. “Given that global conditions are likely to turn volatile soon, the window of opportunity of RBI rate hike in small increments must be avoided. A 6% repo rate by December could be the best possible option.” According to SBI’s estimates, headline retail inflation may peak at 6.8% in November, data for which will be released around a week after the MPC announces its next interest rate decision.

Rate cuts ‘off the table’

On Wednesday, the MPC raised the repo rate for the first time in over three-and-a-half years, with its 25-bps increase taking the policy rate to 5.5%. The committee also made its

‘stance’ more restrictive, changing it to ‘calibrated tightening’ from ‘neutral’, which means “rate cuts are off the table in the near term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving conditions and the outlook”. The central bank also raised its inflation forecast for the current fiscal to 5.2% from 5%, peaking at an average of 6% in the October–December quarter. The MPC also noted that there is “some evidence of elevated inflation expectations and generalisation of inflation”, marking a departure from its assessment in August that there were “little signs of generalisation of price pressures so far”.

25 bps hike in Dec?

SBI’s Ghosh is in the minority with his call to increase the repo rate by 50 bps on December 4 or even before that. A snap poll of 15 economists showed the consensus view is for two more rate hikes of 25 bps each — amounting to a 50 bps rise in the repo rate — over the next six months or so.

Economists widely expect the MPC to raise the repo rate by another 25 bps to 5.75% in December. Some, such as HSBC economists led by Pranjal Bhandari, continue to predict only one more rate hike of 25 bps later this year.

“Yes, there is risk of another, especially if growth remains resilient despite a strengthening

El Niño. But for now, we don’t see this as a deep rate hiking cycle,” they said. “Implicit in this is our belief that interest rate hikes are not being prioritised to shore up the INR. Instead, they are being used for lowering inflation (which in turn, may have a positive impact on the INR).”

The rupee fell on Wednesday, closing at 96.78-per-dollar after having fallen as low as 96.86 — not far from its all-time low of 96.96. Responding to a query on the exchange rate at a press conference, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said financial markets could be “irrational” in the short term, with some indicators suggesting the rupee was undervalued.

More than 2 rate hikes?

A small number of economists also see the repo rate being raised by another 75-100 bps. According to Suyash Choudhary, Bandhan Mutual Fund’s Chief Investment Officer of Fixed Income, the current global macro environment is “exceptionally hawkish” for a country such as India that imports energy, maintains a current account deficit, and needs its “fair share” of dollar inflows.

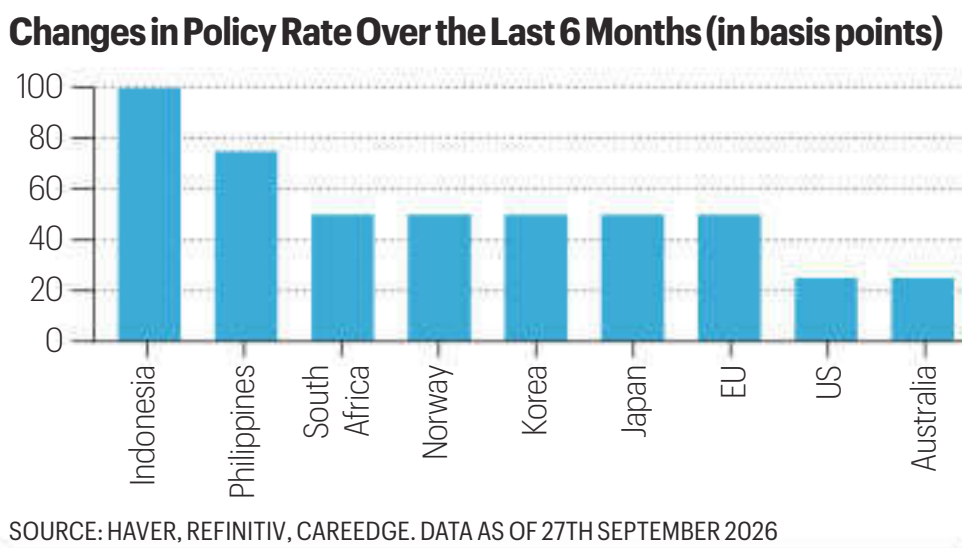
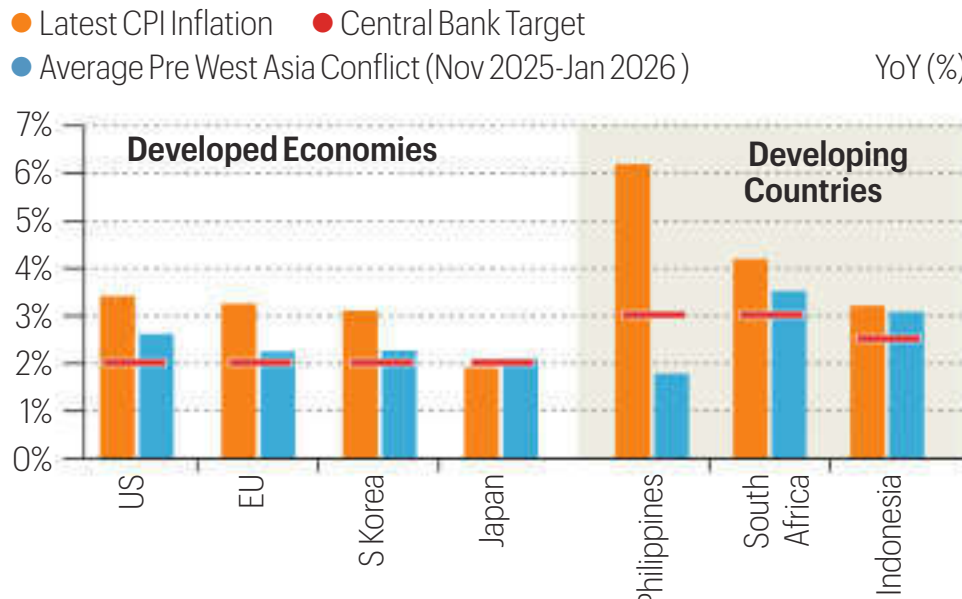
“In the present case higher global real yields and broad-based commodity pressures provide limited degrees of freedom for RBI. Our view is of total rate hikes of 100–125 bps including the one done today,” Choudhary added.

• RBI JOINS INTEREST RATE HIKE CLUB

It is not just India. Major central banks have tightened policy or raised interest rates in response to rising prices amid supply shocks and high crude oil prices.

Inflation in most economies has crossed the central banks’ comfort zone, and has been hovering above the pre-West Asia war era.

Inflation Remains Above Target in Most Economies



SOURCE: HAVER, REFINITIV, CAREEDGE. DATA AS OF 27TH SEPTEMBER 2026

NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT
INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE IN BIDDING PROCESS FOR GROUND HANDLING SERVICES CONCESSION AT NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT
Interested parties are invited to participate in the competitive e-tendering process for Ground Handling Services Concession at Navi Mumbai International Airport. Interested parties are requested to visit the website <https://nmiairport.abcpocure.com/> and access the Request for Qualification-cum-Request for Proposal (RFQP) document(s). For further details & instructions, please visit the E-Tender section of our website <https://navimumbai.adaniairports.com>
RFQP access shall be available from 8th October 2026, till IST 5:00 pm on 20th October 2026.
NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
Email: nmiaitenders2@adani.com
Website: <https://navimumbai.adaniairports.com>

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru – 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383. Website: www.kiadb.in
No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-10/910/2026-27 Date: 07.10.2026
SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)
Tender under two cover bid system is invited for the works mentioned below as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors holding valid Electrical License issued from KCEI, Government of Karnataka who have got adequate financial resources, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the following work:
Name of the work : Providing Electrical Infrastructure Facilities at Dharwad Node Industrial Area, (Phase-II Part), Dharwad Taluk & District (Package-2). (2nd Call).
The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **22.10.2026 upto 04:00 pm.**
Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the E-Procurement Portal <https://kpppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/-
Chief Engineer - 2
DIPRI/CP/JA/3126/2026-27

Long-term cost of homeownership set to increase



• Household budget strain

THE RBI’S repo rate is the price at which banks borrow from the central bank. When that rate rises, borrowing costs across the financial system tend to move up

ON A Rs 50 lakh home loan for 20 years, a 25-basis-point increase can mean roughly Rs 780 more in monthly EMI and nearly Rs 1.88 lakh in additional interest outgo

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 7

A 25-BASIS-point repo rate hike may look insignificant on paper. For a homebuyer, it is anything but small.

On a Rs 50 lakh home loan taken for 20 years, a 25-basis-point increase can mean roughly Rs 780 more in monthly EMI and nearly Rs 1.88 lakh in additional interest outgo over the life of the loan, experts say.

For a household already struggling to make the down payment and qualify for a loan, the RBI’s rate decision can turn an affordable home into a big liability.

Pain does not stop with EMI

The RBI’s repo rate is the price at which banks borrow from the central bank. When that rate rises, borrowing costs across the financial system tend to move up. Floating-rate home-loan borrowers are particularly exposed because their interest rates are linked, directly or indirectly, to benchmark rates — repo rate. The increase can either push up the EMI or force the borrower to stay indebted for longer. According to experts, banks may choose to

Banks raise external benchmark linked lending rates

Mumbai: Several banks revised their external benchmark linked lending rates (EBLR) by 25 basis points (bps) after the Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday hiked the repo rate by 25 bps to 5.50%, the first hike in nearly three-and-a-half years. These revised EBLR rates will be in effect from October 8.

EBLR linked loans primarily consist of retail loans, personal loans and MSME loans. FE

increase the loan tenure rather than allow the EMI to jump sharply. That may soften the immediate monthly shock, but it is hardly a free lunch. A longer tenure means the borrower remains in debt for more years and can end up paying considerably more interest. For first-time homebuyers, the problem is even more severe. Loan eligibility is determined partly by the borrower’s income and repayment capacity. Higher interest rates reduce the amount a household can borrow for the same EMI.

• MARKETS

 Sensex 72,638.70 -429.11 -0.59%	 NIFTY 22,603.05 -173.05 -0.76%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,47,767	 US Dollar ▲ ₹96.78
		 Silver ▼ ₹2,20,866	 Oil ▼ \$117.58

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 6, 2026

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF HARYANA
MAHENDERGARH (HARYANA) - 123031
Ref. No.: CUH/2026/Estt.Sec.IT/808 Date: 06.10.2026
WALK-IN-INTERVIEW
The Walk-in-Interview for engagement of Guest Faculty in various departments will be held on **16.10.2026 at 09:00 AM** in the Administrative Block, Central University of Haryana, Mahendergarh. Details regarding departments, vacancies, reservation, eligibility, prescribed application form, and general instructions are available on the University website www.cuh.ac.in.
REGISTRAR

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice
Tender No : 05/2026-27/PPD/TVM
Others - Grey Water Reuse-15 MLD Tertiary Treatment Plant at Muttathara - Design, Engineering, Procurement, Construction, Erection, Commissioning and Operation & Maintenance for a period of 5 years after successful commissioning of 15 MLD Tertiary Treatment Plant for Tertiary Treatment of Sewage Effluent at STP Muttathara, Thiruvananthapuram
EMD : Rs. 5,00,000/- Tender fee : Rs. 16,540 + 18% GST Last Date for submitting Tender : 02-11-2026 03:00 pm Phone : 8547638425 Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in
www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
KWA-JB-GL-6-340-2026-27
Superintending Engineer
PPD Regional Office
Thiruvananthapuram

TAMIL NADU SMALL INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED
(An Undertaking of the Government of Tamil Nadu)
A-28, Thiru-Vi-Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai-32.
Telephone No.044-2250 1632, FAX No.044-2250 0411
e-TENDER NOTICE
Rc. No. TANSI/676/2026-PA
1 Procurement of Best Quality of Teakwood of various sizes and Thickness
2 Procurement of 0.6mm Balancing Laminated Sheet and 0.6mm Flexible Laminated of various colours and different shades of size: 8'x 4', as per IS: 2046:1995
3 Procurement of CR Sheet Various Sizes and thickness as per IS 513
REFER THE FOLLOWING WEBSITE FOR DOWNLOAD TENDER DOCUMENTS AND OTHER INFORMATIONS : www.intenders.gov.in
Additional Chief Secretary /
Chairman and Managing Director
DIPR/3031/Tender/2026

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.
No. NT/2026-27/02N-48 Date: 06.10.2026
निविदा सूचना, 2026-27
निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए केन्द्र, राज्य सरकार के अधिकाधिक विभागों एवं उनके अधिकृत संगठनों में पंजीकृत एवं अनुपची संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रथम में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं:-
कार्य का विवरण कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (₹.) शीर्षक सूचना संख्या
Construction of Proposed Boundary wall around MDS University Land, Ajmer. 202.92 अकरालीन
UBN: RRC2627WSOB00664 1 Lakh ₹-398/26-27
Immediate road repair of damaged portion on Merta Lambiya Raas Road. 234.92 अकरालीन
UBN: RRC2627WSOB00666 1 Lakh ₹-401/26-27
Construction of various School Buildings in Rural areas in Alwar. 309.73 अकरालीन
UBN: RRC2627WSOB00640 1 Lakh ₹-404/26-27
Renewal work of Karauli-Hinduan-Mahwa Road. 498.36 अकरालीन
UBN: RRC2627WSOB00647 1 Lakh ₹-407/26-27
Construction of Cement Concrete Pavement with drain at various places of BOT Road Bhunapur-Beg-Alwar. UBN: RRC2627WSOB00646 465.76 अकरालीन
Repair and Maintenance work of Non-DLP portion of road BarBaseri-Bayana-Weir-Bhusawar-Chankarwar-Kherli Road. UBN: RRC2627WSOB00648 210.93 अकरालीन
Remaining work of Auditorium Building in Nagar Parishad Campus, Jhunjhunu. UBN: RRC2627WSOB00649 427.82 अकरालीन
₹-408/26-27
निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रश्न में निम्न प्रकार, धोखा, धोखा, धोखा करने व खोले की तारीख तारीख समुचित दिनांक एवं संवेदन वेबसाइट: <http://proc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in> तथा <http://pwwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc> पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने निविदा रखकर के पथन से वेबसाइट <http://proc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन करवाया जा सकता है।
प्रशासक

INTEROPERABILITY FOR NON-BANK ACCOUNT AGGREGATORS

What RBI move means for asset statement

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 7

DEMATERIALIZED ACCOUNTS have made it easy for investors to track their investments across financial markets, be it stocks, mutual funds, debt instruments, or commodities. This has made investing quite hassle-free for the common man, eliminating the need to track statements through different apps or depositories.

The RBI’s move to now allow “inter-operability” between financial account aggregators could also get your bank holdings into the singular consolidated statement, eliminating the need to track different bank statements to keep a check on

deposits. The RBI on Wednesday allowed “interoperability among NBFC Account aggregators, enabling aggregation of financial information through all account aggregators from one account aggregator.”

After the monetary policy statement, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said, “We are also facilitating SEBI regulated depositories to include information related to deposit accounts in their consolidated account statement.”

Account aggregators are non-banking financial companies who store and move the user’s banking data without having the permission to access it.

They act as a secure bridge

for banking data, allowing lenders to access all relevant data swiftly for faster loan disbursements, or manage consent for other companies attempting to fetch your data.

“The account aggregators are people with whom banks enter into a contract for the purpose of sharing information. You can get onboarded as a bank customer, consenting to provide your information. And on the basis of your information, they will be able to pull data,” said Vivek Iyer, Partner and National Leader for Financial Services at Grant Thornton Bharat.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



GUNNER BALBIR KUMAR
31 MAY 1983 - 08 OCTOBER 2005

In fond remembrance of Gunner Balbir Kumar who lived up to the highest traditions of Gunners of the Indian Army and made the supreme sacrifice while guarding the frontiers during the earthquake of 8th October 2005.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 237 FIELD REGIMENT, VIR CHAKRA PALTAN - YUDHE NIPUNAM.



GUNNER KISHOR KUMAR
02 MAY 1981 - 08 OCTOBER 2005

In fond remembrance of Gunner Kishor Kumar who lived up to the highest traditions of Gunners of the Indian Army and made the supreme sacrifice while guarding the frontiers during the earthquake of 8th October 2005.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 237 FIELD REGIMENT, VIR CHAKRA PALTAN - YUDHE NIPUNAM.



5050625A HAV THAKUR BAHADUR ALE MAGAR

On this day 5050625A Hav Thakur Bahadur Ale Magar of 5/1 Gorkha Rifles made the supreme sacrifice during 'OP RAKSHAK', Jammu and Kashmir in Oct 2023 in a true act of valour and courage. The brave soldier will always be remembered for his enthusiasm. To this brave heart we pledge that we shall always be guided by his immortal spirit and make his name proud.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 5/1 GORKHA RIFLES



11 GORKHA RIFLES REGIMENTAL CENTRE

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, SS-14081 Late Lt PC Das of 4/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during INDO PAK WAR (Operation Bison) on 08 Oct 1949.

COLONEL 11 GR & SIKKIM SCOUTS AND ALL RANKS



INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

ITBP salutes its bravehearts Head Constable Jaipal, Constable Shiv Prasad and Constable Dinesh of 35th Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Chhattisgarh in 2010.

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officers on their Balidan Diwas.

 SUB INSPECTOR H H THIPPAIAH 11 BN BSF 27.04.1948 - 08.10.1994	 ASSISTANT SUB INSPECTOR SONAM SUMBURI 130 BN BSF 10.02.1972 - 08.10.2024
 CONSTABLE YOGENDRA SINGH 94 BN BSF 01.01.1969 - 08.10.1998	 NAIK TUL BAHADUR CHHETRI, SHAURYA CHAKRA 73 BN BSF 01.07.1953 - 08.10.1980

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Shri A. P. Batra (IPS) Commandant **1 Bn** 1-5-1914 To 8-10-1959

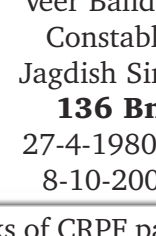
DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Shri A. P. Batra, IPS, Commandant, 1 BN CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly confronting armed hoodlums who were looting passengers aboard a train en route from Ajmer to Neemuch, on 8 October 1959. Despite being off duty, he fearlessly took on the criminals single-handedly and fought till his last breath after sustaining multiple stab injuries. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Shri R. S. Kuhar Second-in-Command **2 Bn** 29-5-1951 To 8-10-1990

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Shri R. S. Kuhar, Second-in-Command, 2 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining serious injuries while countering an attack by militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir, on 8 October 1990. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

 Veer Balidani Shri J.D. Amar Asstt. Comdt. 136 Bn 4-2-1972 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Wahid Ali 136 Bn 4-1-1950 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Head Constable Shanti Swaroop 136 Bn 6-4-1949 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Constable Nanak Singh 136 Bn 5-6-1968 To 8-10-2005
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 Veer Balidani Constable Abdul Rashid Mir 136 Bn 1-1-1971 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Constable Ashwani Kumar 136 Bn 8-1-1971 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Constable Abdul Rashid Khan 136 Bn 1-8-1978 To 8-10-2005
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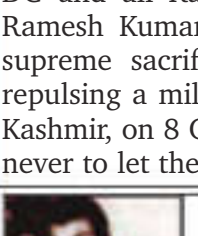
 Veer Balidani Constable Jagdish Singh 136 Bn 27-4-1980 To 8-10-2005	 Veer Balidani Constable Nazir Ahmed Khan 136 Bn 1-3-1976 To 8-10-2005
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DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to the nine bravehearts of 136 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly countering a Maoist attack despite being grievously injured in an IED blast in dist. Chattrra, Jharkhand on 8 October 2005. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

 Veer Balidani Constable Rishpal Singh 30 Bn 1-7-1971 To 8-10-2006	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Rishpal Singh of 30 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while fighting against the Maoists despite being seriously injured in an IED blast in dist. Bijapur, Chhattisgarh on 8 October 2006. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
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 Veer Balidani Constable Anup G. Nair 175 Bn 1-6-1983 To 8-10-2007	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Anup G. Nair of 175 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an attack by Maoists in dist. Kanker, Chhattisgarh on 8 October 2007. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
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 Veer Balidani Constable/Bugler Ramesh Kumar 45 Bn 16-7-1969 To 8-10-2002	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable/Bugler Ramesh Kumar and Constable D. G. Ade of 45 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly repulsing a militant attack at a polling booth in dist. Doda, Jammu & Kashmir, on 8 October 2002. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.
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 Veer Balidani Lance Naik Silai Kudada 24 Bn 12-5-1952 To 8-10-1990	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Silai Kudada of 24 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a grenade attack on 8 October 1990. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
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 Veer Balidani Naik Prabhunath Yadav 53 Bn 1-6-1952 To 8-10-1992	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik Prabhunath Yadav of 53 BN CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an ambush by insurgents in a dense jungle in Bongaigaon, Assam, on 8 October 1992. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
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WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of West Bengal Enterprise)
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhavan, Block-DJ, Sector-II, Bidhanagar, Kolkata-700091
CIN: U40101WB2007SGC113474 • web: www.wbsetcl.in

NIT No.: CE/0&M-II/WBSETCL/Kharagpur & Gokarna Tr. Bay/26-27/16 Date: 08.10.2026

Under the jurisdiction of the Chief Engineer (O&M)-II

E-Tender is invited for construction and erection of 400 kV, 220 kV, 132 kV Bays, 315 MVA, 400/220/33 kV Transformer, 400 kV Reactor, 160 MVA, 220/132/33 kV Transformer at Kharagpur 400 kV sub-station and Gokarna 400 kV sub-station along with allied work on turnkey basis. Bid submission starting date (online): 30.10.2026, 06:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 18.11.2026, 04:00 P.M.

Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details.

ICAT/18728(2)/2026



MADHYA GUJARAT VIJ COMPANY LIMITED
Registered Office: Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Race Course, Vadodara 390007
Tel.No : (0265) 2310582-86
Web Site : www.mgvcl.com
E-mail : cetech.mgvcl@gbmail.com
CIN: U40102GJ2003SGC042907

E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender is invited for "Centralized call center management of MGVC Limited and Fault Rectification Team (FRT) at various subdivisions under jurisdiction of MGVC Limited FOR F.Y.2026-27:

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Tender ID	Tender Amount in Crs
1	MGVCL/TECH/CCC/26-27	352530	157.91

Details of tenders can be viewed and downloaded on www.mgvcl.com/Tender and can be viewed, downloaded & submitted on www.tender.nprocure.com

Chief Engineer (T&O), MGVC Limited corporate office, Vadodara

कार्यालय नगर परिषद भिवाड़ी (खैरथल-तिजारा) राज.
Tel. No.- 01493 294977 E-mail ID- bhiwadi.nagarpalika@gmail.com

क्रमांक-न.प.मि / 2026 - 27 / 5813 दिनांक- 06.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 29/2026-27

नगर परिषद भिवाड़ी क्षेत्र में "5 साल (32) के लिए व्यापक एकीकृत लोस अपशिष्ट प्रबंधन (ISWM) सुविधाएँ, जिसमें डोर-टू-डोर और सेकेंडरी कलेक्शन, मशीनी और मनुजल सड़क की सफाई, नालियों की सफाई, तय प्रोसेसिंग सेंटरों तक परिवहन और आम प्रोसेसिंग व निपटान शामिल हैं" कार्य हेतु निविदा वार्ता अनुसार सख्त सेवेदारों हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा फार्म ऑनलाइन वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड व <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर खोलनोड किये जा सकते हैं।

S. No.	Particulars	Detail
1	Name of Work	Comprehensive Integrated Solid Waste Management (ISWM) facilities including Doorstep, Secondary Collection, Mechanical & Manual Road Sweeping, Drain Cleaning and Transportation to designated processing centers and further Processing and Disposal of the same for 5 Years (3+2) in Bhiwadi.
2	Estimate Project Cost	01 works Total 124.20 Cr.
3	Earnest money (EMD) 2%	2484000/-
4	Cost of tender document (non-refundable) In favor of Commissioner Municipal Council Bhiwadi Payable at Bhiwadi	10000 Each
5	RISL Processing Fees (non-refundable) In favor of MD RISL Payable at Jaipur.	2500 Each (MD RISL Payable E -Grass Challan Portal)
6	Tender Publication on official web site http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in & http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in	07.10.2026 & Time 05.00 PM
7	Tender download start date	07.10.2026 & Time 05.10 PM
8	Bid Submission start date & Time	07.10.2026 & Time 05.20 PM
9	Pre-Bid meeting date & Time	23.10.2026 & Time 11.00 AM
10	Bid Submission End date & Time	12.11.2026 & Time 10.00 AM
11	Technical bid opening date & Time	12.11.2026 & Time 11.00 AM
12	NIB NO. -	DLB2627A8292
13	UBN NO. -	DLB2627SLRC21325

निविदादाताओं को प्रोसेसिंग फीस E-Grass Portal पर 56-Local Bodies Department मद में जरिये चालान जमा करनी होगी। E-Grass Portal पर प्रोसेसिंग फीस जमा नहीं कराने पर निविदादाता द्वारा प्रस्तुत निविदा को तकनीकी रूप से निरस्त कर दिया जाएगा। एवं अमानत राशि ऑनलाइन नगर परिषद भिवाड़ी के A/c No. 349401000374, IFSC Code --ICIC0003494, Branch-Bhiwadi, ICICI Bank पर Submission Date and Time से पूर्व जमा करवाकर उससे प्राप्त होने वाली रसीद को स्कैन करके www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in पर अपलोड करना होगा। [निकाय के अन्य किसी भी शांति स्वीकार नहीं की जायेगी। अन्यथा आपकी बिड को खोलने पर विचार नहीं किया जाएगा।] निविदा से सम्बंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> तथा sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

आयुक्त नगर परिषद, भिवाड़ी

राज.संवा./सी / 26 / 11458

Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No.: 9958/96M/E-TENDER/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated: 01.10.2026

Short Term E-Procurement Inviting Tenders

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bid online through <http://tender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractor registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Bridge work Category as applied from Date 09-10-2026 10:00 A.M. to 15-10-2026 up to 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 15-10-2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1.	Reconstruction work of Damaged and narrow Bridge Located at Km-2 of HSK to Aliabad Link Road	69.00	5.45	09 Month	Tender Cost Rs 300+ 2000+18% GST. Rs. 414.0=2714.00	Executive Engineer Construction Division 2, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone. P.W.D., Meerut	A B Bridge Work
2.	Reconstruction work of Damaged and narrow Bridge Located at Baroda Link road Km-1 in Firozpur	68.80	5.44	09 Month	Tender Cost Rs 300+ 2000+18% G.S.T. Rs. 414.0=2714.00	Executive Engineer Construction Division 2, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone P.W.D., Meerut	A B Bridge Work

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
4. Details of e-tender uploaded on <http://tender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on <http://tender.up.nic.in>
6. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr circle, PWD
Bulandshahr

(Partap Singh)
Executive Engineer C.D.-2,
PWD, Bulandshahr

Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No. 9970/96M/E-Tender/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated: 01.10.2026

E-Procurement Short Term Inviting Tender

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate short term bids online through <http://tender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Building Work Category as applied from Date 09-10-2026 10:00 A.M. to 15-10-2026 up to 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 15-10-2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Construction of four Type-4 residential units in a single block on Public Works Department land near Bhoor chauraha in District Bulandshahr.	170.00	10.50	12 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+ 2000+18% GST.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A (Building work)
2	Construction work of four Type-4 pooled residences located in the DM Colony of District Bulandshahr.	170.00	10.50	12 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+ 2000+18% GST.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A (Building work)
3	Construction of a boundary wall and a watchman's cabin around the PWD land situated near the fire station on the H a m i d p u r - Sikandraabad-Kuchesar road in the B.B. Nagar block of District Bulandshahr.	69.00	5.45	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+ 2000+18% GST.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Building work)
4	Reconstruction of a small bridge with a 3x5.00 meter span over the Neem River at km-2 of Dunga-Daraura Manjpur road in District Bulandshahr.	73.70	5.69	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Bridge work)

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. The Bidder should have same nature of work experience at least two years.
4. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
Details of e-tender uploaded on <http://tender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on <http://tender.up.nic.in>
6. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
7. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>

Executive Engineer P.D., PWD, Bulandshahr

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr circle, P.W.D. Bulandshahr

Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No. 9972/96M/E-Tender/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated. 01.10.2026

E-Procurement Short Term Inviting Tender

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate short term bids online through <http://tender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Bridge Work Category as applied from Date 09-10-2026 10:00 A.M. to 15-10-2026 up to 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 15-10-2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Reconstruction work involving the provision of a 3x6.00m RCC box culvert to replace the damaged minor arch bridge located at the Km-1 of the Damani link road in District Bulandshahr.	141.60	9.08	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Bridge work)
2	Reconstruction of a small bridge with a 3x5.00 meter span over the Neem River at km-2 of Dunga-Daraura Manjpur road in District Bulandshahr.	79.50	5.98	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Bridge work)
3	Reconstruction work of the bridge located at km 1 of the Bulandshahr-Tajpur Road (ODR) in District Bulandshahr	73.70	5.69	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0= 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Bridge work)

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. The Bidder should have same nature of work experience at least two years.
4. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
Details of e-tender uploaded on <http://tender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on <http://tender.up.nic.in>
6. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
7. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>

Executive Engineer P.D., PWD, Gautambudhnagar

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr circle, PWD Bulandshahr

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक यूनिट-31, कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, (30x90 सक्कार का उपक्रम) एस0बी0-90, शास्त्री नगर, गाजियाबाद-201002
निविदा सूचना सं.: 1800/Vividh-12/320 दिनांक : 07-10-2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से Construction of Chain Link Fencing Boundary Wall at State Livestock Com Agriculture Farm Babugarh, Hapur, अनुमानित लागत रू० 408.88 लाख (जी०एस० टी० रहित एवं लेबर सेस श्रेणी) हेतु सी०एण्ड टी०एस० में यथोचित अंश में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत केन्टेडोर से दिनांक 04.11.2026 के अग्रान्त 16.00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 08.10.2026 से दिनांक 04.11.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सक्कार की e-procurement वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 04.11.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 16.30 बजे सी०एण्ड टी०एस० यूनिट-31, 30x90 जल निगम, गाजियाबाद में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रू० 10000.00 + GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupn.org एवं प्रोकरॉयेन्ट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जाणें, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का सम्य-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

Advertisement

State Level Awards Year 2026-2027

The Government of Haryana has instituted various State Level Awards to honor women who have done outstanding work in various fields for their notable contributions and achievements and to encourage their contribution towards women empowerment and the development of society.

DETAILS OF AWARDS:-

Sr. No.	Name of Award	No of Awards	Award Money
1.	Smt. Sushma Swaraj Award	1	Rs. 5 Lakh & a citation
2.	Indira Gandhi Mahila Shakti Award	1	Rs. 1.50 Lakh & a citation
3.	Kalpna Chawla Shaurya Award	1	Rs. 1.00 Lakh & a citation
4.	Bahin Shano Devi Panchayti Raj Award	1	Rs. 1.00 Lakh & a citation
5.	Life time achievers award	1	Rs. 51,000/- & a citation
6(I)	Government Employees	4	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation
6(II)	Social Workers	4	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation
6(III)	Women Entrepreneurs	2	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation

HOW TO APPLY & IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS:-

1. **Mode of Application:** Applications must be submitted strictly online only through the dedicated online award portal on WCD Haryana Website.

2. **Guidelines:** Eligibility criteria, guidelines/notification can be downloaded from the official departmental website: <https://wcdhry.gov.in>.

3. **Rejection Criteria:** Applications sent via Post, Courier, or any offline medium will NOT be accepted. Incomplete applications or those submitted in an incorrect format will be summarily rejected.

Applications are open from 06 October to 05 November 2026


Scan QR to apply

No. 49981-4

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ms. Seema, M/s Jai Maa Plastics through its Sole Proprietor, R/o Plot No. 1543, HSIIDC Rai, District Sonapat, Haryana-131029** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI Act 6165/19, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ms. Seema** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ms. Seema** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ms. Seema** accused of **CC NI Act 6165/19, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Gaurav Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)-04, West DP/14185/WD/2026 Room No. 04, Tis Hazar Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Atif, S/o: Md. Nisar, R/o: H. No. C-4/A, 353, LNJP Colony, Ranjeet Singh Marg, Guru Nanak Hospital, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.824/2025, U/s: 304(2)/317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Police Station Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Atif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Atif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Atif** of **Police Station Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Central, 1st Floor, Room No. 138 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/14303/N/2026

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.

Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
M 264	CE / MM	Procurement of 11 KV AB Switch with Polymer PT Insulators
M 265	CE / MM	Procurement of 22 KV AB Switch with Polymer PT Insulators

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in DIPR/3062/Tender/2026

ANDHRA PRADESH STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD., (A STATE GOVERNMENT UNDERTAKING)

HEAD OFFICE, Sri Sai Towers, Door No-10-152/4, 4th & 5th Floor, Ashok Nagar, Besides Siris Company, Bandaru Road, Kanuru, Vijayawada-520007.

Ln.No. Proc/ M2/ PADDY/ KMS-2025-26 Date: 07-10-2026

TENDER NOTICE (2nd Call)

APPOINTMENT OF REVENUE DISTRICT WISE PADDY TRANSPORT CONTRACTORS FOR TRANSPORTATION OF PADDY FROM PPCs AT RSKs TO RICE TO GODOWNS IN WIN AND OUTSIDE THE DISTRICTS FOR KMS 2026-27 & 2027-28 UNDER ZONE-I, II & III THROUGH NCDEX E MARKETS LIMITED (NeML) AUCTION PLATFORM IN ANDHRA PRADESH.

Those who are interested to participate in tender should be registered with NCDEX e-Markets Ltd. on their website www.neml.in and can contact the Customer Service Group on phone numbers (+91-22) - 46810500/ 9862059599/ 9032429420 or email: askus@neml.in. Last date for online registration and completion of formalities for submitting the online tenders shall be up to 16.10.2026 by 5.00 PM IST. For complete details and to download tender documents at free of cost visit www.apscscl.in and www.neml.in

Sd/- VC & MANAGING DIRECTOR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manish Jain, R/o: H.No-685, Gali No-7, Govindpuri, New Delhi-110019** also **R/o: H.No-305-A, 2nd Floor, Govindpuri, New Delhi** also **R/o: M/S Grocery Boss Online Services Pvt. Ltd. 4-1/19-20, First Floor, Sector-04, Rohini, New Delhi-110085** and also **R/o: H.No-1590, 3rd Floor, Gali No-13, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT Case No.: 4663/20, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S. Sarita Vihar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manish Jain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manish Jain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manish Jain** of **P.S. Sarita Vihar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.01.2027**.

By Order
Ms. Shruti Sharma-I
Ld. JMFC NI Act-02, Room No. 609, Saket Court, New Delhi
DP/14100/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Fazil, S/o.: Akhtar, R/o.: H. No. C-407, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 603/2023 Dt. 04/07/2023, U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Narela Industrial Area, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Fazil** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Fazil** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Fazil**, accused of **FIR No. 603/2023 Dt. 04/07/2023, U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S Narela Industrial Area, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026**.

By Order, Sh. Sahil Gupta,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
DP/14229/ON/2026 North District, Court No. 6, Ground Floor, (Court Matter) Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Anshika Singh D/o Gulbir Singh, R/o H. No. 75, MCD Flats, Block-04, Sec-20, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 387/2024 U/s 109/354/354A/506 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Anshika Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Anshika Singh** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Anshika Singh** in **FIR No. 387/2024 U/s 109/354/354A/506 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.11.2026**.

By order
Ms. Jasjeet Kaur
Additional Sessions Judge-04 (POCSO)
North West, Room No. 203, 2nd Floor
District Courts, Rohini, Delhi
DP/14224/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Salman Ansari S/o Mohd. Yakub, R/o H.No. 1145, Gali No.-18/2, E-2 Block, Nehru Vihar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 76/2020, U/S 25/54/59 A. Act, PS Khajuri Khas, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salman Ansari** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Salman Ansari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Salman Ansari** the said accused of **FIR No. 76/2020, U/S 25/54/59 A. Act, PS Khajuri Khas, North-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.12.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
DP/14311/NE/2026 Court No.-22, 1st Floor, North-East Distt., (Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Abhishek S/o Babli R/o Village Mushrafpur Jhanda, PS Hafizpur, District Hapur, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **E-FIR No. 8515/2026 U/S 305(b)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Abhishek** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Abhishek** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Abhishek** of **E-FIR No. 8515/2026 U/S 305(b)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **16.11.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (Central)
Central District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/13952/CD/2026(Court Matter)

e-Procurement Cell, OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER BUILDING CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT BUILDING DIVISION NO. – 1, RANCHI (Behind State Guest House Morhabadi) Dindayal Nagar Booty Road Ranchi-834008

VERY SHORT TERM E-QUOTATION INVITATION NOTICE FOR RATE PURPOSE ONLY

Quotation Reference No: BCD/Bld. Div. No.- 1 --- 19/2026-27

Sealed Quotations are invited for the work **Proposed Semi Olympic Swimming Pool at JCSOI Club Campus, Deendayal Nagar, Ranchi** or all Materials from Reputed Shop Keepers/ Manufacturers / Suppliers / Retailers / Distributors and Registered B.C.D. Contractors for following items. They should quote their rates for unit mentioned in the table. If they do not deals all of the below mentioned items then they are allowed to quote their rate for part of the items which ever they deals. The rates should be exclusive of all types of Taxes, GST, Contractor's Profit and overhead charges etc. but inclusive of Royalty. All Rates should be exclusive of Labour Cess.

Terms and Condition 1. The quotationer shall furnish Pan, GST registration no.
2. The rate quoted by quotationer shall be firm and final.
3. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject/cancel any or all quotations without assigning any reason thereof.

नोट :- (1) वेबसाइट में ई-कोटेशन अपलोड की अंतिम तिथि : 16-10-2026 के अपराह्न 1:00 बजे तक।
(2) ई-कोटेशन खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : 17-10-2026 अपराह्न 1:30 बजे।
(3) ई-कोटेशन आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या-1, राँची।
(4) ई-कोटेशन प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० : 8527519262

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

Nodal Officer,
e-Procurement Cell, Office of the Executive Engineer Building Construction Department, Building Division No.-1, Ranchi

PR.NO.391301 Building(26-27):D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, जमशेदपुर
Email ID-rdsdjamshedpur@gmail.com

:- अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना :-
पत्रांक : 1211 जमशेदपुर/दिनांक 07/10/2026
अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या E-RSDS/JSR/02/2026-27/2ND CALL.

1.कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम (ITDA)	प्राकलित राशि (₹0)	अग्रघन की राशि (₹0)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (₹0)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	CONSTRUCTION OF 50 BEDDED HOSTEL AT BOYS RESIDENTIAL UPGRADED HIGH SCHOOL, SINGHPURA, LALKOTA, GURABANDA.	2,26,56,300.00	4,54,000.00	10,000.00	माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 08.10.2026
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय –दिनांक 08.10.2026 से दिनांक 15.10.2026 को अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।
4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, जमशेदपुर।
5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 16.10.2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे।
6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, जमशेदपुर।
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष संख्या – 9304896913
8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में।
11. अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पत्र पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,जमशेदपुर
PR 391297 (Rural Development)26-27'D

KONKAN RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED (A Government of India Undertaking)

Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd. USBRL Project office, Reasi, Jyotipuram Road, Timnha, Post Gran Morh, Reasi (Distt. Reasi) J&K 182311, Jammu & Kashmir

OPEN E-TENDER (Two-Packet System)

Tender Notice No. KR-PD-JK-EL-CT-08-2026 dated 07/10/2026.

Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd. Invites tender for "Supply and installation of Box Type Cable Tray (3 runs throughout the bridge) using GI support Structures, including shifting/re-routing of existing 3 runs of 3C x 300 sq.mm Copper Cables inside the installed cable trays, complete in all respects in the Katra-Banihal Section of Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link Project, Jammu & Kashmir."

Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 2.97/- Cr. Completion period of contract: 04 months. Submission of Tender: 28/10/2026 upto 15:00 hrs. Opening of Tender: 28/10/2026 @ 15:30 hrs. Cost of Tender Form: Nil. Earnest Money/ Bid Security: ₹ 5.94,683/- or as per IREPS to be submitted through online payment modes available on IREPS Portal only. For further details and updates please visit <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. Amendments/ Corrigendum, if any would be hosted on the above website only.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई- निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/DEOGHAR/02/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

क्रं एवं सुप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राकलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	देवघर जिला के सारवाँ प्रखंड अन्तर्गत ग्राम रक्ति से बबेरी के बीच जोरिया पर पुल निर्माण।	4,92,84,400.00	9,86,000.00	10000.00	18 माह
2	देवघर जिला के सारठ प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत डिण्डाकोली के डिण्डाकोली नैयाडोह जोरिया में उच्चस्तरयी पुल निर्माण।	3,40,44,300.00	6,81,000.00	10000.00	18 माह
3	देवघर जिला के मोहनपुर प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत पोस्तवारी के पचरुखी घाघर नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	4,34,03,400.00	8,68,100.00	10000.00	18 माह
4	देवघर जिला के देवघर प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत पुनासी के पुनासी टोला में ननजोरवा नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	4,79,08,800.00	9,58,200.00	10000.00	18 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 16.10.2026
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 16.10.2026 से दिनांक 05.11.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, देवघर
5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 07.11.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे
6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 8292390365 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)
8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पत्र पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर
PR 391283 Deoghar (26-27)_D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ENGAGEMENT OF USER FEE COLLECTION AGENCY ON THE BASIS OF COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH E-TENDER FOR 4 NOS. TOLL PLAZAS LOCATED IN FARIDABAD & GURUGRAM DISTRICTS IN THE STATE OF HARYANA INCLUDING INCIDENT MANAGEMENT & UPRKEEP/MAINTENANCE OF ADJACENT TOILET BLOCKS, INCLUDING RECOVERING THE CONSUMABLE ITEMS.	CLOSING DATE 19.10.2026	10448 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-epd1-gurgam@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, JIND	SPECIAL REPAIR OF JIND-SAFIDON ROAD TO SINGHANA AND MOANA TO P.C. SINGHANA AND MEHANA TO LINK OF DERA FATTU WALA TO ASSANDH ROAD (ROAD ID 6704, 6714, 12499) (UNDER NABARD RIDF-X003I FOR THE YEAR 2026-27).	CLOSING DATE 14.10.2026	442.38 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pweedepjind@gmail.com
3	PWD B&R, HANSI	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM BANIHORI TO KAPRI BY PROVIDING STRENGTHENING IN KM 0.00 TO 6.74 AND 6.77 TO 7.50 IN HISAR DISTT (ROAD ID 5108) (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF-X003I).	05.10.2026 22.10.2026	659.82 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01663259688 pwd-epd-hansi@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR OF FLOOD AFFECTED ROAD FROM NEOLI KALAN TO MATTERSHYAM RD 2.000 TO 2.980 IN HISAR DISTT. (ROAD ID 10801)	CLOSING DATE 12.10.2026	41.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-epd1-hisar@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	STRENGTHENING OF YAMUNA NAGAR KHAJURI JATHALA ROAD (ID 511) KM. 0.00 TO 2.00) IN YAMUNA NAGAR DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAM-2026-27)(YAMUNA NAGAR CONSTITUENCY).	05.10.2026 15.10.2026	73.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01732237834 pwd-epd-yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, HISAR	STRENGTHENING OF 03 NOS. ROAD (1) CHAUDHARWALI TO JHANSAL ROAD RD 0.00 TO 1.800 (ROAD ID 10501) (2) CHOUDHARWALI TO BER UPTO RAJASTHAN BOUNDARY ROAD RD 0.00 TO 2.070 (ROAD ID 10503) (3) KHARIA TO SISWALA ROAD RD 0.00 TO 3.305 (ROAD ID 10512) (ADAMPUR CONSTITUENCY OF WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP NO. 7) + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 14.10.2026	1573.06 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-epd1-hisar@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, HISAR	WDG STG 07 NO. ROAD (1) MINI BANK LUDAS ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.600 (5012) (2) HISAR BALSAMAND TO HARJIAN CHOPAL ARYA NAGAR ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.520 (5014) (3) PANCHAYAT GHAR TO ARYA NAGAR ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.210 (5015) (4) RAWALWAS KHURD TO GHS RAWALWAS KHURD ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.050 (5018) (5) PHERNI RAWALWAS KHURD ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.520 (ROAD ID 5019) (6) PHERNI KIRTAN ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.700 (5020) (7) HISAR BALSAMAND ROAD TO GURUKUL ARYA NAGAR ROAD RD 0.00 TO 1.200 (4911) IN HISAR (NALWA OF WP 26-27 G. 8)	CLOSING DATE 14.10.2026	392.78 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-epd1-hisar@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, HANSI	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM HANSI MEHID MASUDPUR DATTA GURANA TO HANSI BARWALA ROAD BY PROVIDING STRENGTHENING OF ROAD IN KM. 19.00 TO 19.70, 19.87 TO 23.00, 24.20 TO 30.40 AND IPS IN KM 19.70 TO 19.87, 23.90 TO 24.20 AND RECONSTRUCTION IN KM 23.00 TO 23.90 IN HISAR DISTT (ROAD ID 5206) (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF-X003I). + 2 WORKS	05.10.2026 14.10.2026	1390.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01663259688 pwd-epd-hansi@hry.nic.in
9	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	MULTI LAYERED EXTRUDED CROSS LAMINATED (MECL) BLUE TARPULINS.	07.10.2026 05.11.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsd@haryana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
10	CIVIL AVIATION, HARYANA	MAINTENANCE CONTRACT AND CAMO SUB-CONTRACT OF SKA B2000T AIRCRAFT (FUSION), VT-HCA	06.10.2026 21.10.2026	EMD 5000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709386 cavation@hry.nic.in
11	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HANSI	CHANNOT-RENOVATION OF WATER SUPPLY SCHEME VILLAGE CHANNOT DISTT. HISAR. "CONSTRUCTION OF 2 NO. RCC SS TANK, BALANCE WORK OF EXIST 1.00 MLD WTP, RESTORATION OF DAMAGED WATER CONNECTION, CONST. OF CC PATH / ROAD, REPAIR OF EXISTING S/S WELL, REPAIR OF BOUNDARY WALL, PUMPING MACHINERY, PROP 150 MM AND 200 MM RAW WATER RISING MAIN, RAW WATER PUMPING MACHINERY, RE-CONST OF PC ABOVE DPC 3.66X3.05MTR., CONST. OF 1 NO. RCC RETENTION TANK (6.00X5.00X1.83MTR) AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO.	29.09.2026 12.10.2026	615.47 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01663256145 eehansi@gmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, BHADURGARH	CONSTRUCTION OF IPB SERVICE ROAD ON BOTH SIDE OF 3-CELL BOX STRUCTURE ON WEST JUA DRAIN FROM RD 4150 TO 5450	CLOSING DATE 12.10.2026	118.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01276-298418 wsdvision@bgarhi@gmail.com
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SIRSA	INTERNAL CLEARANCE AND REMOVING SILT FROM THE MAMMERKHERA DISTY. FROM RD. 0 - 68000 IN RMS SECTION (RABI SEASON 2026-27) + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 12.10.2026	16.86 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996656761 xersers.wsd1925@yahoo.com
14	HORTICULTURE CEF MANGIANA, SIRSA	SUPPLY OF MANPOWER AND EXECUTION OF WORK OF PLANTATION AND MANAGEMENT OF ORCHARDS AND FRUIT PLANTS PROPAGATION AND THEIR MANAGEMENT IN NURSERY SEGMENT, PRODUCTION OF VEGETABLES AND FRUITS SEEDLINGS IN HI-TECH GREEN HOUSE, EXECUTION OF DIFFERENT WORKS IN NATURAL FARMING PROJECT, OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF AUTOMATION IRRIGATION & FERTIGATION SYSTEM AT THE CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE FOR FRUITS, MANGIANA, SIRSA.	08.10.2026 19.10.2026	2 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416662510 dthcfmangiana@gmail.com
15	HORTICULTURE, POTATO TECHNOLOGY CENTRE, SHAMGARH, KARNAL	SUPPLY OF LABOUR IN TISSUE CULTURE LAB, AEROPONICS UNIT, HARDENING UNITS, NET HOUSES AND OPEN FIELD FOR PRODUCTION OF HIGH QUALITY SEED POTATO AND MINUTEBERS AND LANDSCAPING ON BASIS OF JOB WORK	08.10.2026 22.10.2026	1 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9521529519 ptcshangarh@gmail.com
16	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, CHARKHI DADRI	RENOVATION OF POND AND RAMP INLETS, VILLAGE LOHARWARA, BLOCK CHARKHI DADRI , DISTT. CHARKHI DADRI	05.10.2026 12.10.2026	18.27 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in epaper.indianexpress.com 50012/HRY						

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT COMMISSIONER GOVT. OF MADHYA PRADESH, MADHYA PRADESH BHAWAN 29-C & D, JESUS AND MARY MARG CHANAKYAPURI, NEW DELHI-110021 Phone No. 011-26772001, 2002

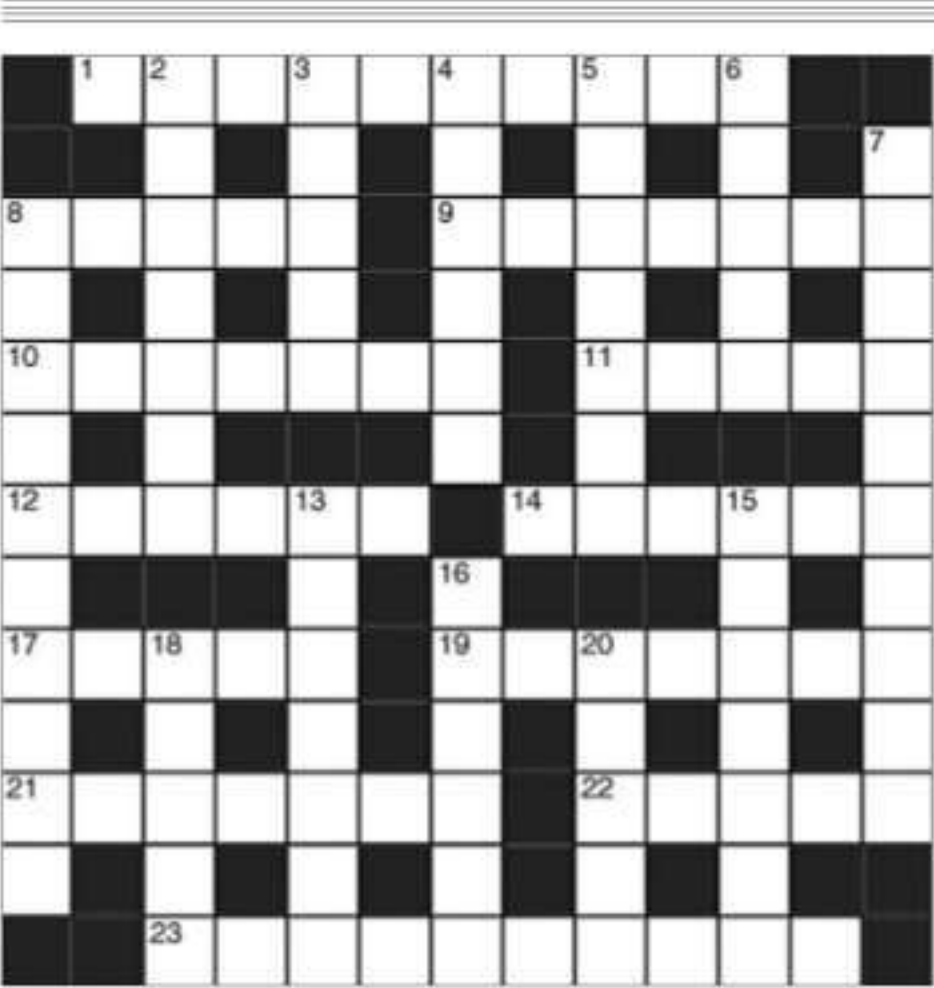
NIT No. 17/LINEN/MPB/2026 Dated: 06/10/2026

TENDER NOTICE 2nd Call

Online tender for Annual Supply of Linen Items in State Guest Houses of Government of Madhya Pradesh at New Delhi, namely, Madhya Pradesh Bhawan, 29, C-D, Jesus & Mary Marg, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi 110021 are invited with two bid system (Technical bid & Financial bid) through e-Tendering website (www.mptenders.gov.in or www.mpbhawanbhooking.mp.gov.in) in the prescribed proforma from registered contractors in PWD/ State PWD/DDA/NDMC/MCD and reputed firms.

S. No	Description of Items	Remarks
10.	NIT No. & Date	NIT No. 17/LINEN/MPB/2026 Dated 06/10/2026
11.	Issuance of tender	M.P. Bhawan, New Delhi website (www.mptenders.gov.in or www.mpbhawanbhooking.mp.gov.in)
12.	Pre-bid conference	21/10/2026 at 03:00 PM in the conference hall of Madhya Pradesh Bhawan, Plot No. 29 C-D, Jesus Mary Marg, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi-110021
13.	Date of Submission of tender	Submission on or before 27/10/2026 up to 03:00 PM
14.	Date of Opening of technical bid	28/10/2026 at 03:00 PM

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Supporter at the match in special costume (10)
8 Bird seed needs it (5)
9 He looks after a dog on a hill (7)
10 Wanted a knighthood indeed (7)
11 Possibly showed off Eastern craft (5)
12 The rest of Spain (6)
14 Colour that would run? (6)
17 It's used in guiding pilots left and right (5)
19 Hide the port (7)
21 Assign work to a writer (7)
22 A girl with good ones attracts a lot of them (5)
23 Not left behind; in fact well in front (5,5)

DOWN
2 A quick reply by one who is foiled (7)
3 Prevent animal swallowing the tin opener (5)
4 Withdraw a direction to surrender (6)
5 Cut down a dentist's work (7)
6 It's said in France to be the same (5)
7 Puzzles resulting in arguments? (10)
8 Lacking inspiration he goes for a walk (10)
13 Not a straightforward job for woodworkers (7)
15 Girl alone or tied up (7)
16 The Mad Hatter gets a warning (6)
18 Colour scheme for last month - heraldic gold (5)
20 He's found in proper alphabetical order (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6113
ACROSS: 1 Divest, 4 Client, 9 Stirrup, 10 Tarsi, 11 Gusto, 12 Repress, 13 Puts a stop to, 18 Imperil, 20 Whine, 22 Tired, 23 Bitters, 24 Rostov, 25 Chalet
DOWN: 1 Design, 2 Veils, 3 Sorrows, 5 Lit up, 6 Earnest, 7 Thirst, 8 Sports clubs, 14 Umpires, 15 On watch, 16 Bitter, 17 Tea set, 19 Rodeo, 21 Ideal

JUMBLER WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The one thing I regret was that my work required an enormous amount of my __, and a lot of ____ - Neil Armstrong (4,,6)

EEDVA

FDIRT

BLTEGI

LULEMV

SOLUTIONS: Evade, Drift, Gliblet, Velium
ANSWER: The one thing I regret was that my work required an enormous amount of my **time**, and a lot of **travel** - Neil Armstrong

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6465

		3	8	1				
4		6	9	1		5		
1		7	2			9		
8	5	4		3	2		1	
6		9	8				3	
	5	1	7	6		2		
	8		2	9				

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6464

2	3	5	9	4	8	6	7	1
8	7	4	1	3	6	9	5	2
6	9	1	2	5	7	8	4	3
5	2	7	6	1	9	4	3	8
3	8	9	5	7	4	2	1	6
4	1	6	8	2	3	7	9	5
7	4	2	3	6	5	1	8	9
1	5	8	4	9	2	3	6	7
9	6	3	7	8	1	5	2	4

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Today you might have to put your own emotional considerations second to those of someone else. You also might explore ways to improve your health, especially through diet. Be aware there's a moon alert all day. Tonight: Get organised.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a wonderful, creative day. If you're involved in the arts or a creative project, you can use your artistic talents because this entire day is a moon alert, which means your mind is free, floating like a helium balloon released in the sky. Tonight: Socialise.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Focus on home and family. Relax at home among familiar surroundings. Cut yourself some slack, because it's hard to crank up ambition today. Enjoy the company of others, but don't agree to anything important. Tonight: Cocoon at home.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a great day for a short trip. Or you might want to relax and learn something new. Conversations will be a pleasant way to pass this day. Because there's a moon alert all day, avoid shopping except for food and gas. Tonight: Learn something new.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is a tricky day because the entire day is a moon alert, which is a poor day for shopping or making important decisions. Nevertheless, you're thinking about financial matters, negotiations and perhaps shopping. Tonight: Check your belongings.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the Moon Alert is taking place in your sign, which might make you feel more emotional. However, it can also make you feel relaxed and free-floating. Don't make important decisions. Don't go shopping. (Except for food and gas.) Tonight: You're in charge.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is the perfect day to be low-key and hide somewhere (with good food and drink). Lower your ambitions when it comes to what you want to accomplish today. Shortages and a lack of focused energy might slow you down. Tonight: Peace and quiet.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): With Venus and Mercury in your sign, you'll enjoy talking to people. In turn, people will be attracted to you. Think about future goals but commit to nothing important today. Tonight: Be friendly.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This entire day is a moon alert, which is pleasant, creative and great for talking, but poor for important decisions and spending money. People notice you today. Tonight: Be modest.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You might have some feelings of escapism today because you want to do something different. If you can explore the world around you, by all means, do so. Restrict spending to food and gas due to the moon alert all day. Tonight: Explore and learn.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Be careful because today there's a moon alert in effect all day, and it's taking place in one of your Money Houses. Therefore, postpone decisions about inheritances, shared property, taxes, debt and insurance issues. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You have to be accommodating when dealing with others today. Don't agree to anything important, because there is a moon alert. Enjoy talking with everyone. Tonight: Be friendly and cooperative.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



KIET UNIVERSITY - SEMINAR
KIET Deemed to be University, Ghaziabad, celebrated World Space Week 2026 with a seminar on Prof. Satish Dhawan Memorial Day, themed "Space Technology for National Development: From Earth Observation to Emerging Space Applications." The programme featured a tribute to Prof. Dhawan, ceremonial lamp lighting, Saraswati Vandana, and expert sessions by Shri Anil C. Mathur, Dr. M. R. Sujimol, and Dr. Pramod Kumar on emerging space technologies, satellite communication, and earth observation. An interactive session enabled students and faculty to engage with the experts, followed by visits to KIET's Centres of Excellence. Dr. Manoj Goel highlighted space technology's role in national development and encouraged students to pursue research and innovation.



NIET - COLLABORATION
Noida Institute of Engineering & Technology (NIET), Greater Noida, has launched the CodeXperience Center powered by Capgemini to strengthen industry-academia collaboration and prepare students for the digital and AI-driven workplace. The Center will offer experiential learning, mentorship, workshops, emerging-technology exposure, collaborative projects and real-world problem-solving. Senior leaders from Capgemini and NIET attended the launch, highlighting industry engagement and future-ready skills. Balasubramaniam Natarajan, Executive Vice President, Insights & Data-India, Capgemini, said the Center will enable students to develop solutions for industry challenges while building AI literacy and innovation. Dr. Neema Agarwal, Additional Managing Director, NIET, said the initiative will foster experiential learning, innovation and industry exposure, helping students become adaptable, future-ready professionals.

AMITY GROUP OF SCHOOLS - INDIA MIND LEAGUE
Amity Group of Schools has launched India Mind League (IML) 2026, India's first Holistic Future-Readiness Championship for students of Grades IX-XII. Open to students across Delhi-NCR, registrations close on 16 October 2026. Envisioned by Dr. (Mrs.) Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools & RBFE, IML aims to move beyond academic excellence and nurture mindful, empathetic, value-driven and responsible future leaders. Built around the philosophy "THINK. FEEL. CONNECT. LEAD.", the championship focuses on four dimensions: Intelligence Quotient (IQ), Emotional Quotient (EQ), Social/Spiritual Quotient (SQ) and Leadership Quotient (LQ). The four-stage journey includes an online Future-Readiness Assessment, Virtual Live Showdown, experiential Leadership Bootcamp and Grand Finale. Integrating Indian Knowledge Systems and Vedic wisdom with contemporary skills, IML encourages ethical decision-making, self-awareness, collaboration and purposeful leadership, preparing students to contribute meaningfully towards a stronger Viksit Bharat.



AMITY UNIVERSITY - HONOURS
Amity University Uttar Pradesh (AUUP), Noida Campus, conferred the Honorary Doctorate Degree, D.Sc. Honoris Causa, upon Nobel Laureate Prof. Roger D. Kornberg and Honorary Professorship upon Prof. Yahli Lorch, Professor (Research), Structural Biology, Stanford University School of Medicine, recognising their outstanding contributions to science, research and education. Prof. Kornberg, recipient of the 2006 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for his pioneering work on eukaryotic transcription, expressed gratitude and emphasised that scientific innovation stems from curiosity, discovery and its application for the benefit of humanity. Prof. Lorch appreciated the honour and highlighted Amity's growing contribution to global scientific advancement. Dr. Ashok K. Chauhan, Founder President, Amity Education Group, and Dr. Atul Chauhan, Chancellor, AUUP, congratulated the distinguished scientists and reaffirmed Amity's commitment to excellence, research and innovation. Dr. Atul Chauhan urged students to embrace challenging problems, persevere and work towards transforming society.



S.C. DAV PUBLIC SCHOOL - EVENT
The Interact Club of S.C. DAV Public School, Noida, organised a Health and Hygiene Awareness and Contribution Drive at Raipur Village, Sector 126, Noida, to promote personal hygiene and healthy living practices. Students interacted with children and parents, raising awareness about personal cleanliness, hand hygiene and oral care. They also distributed essential hygiene products, including toothbrushes and toothpaste, among community members. The initiative aimed to turn awareness into action by encouraging families to adopt simple and healthy habits in their daily lives. Through this meaningful outreach, the Interact Club reaffirmed its commitment to the spirit of "service before self" and its efforts towards building a healthier, more aware and responsible community. The drive also encouraged students to actively engage with community needs and contribute towards positive social change.

GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY - ACHIEVEMENT
The University has earned the Platinum Subject Rating in Education from QS I-GAUGE, recognising its academic quality and performance in the discipline. The recognition follows an independent assessment against defined subject-rating benchmarks and reinforces the University's commitment to academic excellence, institutional development and continuous improvement. Dr. Dhruv Galgotia, Chief Executive Officer, Galgotias University, said the recognition reflects the University's efforts to maintain high educational standards and its commitment to translating further improvements into tangible benefits for students. The achievement adds to Galgotias University's growing national and international profile. In the QS World University Rankings 2027, the University is placed in the 1201-1400 global band, ranked 46th in India and among the Top 16 private universities nationally. It also advanced in the Times Higher Education World University Rankings 2027, entering the 1001-1200 global band and ranking 41st among Indian universities. Together, these recognitions highlight Galgotias University's academic progress and global visibility.

Gambhir lauds Agarkar for always putting team ahead

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 7

AJIT AGARKAR’S tenure as chief selector of the men’s cricket team has been quite a mixed one. With him in charge of the selection committee, team India won silverware, but he also had to make tough calls. Taking the reins in July 2023, Agarkar’s tenure officially ended on Tuesday, with the BCCI calling for applications. Head coach Gautam Gambhir lauded Agarkar and praised his conviction.

“Dear Ajit Bhai, an absolute honour to work with you. Those 3 ICC trophies are a testimony of your conviction: Team first & Team ahead, always... I must say, History will be kinder to you. Thank you for everything. My heartfelt wishes for your future endeavours !”, Gambhir wrote on X (formerly Twitter).

“The fact is that Ajit Agarkar had the responsibility to take a lot of big decisions in this stint; he had to phase out the senior players, and it cannot be easy”

R ASHWIN,
ON AGARKAR’S SITUATION

It was not just Gambhir as former Indian cricketer R Ashwin, on his YouTube channel, was empathetic to Agarkar’s situation as the selector. “The fact is that Ajit Agarkar had the responsibility to take a lot of big decisions in this stint; he had to phase out the senior players, and it cannot be easy. I was one of the senior players phased out during his tenure, but still by keeping some distance from that, I want to say that he has been a very good chairman of selectors. If we look at what all he has done with the team,” Ashwin said on his YouTube channel. During Agarkar’s tenure, India reached the final of the ODI World Cup before winning the 2024 T20 World Cup and the 2025 Champions Trophy. India also retained the T20 World Cup earlier this year.

“Agarkar didn’t ask for an extension. As there was no interest from his side, the BCCI has decided to look for a new chief selector,” a source had told this paper.

COMEBACK STORY

Zero sugar, 100 percent effort: How Bhuvi rediscovered swing

36-year-old seamer made sacrifices to regain swing, which had been his hallmark in his heyday

Lalith Kalidas
New Delhi, October 7

“I WANT to be like that again. Will it be possible?”

A few months had passed in calm silence. Bhuvneshwar Kumar and his physio Ramneesh Vohra had not let their association be disrupted by the snub that struck him 12 days after India’s 2022 T20 World Cup semi-final exit. He was taken off the national radar after a New Zealand tour. His 37 T20I wickets in 2022 remain the most by an Indian man in a calendar year.

“We met regularly but never had a word about it for almost 2-3 months,” Ramneesh, a BCCI-qualified physiotherapist, tells *The Indian Express* from his clinic in Noida. “We never discussed what went wrong.”

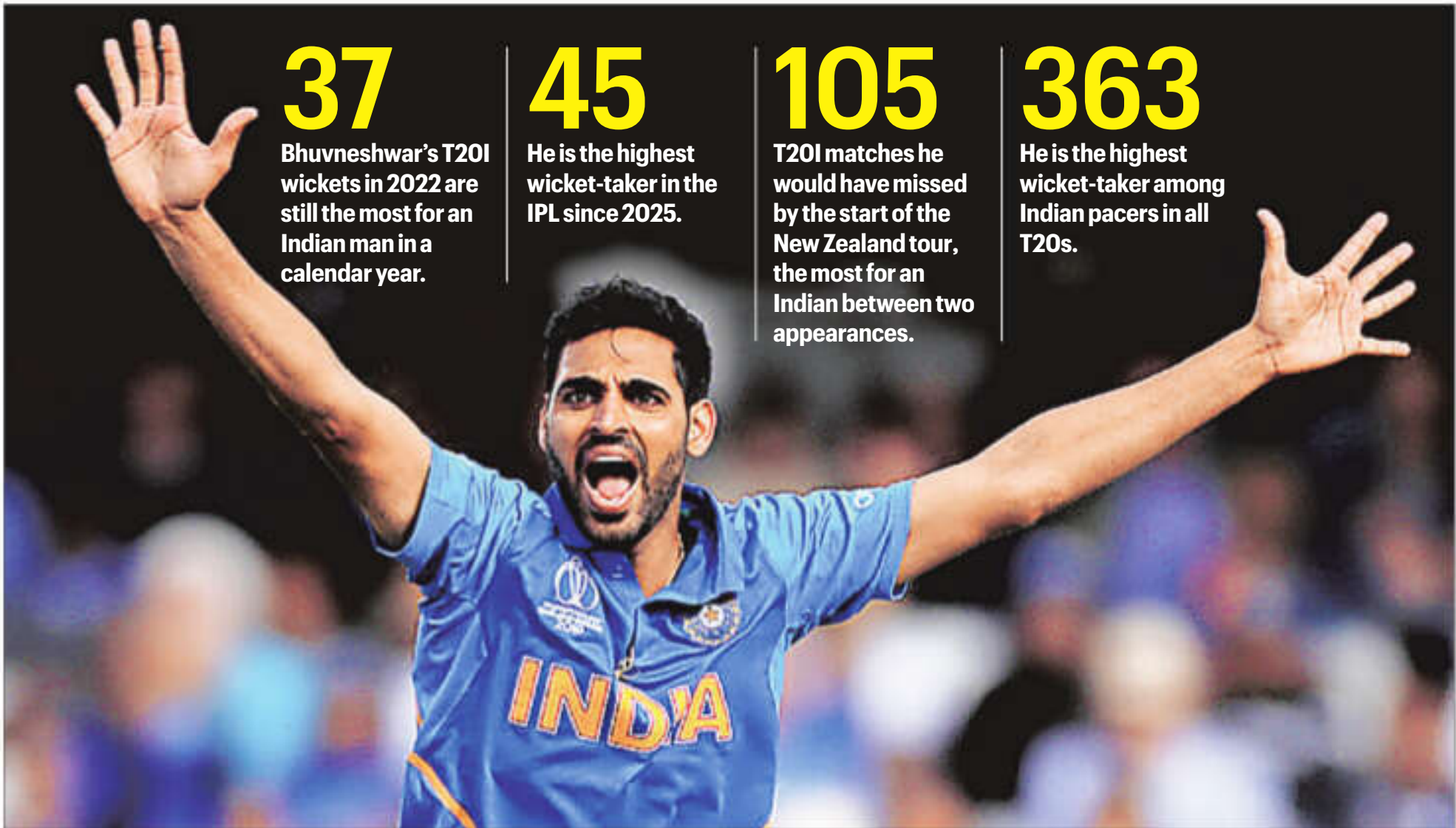
Bhuvneshwar’s stillness was perplexing, even for Ramneesh. His thoughts finally came out in the open one morning.

“I want to be like that again,” Bhuvneshwar told Ramneesh. He pointed to a mobile screen that replayed the booming in-swingers that rattled Pakistan’s Nasir Jamshed and Mohammad Hafeez on his T20I and ODI debuts in December 2012 on a loop.

That was 10 years earlier. The confidence had undeniably taken a hit. Could he bend the ball to his will again? “Will it be possible?” he asked Ramneesh.

Bhuvneshwar wasn’t searching for swing to wear the India blues again. “He just wanted to enjoy and give his best no matter where he played. The chat was all about that,” Ramneesh recalls.

The hard yards put in, alongside Bhuvneshwar’s personal trainer Surya Yadav, helped the veteran seamer complete a circle on Tuesday. At 36, he found himself back in the T20I squad for India’s New Zealand tour, the country where he



Bhuvneshwar Kumar relentlessly worked on fitness after 2022. (Below) Kumar with his physio Ramneesh Vohra. REUTERS/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

played his last international game in November '22.

The platform was laid by two victorious IPL seasons with Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB). Nerve-less control in the Powerplay and at the death yielded him 45 wickets at a sub-9 economy, the best among all pacers in the league over that period.

Ramneesh first crossed paths with Bhuvneshwar during the COVID lockdown at a Noida academy in 2020. Surya's technical inputs came in about four years later.

“He never wanted to increase pace. He only wanted to regain his swing. We first put in work to help regain that swinging capacity. The technical aspects were handled by Surya. I would handle his joints, which had to be opened up first. Only then could he proceed to strengthening, do functional activities and later enter game-pattern activities. His priority was to get his foot landing at the crease like in 2012, when his contact was on his toe and not the entire back foot,” says Ramneesh.

The transformation was in full flight during RCB's triumphant Playoffs run in May. Two near-140 kph deliveries froze Shubman Gill and Sai Sudharsan, Bhuvneshwar getting them



“He never wanted to increase pace. He only wanted to regain his swing. We first put in work to help regain that swinging capacity”

RAMNEESH VOHRA,
BHUVNESHWAR KUMAR'S PHYSIOTHERAPIST ON HIS GOALS

with his rejuvenated bouncer and nip-backer.

“Earlier, he used to be a bowler, like many others. Now, he can run a marathon if he wants,” Ramneesh says proudly.

Hard yards

The sacrifices were big but not impossible for Bhuvneshwar, who, according to Ram-

neesh, has had “no fun activities or parties” outside cricket.

“Zero sugar, zero gluten and zero lactose for the last six years. He has shed fat from his visceral organs. That’s the main thing.”

He weighed 80 kg earlier, with 22-25 percent body fat. Now at 75 kg and 16 percent body fat, Bhuvneshwar has improved his muscle mass.

“That’s the beauty when you develop a bond with an athlete”, Ramneesh adds.

The two have transcended the player-doctor relationship to “brothers” and neighbours in the same society of the city. “We strictly keep our work off social media and often train at my home or his,” he says.

Ashish Winston Zaidi raves about Bhuvneshwar’s comeback. Zaidi, a former Uttar Pradesh seamer, retired in 2006, a year before Bhuvneshwar’s debut. The two later caught up regularly during the UPT20 league.

In 2009, Zaidi’s straight talk was Bhuvneshwar’s greatest counsel, a day before he dismissed Sachin Tendulkar for his only duck in the Ranji Trophy and burst to fame before the IPL.

“*Maine bola usse Tendulkar jaan thodi ley lega* (I told him Tendulkar wasn’t going to kill

him). He was a nervous teenager then but a very mature cricketer now,” recounts Zaidi.

“He made a mistake somewhere trying to increase pace. Moving back to swing, and line and length have helped his comeback. His bowling amazed me this season.”

“Nowadays, a lot of boys are bowling quick but have no swing. If you look at the batting tracks today, if you don’t have swing or movement, you are in trouble,” the former cricketer says.

Ramneesh recalls only one instance of Bhuvneshwar expressing disappointment over his exit from the national team in late 2022, when “Bhuvi sir” arrived as the chief guest on his revamped clinic’s inauguration.

“Someone asked him why he got the ‘keeper up to the stumps during that Adelaide (T20 World Cup) semifinal (against England). He said that it wasn’t his call and the decision didn’t go well.”

“He always used to say, ‘I don’t want to think about it or its consequences. I am not doing anything to get somewhere.’”

But he got himself somewhere on Tuesday. Back in an India shirt, with the avenues opening up further as they enter a 50-over World Cup year.

BRIEFLY



Aquatic stadium at Veer Savarkar Sports Complex in Ahmedabad.

‘Rising Together’ vision; Olympic bid presentation in November

SPORTS MINISTER Mansukh Mandaviya and Indian Olympic Association President P T Usha on Wednesday said that the country’s bid to host the 2036 Olympics will revolve around the vision of “Rising Together” and the first project presentation to the IOC’s Future Host Commission will be made at the end of November. The International Olympic Committee (IOC) on Tuesday said India, Germany, Qatar and Türkiye are among 7 countries with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics and have been invited to present their Games projects next month. “Hosting the Olympic and Paralympic Games would inspire millions of young Indians to participate in sport, strengthen healthier and more active communities, and create new opportunities for our youth,” Mandaviya said in a press release issued by the IOA. Ahmedabad is India’s city of choice to host the showpiece. PTI

9 U23 wrestlers denied US visas for World C’ship

SEVERAL INDIAN wrestlers, including 2024 U17 World Champion Neha Sangwan, have been refused US visas, putting their participation in the upcoming U23 World Wrestling Championships in Las Vegas from October 12 to 18 under a cloud. The wrestlers were verbally informed about the refusal on the grounds that they were below 20 years of age and unemployed. Their passports were returned to them when they visited the embassy for interviews. The Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) has now urged the US Embassy in New Delhi to reconsider the cases. According to a letter written by the WFI to the US Embassy, nine wrestlers were refused visas on Wednesday. PTI

Former City great David Silva joins Hong Kong club

FORMER MANCHESTER City and Spain midfielder David Silva has come out of retirement after three years to join Supreme Sha Tin, the Hong Kong club announced Wednesday. The 40-year-old Silva, a member of Spain’s 2010 World Cup winning squad, ended his career in the summer of 2023 after sustaining a serious knee injury while in preseason training with Real Sociedad in Spain. “I am delighted to join Supreme Sha Tin,” Silva, who made 125 appearances for Spain, said in a video posted on the club’s social media channels. “I’m really looking forward to going to Hong Kong to enjoy the culture, the people, the food in Hong Kong, of course.” AP

Opener Head hits back at critics of Australian team

AUSTRALIA OPENER Travis Head has taken to task former Test players turned critics whom he accused on Wednesday of “putting a bullet” through the current team, who start the first Test against South Africa in Durban on Friday. Head did not single out any pundit directly, but his strong remarks at a press conference came the day after Matthew Hayden, one-time holder of the record for the most runs in a test innings, accused selectors of “promoting the greatest pile of mediocrity that we’ve seen in a generation of cricket”. Head said, “I think it’s unfairly judged a fair bit from a group of past players, pretty much that put the bullet through a lot of players, which I think is unfair.” REUTERS

CAS to hear Senegal appeal over AFCON title

THE SAGA over the winner of this year’s Africa Cup of Nations title will move closer to resolution on Thursday when Senegal’s appeal after being stripped of the title is heard by the Court of Arbitration in Sport in Lausanne. Senegal are contesting the Confederation of African Football’s decision to declare Morocco champions, despite Senegal beating the hosts 1-0. Senegal walked off the pitch for 14 minutes after a penalty was awarded against them, before play resumed. “After the hearing, the panel will start its deliberations. At this stage, CAS cannot state when a final decision will be rendered but it will not be on the date of the hearing,” CAS said in a statement. REUTERS

Part-timer Dhir keen on improving after stellar India debut

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 7

FOR A player who had bowled just 8.4 overs without a wicket in his IPL career, Naman Dhir could hardly have made a stronger case for his bowling. The Impact Player rule may have reduced his opportunities at Mumbai Indians, but the 26-year-old insisted he was ready.

“I’ve been bowling for a long time. It’s not like I’ve just started. In IPL, yes, there’s an impact player rule, so you see me bowling less. But it’s not like

I haven’t bowled, I’ve bowled a lot and I’ve had great experience here. I’ve got wickets, I hope I’ll keep doing well in the future,” he said after taking 3/31 on his T20I debut against West Indies in Lucknow.

“IPL prepares you for international cricket. There’s a lot of competition there. If you’re playing IPL with a team like Mumbai Indians, you don’t feel so much pressure coming here,” he added.

His performance also showed that the lack of bowling in the IPL had not hampered

him. Dhir said he has continued to bowl regularly in practice and is comfortable handling different workloads.

“There’s an impact player rule in IPL. It’s not like I don’t practise; I practise there too. It’s the same here. If I get 4 overs, 2 overs, if I get 6 or 7 overs in a one-dayer, it’s nothing new for me. I just have to focus on my plans and try to execute them.”

Dhir’s three wickets came after he watched Axar Patel bowl in the Powerplay and felt the slower pace was helping him on the turning pitch.



Naman Dhir has only bowled 8.4 overs in the IPL. CREIMAS

“I saw Axar bhai bowling in the powerplay, so he was bowling a little slow. It was turning. And in my mind, I thought if I bowl a little slow with the wicket gripping, I can get them out. So I just stuck to my basic plans and bowled, and I got good results,” he said.

There was a personal side to the call-up too. Dhir was at the Ranji Trophy camp in the PCA when he got the news, having just come off a good tournament for himself and his team.

“Obviously, it was a great feeling when I got the call. I was

in the Ranji Trophy camp, in PCA, our tournament had just ended, a very good tournament had gone for me, for our team, so it was a surreal feeling. I was with my friends, so right away I called my father, he was emotional; I got a little emotional.”

Dhir made it clear that while his batting may get more attention, he has continued to work on his bowling. “I’ve practised as much as I can. It’s not like I’m a batting all-rounder or a bowling all-rounder; my batting is a plus, but at the same time, I’m working hard on my bowling.”

LETTING HIS HAIR DOWN

Gukesh, the 20-year-old world champion who’s finally starting to act his age

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, October 7

DURING THE recent Chess Olympiad in Samarkand, world champion Gukesh D did something he had rarely ever done in public before. He cracked a joke. Sitting at the airport on his way back after helping India’s open section team to a silver medal, Gukesh shot a video with Praggnanandhaa where he told his teammate that a fan had approached him for a photo but could not recollect his name, before eventually mistaking him for Pragg.

“Guys remember, this is Gukesh,” he said cheekily pointing at Pragg, “... and I’m Pragg,” Gukesh joked, while his compatriot smiled good-naturedly.

In that short, one-minute clip, Gukesh had shown the world a glimpse of his other side: the goofier, 20-year-old version of himself that fans have seldom seen during chess tournaments.

“On-the-board Gukesh and off-the-board Gukesh are very different,” explains Vidit Gujrathi, who was also a part of the Olympiad team.

Sankalp Gupta, who has also been a coach with the Indian team for multiple editions and has seen Gukesh’s fun-loving side first hand during the Turkish League in 2023, adds: “On-the-board Gukesh and off-the-board Gukesh are almost like two different people.”

But even those who have seen both sides of Gukesh were pleasantly surprised by the version of him that they saw at this Olympiad. For the past 18 months, the 20-year-old looked like he was struggling under the twin burdens of dwindling form and the weight of expectations. At the Chennai Grand Masters, his last tournament before the Olympiad, he did not win a single match.

Then, something changed. “Around August, after he

played the Chennai Grand Masters, I started seeing a change in Gukesh. He was learning surfing, doing a bit of skating, trying all these new things. He was spending some time away from chess trying to have fun. The same thing carried over to the Olympiad as well. He was having a lot of fun. When we had our online training camp for the Olympiad, as soon as Gukesh joined, the vibe got lighter,” says Srinath Narayanan, the captain of the Indian men’s Olympiad team.

Srinath traces how Gukesh changed over successive Olympiads. “There’s been an incredible difference with Gukesh every year. In 2022, when I was not captain of the team Gukesh was in (India 2), the story I heard was that Gukesh wouldn’t participate in team meetings. He would just turn up to play and win his individual games. In 2023 during the Asian Games, the players were not the best of



Gukesh D has become more outgoing with teammates after 2024.

friends. But before the Budapest Olympiad, I had a chat with the players. I felt something changed in Gukesh internally, that he really wanted to get along with the team and spend time with everyone, indulge in banter, attend team meetings, which became a ritual starting from the Budapest Olympiad,”

says Srinath.

Sankalp Gupta, who has also been a coach with the Indian team for multiple editions, adds: “At the 2022 Olympiad, Gukesh used to be completely different than he is currently. I’m not saying this approach is better or that one was. It’s just a different approach. He used to be like a lone

wolf back in 2022. He would eat meals by himself, stay by himself. But in 2024, he would join team meetings. We had great team bonding that time, but Gukesh was still a bit reserved.”

Srinath explains that the distance that the players kept from each other a few years ago was understandable. For most of the year, they would be fighting for the same titles, facing off against each other repeatedly, and chasing the same opportunities. It was a scenario that previous members of India’s Olympiad teams had not faced.

Bond between players

But since Budapest 2024, the camaraderie and the banter in the India camp grew as have the bonds between players. Helping solidify the bond were multiple game-day rituals, like team walks, long meetings and a player-of-the-round award (which Srinath points out was also an idea from Gukesh). At

Samarkand, the banter was unparalleled, says Srinath and Sankalp. Much of it was initiated by Gukesh, who the coaches say was the ‘funniest’ member of the Indian men’s team at this edition, taking over the baton from P Harikrishna, who would lighten the mood in previous Olympiad teams.

“Team meetings had a vibe that you would find in a typical boys hostel,” says Srinath. “At Budapest Olympics, the team meetings for initial rounds were just 5-10 minutes. By the time we played USA in round 10, meetings would just go for 40-45 minutes with a lot of casual banter,” says Srinath.

Srinath says that the ongoing Olympiad, Gukesh was professional when discussion turned to chess, but he also knew when to switch off. “Gukesh felt that we should be more chill as a team. Players keep certain things, like opening preparation, personal. But they can still

hang out together as friends outside of that,” says Srinath.

The biggest surprise came at the traditional Bermuda Party held after the 6th round. The team atmosphere was a bit gloomy that day because India had lost to Uzbekistan. Gukesh had taken a draw and Nihal had lost a game that he could have won.

That evening, Gukesh and Vidit turned up at the Bermuda Party and Gukesh did another thing you would not expect him to do in the middle of a tournament. He danced. He even did an impression of Michael Jackson’s moon walk.

“With the amount of cameras and attention on him, it was difficult for Gukesh to be able to do that in the past. But in Samarkand, he made a conscious decision that he is not going to care about all those things and he will just have fun like a normal 20-year-old,” says Srinath.

After walking out, Ronaldo says he is still available for Portugal

Tales Azzoni
Madrid, October 7

CRISTIANO RONALDO is not following Lionel Messi into international retirement just yet.

The Portugal superstar said he will remain available to play for his national team, despite having walked out on the squad during the current international window.

In a long statement posted Tuesday, just hours before Messi's much-anticipated farewell game with Argentina, Ronaldo said recently hired coach Jorge Jesus hadn't been true to his word about when he would play the striker in the latest round of Nations League matches.

Still, the 41-year-old Ronaldo said he owed fans and his teammates an apology and expects to receive a punishment.

"I can promise all my fans, and naturally especially all Portuguese people, that we will have one or more farewell matches. There will be time for that," Ronaldo said.

He added: "Therefore, if I am physically fit, playing for my club, hopefully scoring goals, then after serving whatever suspension is imposed on me, I will be available, as I have always been until today, to compete and win for our national team."

Ronaldo was an unused substitute for Portugal's 2-1 win over Norway in Oslo. He then left camp after Jesus said the star forward wouldn't start the game against Denmark last Thursday. Portugal beat the Danes 4-2 in Copenhagen.

Pending punishment

Ronaldo could possibly face a harsh punishment for leaving the training camp. The federation's disciplinary regulations say that any player who "abandons or fails to appear" without justification at a training session, match or activity of the national teams, "shall be sanctioned with a suspension of one to six months," in addition to a fine.

Ronaldo did tell the federation that he was leaving, but it wasn't clear whether the decision would be considered justified in accordance with the regulations.

"Despite the absolute breach of trust in the coach's word, as anyone who witnessed these conversations can attest, I should not have done it," Ronaldo said. "The responsibility is entirely mine. I apologize to the Portuguese people once again, but the breaking of one's word has, for me, a defining impact. I felt that, from that point on,

my staying would only harm the group, and I did what I have always said I would do if I didn't feel useful: I picked up my bags and left."

He said "I believe the punishment should be no mitigating factors," as he is the team captain "and that is an aggravating factor."

"I have already apologized, but I know that actions must have consequences. Anyone in football as I am knows that, regardless of each person's status, the rules are the same for everyone."

Jesus and federation president Pedro Proença recently downplayed the "misunderstanding" that led to Ronaldo's decision to leave the training camp, saying after a 2-1 win over Norway in the Nations League on Sunday that the veteran star could return whenever he wants.

Ronaldo said that after the World Cup he prepared a farewell letter to Portugal fans, but ended up deciding to remain with the national team after a request from the Portuguese soccer federation. He said he was asked by the federation about his opinion on Jesus and said "he would be the right choice" as the national team's coach.

Ronaldo's version

Ronaldo, who plays for Saudi club Al-Nassr, said he'd agreed to a plan for managing his playing time and that he expected the coach to publicly clarify the situation and accept responsibility.

He said a short document was given to Jesus with eight points that Jesus would address during a news conference, including one that said the coach would take blame for asking "someone of the stature of Pelé or Maradona" to warm up but not put him in the game.

Ronaldo said that ultimately Jesus didn't follow through and instead spoke aggressively at the news conference, causing a breakdown of trust.

"It was the second time he was failing to keep his word to me," Ronaldo said. "I decided to leave the camp without waiting for any further broken promise. For me, the truth is still the most important thing in the relationship between people. No matter how much it may hurt, tell me the truth."

Ronaldo said he had told Jesus and Proença that "if they did not want me there, they should tell me. All they had to do was be frank with me. I would accept it," a nice farewell could have been arranged "and no one would angry." AP



Cristiano Ronaldo's statement detailed his version of events. AP



THE LAST TANGO

Argentina's World Cup-winning captain Lionel Messi retired from international football on Wednesday, bringing the curtain down on a decorated career in which he reached the World Cup final thrice, winning it in 2022. Messi scored a goal and made two assists in his farewell game against Benin.

208 APPEARANCES Lionel Messi finished his Argentina career with 208 appearances. He wore a special edition jersey featuring wider vertical stripes, a giant sun, and a golden No. 10 on the back.

SOLD OUT IN 90 MINS The 85,000-seater Monumental Stadium seats were originally priced at around \$60-\$300, later fetching over \$2,500 on resale sites, according to Reuters.

FABIO SANTANA Falklands war veteran sang the Argentine anthem for Messi's farewell, a rendition that drove the legend to tears and made goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez put his arm around his skipper.

126 GOALS Messi completes his Argentina journey with 126 goals for the *Albiceleste*, the second-highest ever by a men's international player. Cristiano Ronaldo tops the charts with 146 goals.

ASIAN GAMES JINX BROKEN

‘Medal brings us peace, closure’

Mirabai and her coach Vijay Sharma talk about finally winning an Asiad medal, and how a 12-year project continues

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, October 7

WHEN MIRABAI Chanu first walked into a gym in Manipur to try weightlifting, a coach looked her up and down and made a casual remark that would stay with her for over a decade: 'You could win a medal at the Asian Games.'

She surpassed that remark in nearly every way but the one it named.

Chanu, who can lift three times her bodyweight, won medals at the World Championships, the Commonwealth Games and, in 2021, a historic silver at the Tokyo Olympics. That consistency, chiselled over years of work and protected through countless injuries, had one gap: the Asian Games.

"Something always kept happening during or around the Asian Games. It reached a point where I would constantly wonder why this was happening," says Chanu. Her longtime coach Vijay Sharma, sitting next to her, chimes in: "I won't call it a psychological barrier. You can say that it happened by chance. We have discussed this many times. We realised if we attributed it to bad luck, we wouldn't be able to do anything about it."

So they did something about it. It started with how they approached the Commonwealth Games. Training loads were kept with Chanu's past injuries in mind, and the duo chose not



“I won't call it a psychological barrier. You can say that it happened by chance. We have discussed this many times. We realised if we attributed it to bad luck, we wouldn't be able to do anything about it.”

VIJAY SHARMA
WEIGHTLIFTING COACH

to chase a Commonwealth Games record. A gold with minimal effort was the call. It left her fresh to push at the Asian Games, for the one medal that would complete her.

Weightlifting asks for unflinching trust between coach and athlete. Even at these Asian Games, Chanu did not know what weights she was supposed to lift, or where she stood on the medal table. It was Vijay's split-second permutations and combinations that ensured a silver arrived while keeping her limits in mind.

Vijay was there in Sydney



Mirabai Chanu will now move to the 53 kg category for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. PTI

in 2000 when Karnam Malleswari won a bronze medal. Malleswari's gripe since has been that if her Russian coach had trusted her, a better medal could have been India's. "When you're in the arena, you need to make decisions in a fraction of a second. Whatever decisions we take are for the best of the players," says Vijay. He did not allow that breakdown of trust, which he saw with India's first Olympic weightlifting medal, when he started training Chanu. "That trust is essential. In life, whether with a life partner, in business, or in coaching, without trust, there is no bonding, and without bonding, there are no results. The trust that she has in me, even after she has won medals at the World and Olympic level, she still

asks me what sets to pick up," says Vijay.

"I didn't even know that I didn't need a third lift in Japan," admitted Chanu. "Sir told me that the silver medal was assured and that we wouldn't need to risk another lift," she added.

Once the medal was assured, Chanu could finally feel the weight lift off. It was a collective sense of wrong, felt by both her and Vijay, that was corrected in Nagoya. The fourth-place finish at the Paris Olympics had rankled deeply for both of them, more than two years on, until Nagoya came along.

"Winning this medal after so many years, across four Asian Games cycles, feels like a dream come true for both me and Vijay *sir*. It helps cover up

the pain of missing out on the medal in Paris. Every time we looked at photos or videos from Paris, it reminded us of what we missed. This medal brings us peace and closure," said Chanu.

Their next challenge is the LA Olympics, and a jump to the 53 kg category. Chanu admits that a higher weight class feels more comfortable.

"Now with the weight increase, it'll give some relief from injuries, so we can focus even more on performance and everything else. Whenever I win a medal, I immediately look ahead to the next competition: what I need to do, what changes to make. I learn from every medal and championship, and that's where I get my motivation," says Chanu.

● RULING THE 65KG ROOST

World C'ships is more competitive than Asiad... makes it more exciting: Sujeet

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, October 7

WRESTLER SUJEET Kalkal has had a great week.

He brought the men's 65 kg freestyle gold home from the Asian Games after defeating Olympic champion Kotaro Kiyooka of Japan in the semi-final and winning the final from 2-9 down. He also won the Raja Randhir Singh award for the best Indian male athlete at the Asian Games 2026.

However, the 23-year-old from Charkhi Dadri doesn't want to lose himself in the celebrations right now. "After winning the Asian Games medal, there are some distractions like functions and everything. But I want to go back to the mat as soon as possible," Sujeet said at an interaction organised by

SAI Media.

He is right to want to get back to the mat: a tough World Championships awaits him in Kazakhstan, starting October 24.

Dominant run

Sujeet is on a dominant run in the men's 65 kg category. He is the reigning U23 World Champion, Asian champion and Asian Games gold medalist. Since losing the bronze-medal match at last year's World Championships, Sujeet has won 19 bouts in a row and is unbeaten at the national level too.

The World Championships will bring new challenges: the Iranian powerhouse Rahman Amouzadkhalili, to whom Sujeet lost last year, and the American prodigy Bowen Bassett, who beat Worlds bronze



Sujeet Kalkal defeated Olympic champ Kotaro Kiyooka at the Asiad. PTI

medallist Real Marshall Ray Woods in the US trials.

"The competition level in the World Championships is very tough and it is not going to be easy for me. It is certainly more competitive than the

Asian Games and that is what makes it more exciting. This is the most important competition for me," Sujeet said.

But he has a few things to fine-tune before he goes for a world title.

“One of the reasons that Sujeet trailed in final was that he gave a better position to the opponent on the ground. That is something we are going to work on in this time frame.”

KULDEEP SINGH,
WRESTLING COACH

"I need to learn from the mistakes that I made in the past competitions. So, I am going to focus on that," he said.

Sujeet's Asian Games campaign was near flawless, but he gave away easy points at the

start of bouts, especially in positions played out on the mat.

Work yet to be done

"One of the reasons that Sujeet trailed in the final was that he gave a more advantageous position to the opponent on the ground. That is something we are going to work on in this small time frame we have got," his coach Kuldeep Singh told *The Indian Express*.

Sujeet agrees. "Both my coaches (Kuldeep and Shako) have asked me to take a strong position on the ground. I am working on it. Right now, I need to attack on the ground well and also defend if I lose the attacking position," he explained.

The other thing he has to do more of is attack, something national coach Bentinidis

Shako also insists on.

"Before the Asian Games, I had played a tournament in Russia. I won that tournament and every bout in it. But coach Shako was not happy with it," Sujeet said. "He told me to attack more as I have a variety of attacks."

He did that at the Asian Games, but will need to do more of it at the World Championships. "I worked on it and executed it during the Asian Games. That is why I was able to score so many points. I think I will need to continue doing this at the World Championships," said Sujeet.

Shako, who also coached Bajrang Punia to an Olympic medal, has brought attacking changes to Sujeet's game.

One of the highlights of Sujeet's Asian Games campaign

Gauff falls to Mertens after 'draining' days



Coco Gauff was subject to racist online comments. AP

Reuters
Beijing, October 7

COCO GAUFF exited the China Open in the last 16 on Wednesday, suffering a 6-3-6-3 defeat by Belgium's Elise Mertens after what the American third seed described as a draining few days.

Hours after the upset, Gauff withdrew from the Wuhan Open, a WTA 1000 hardcourt event she won last year, citing fatigue. Gauff, 22, revealed after her victory over Chinese 16-year-old Sun Xinran on Monday that she had received an "insane" amount of racial abuse on social media following a match in which a replayed point sparked an online backlash. "It has been kind of draining, I'm not going to lie," she told a news conference. "I just turn off my phone and move on. There's nothing you can do."

Online abuse

She beat Sun 7-5 6-1 to reach the fourth round, but was targeted online after stopping play during a key point in the first set, raising her hand to complain about a flickering advertising board as Sun was about to put away a winner.

After a video review, the umpire ordered the point to be replayed. Gauff won the point and held serve for 5-5. The WTA condemned the abusive comments she received. "There is no place for racism, discrimination, or abuse in tennis," the WTA told Reuters in a statement.

"We are appalled by the racial abuse directed at Coco Gauff and are in contact with her to offer our full support."

Gauff had beaten the 30-year-old Mertens in their five previous meetings. The 13th seed will next face six-times Grand Slam champion Iga Swiatek. Gauff's challenge unravelled amid a barrage of errors, with the 2024 Beijing champion committing 34 unforced errors, including eight double faults, during the 78-minute defeat.

"I think I just didn't play well," Gauff said. "I think I wasn't moving well. There were a lot of things I didn't do well. I thought Elise played well on the big points, made me play a big ball, yeah."

Gauff said she was sorry to miss the Wuhan tournament.

"I'm disappointed to withdraw from Wuhan, especially as the defending champion," the two-time Grand Slam champion said in a statement. "After a long year, my body needs some time to rest and recover."

Gauff joined world number one Elena Rybakina, who withdrew due to a foot injury, in pulling out of the Wuhan Open, which runs from October 12-18.